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AND

ROBERT CHAMBERS,

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I THOUGHT IT MY DUTY.

PEOPLE are very often heard to say, "I thought it my duty to do such a thing." It too frequently happens that what they thought it their duty to do, was some mischief, which lay ten miles out of their way. At a fair computation, fully one-half of the bad things done, out of the ranks of the avowedly vicious, are done under the impulse of a sense of duty. Decentish people in the middle and higher walks of life, rarely do any harm from ill-meaning—at least none that gives much trouble to their fellow-creatures. It is only when they are acting under what they deem very lofty motives, that they occasion any mischief worth speaking of. So much mischief, however, is thus occasioned, that the world is kept in a constant broil by conscientious actions.

A very common use of the phrase, "I thought it my duty," refers to some unpleasing communication. One man thinks it his duty to inform his friend that some person or persons have been speaking evilly of him, or under-valuing some pursuit in which he is engaged. Another thinks it his duty to warn some person against some person. Another thinks it his duty to administer a point-blank reproof to some one with whose conduct he has been displeased. It too often happens, that, instead of being prompted by a pure sense of duty, such communications are the result of some inferior feelings, which have only taken the guise of conscientiousness; at least, it is rarely that such communications are made in a prudent and kindly manner. Hence, it is not surprising, that, so far from producing the apparently desired benefit, they only aggrieve the feelings of the individual who is the object of them, and introduce dispeace and rancour where formerly all was going on in the common course of things. The number of officious interferences, prompted in the same way, and ending in the same results, is beyond all calculation. It is quite possible for one person thus to drive a whole circle of friends to distraction—under a sense of duty.

In public affairs, the same phenomenon is daily to be observed. In the present constitution of society, there are a good many rights and wrongs, and the most of people are attached to one or other of them, the real absolute right and wrong being in the mean time confounded and half dormant under the cloud of pretended ones. The actings and modes of acting, accordingly, which men feel to be justified by a sense of duty, are very various and frequently quite opposite; so that we have, upon the whole, a very amusing scene presented to us in the public world. One man, acting with a due and most conscientious regard to *his* right and wrong, appears to another as an ill-disposed and wicked person. The general actions of all men are defended as right by one set of people, and condemned as wrong by another. And still there is always the more mischief, the more loudly the man tells us that he acts under a high sense of duty, simply because, the higher his sense of duty, it will self-justify him in the greater departure from natural propriety. It is curious, that, in ordinary good actions, as succouring the poor, and visiting the afflicted, no man ever thinks it necessary to proclaim that he thought it his duty to do so. It is only when he has done something which the secret consciousness of absolute right and wrong tells him to be not quite what it should be, that he uses the phrase. The thing which he thought it his duty to do, is of course something which only appears right to one of his sophisticated consciences, of which the most of people have a good many. It might be no bad sport, when any one begins with, "I thought it my duty," to break in with such a version of what he did as the absolute natural conscience would suggest. Thus, we might have a series of sentences, much in the manner of cross-readings, as, for instance—

"I yesterday thought it my duty—to calumniate an innocent person in a public place, and mark him out as an object of popular detestation."

"My agent has written from the country to mention that several of my tenants have become very restive on certain points: I thought it my duty—to order them to be oppressed by all the means in my agent's power."

"In a pamphlet which I am about to publish, I have thought it my duty—to represent my opponent as the blackest and basest of men."

"In canvassing for the lucrative office which fell vacant the other day, I thought it my duty to my family—to use all the shabby and oblique arts I could devise for the purpose of gaining my point."

This last form of the sense of duty is a very familiar one. Whenever a man speaks of his duty to his family as a reason for a certain course of conduct, there is no room to doubt that the conduct in question is something awfully bad. Men who defend their conduct by a reference to their duty to their families, require to be carefully looked after. A lioness seeking supplies for her young, is scarcely a more dangerous customer. The absolute conscience of the man makes him half aware that he is prosecuting some improper object, or using, in the prosecution of it, some improper means; in this dilemma, he recollects that it will be for the benefit of his family to do so, and, knowing that all men have a sympathy in one's solicitude for one's family, he eagerly adopts this as a reason perfectly satisfactory both to himself and the world. For paltry circumventions in business, bidding for land and houses over a neighbour's head, or anticipating a friend in some speculation of his own suggestion, "I thought it my duty to my family" is an excuse precluding all further discussion. Who can blame a man for providing for his own? It is rather curious that the individuals who act thus from a supposed duty to their families, never think of the corresponding injury which they are doing to the families of their neighbours. If the question were pushed thus far, the genuine selfishness which formed the real motive, would appear. "Oh, every man must look to himself," would be the exclamation of the hardened offender, as he stood unblushingly at bay. Mankind, however, are not so far enlightened upon this subject, as to be able to put such questions. Their sympathies respond so readily to the appearance of a solicitude for offspring, that they neither know the real character of that feeling, nor are able readily to detect the pravities which so often use it as a mask. Expressly nothing more than a natural instinct, and quite independent of the rest of the human character, it is generally regarded as a virtue, and one of so redeeming a kind, that, if the most cruel of tyrants only shows himself at his palace windows in the act of hugging his children, he is held excused for the devastation of a kingdom. Even where this feeling has acted as the real motive for an improper action, it forms no excuse whatever: where it is only held up as a pretext, by way of covering a worse motive, it adds deceitfulness to another kind of guilt.

Since men so often go wrong when acting under what they suppose to be a sense of duty, it will naturally be asked, How are they to avoid such errors, and how are they to make sure that any notion of duty that may arise in their minds is a right one. It would require an elaborate treatise to exhibit a complete divarication of the genuine conscience from the mock ones which result from circumstances and from selfish instincts; but in the meantime something less may suffice. There is an excellent old rule which says, "Do unto others as you would have others do unto you." Upon the whole, if men in general acted under a complete sense of all the bearings of this precept, the humble moralist of these pages would not be so apt, as he now is, to smile, upon hearing one of his fellows say, "I thought it my duty."

MAGAZINE DAY.*

"MAGAZINE DAY" is a sort of monthly era in the history of a London bookseller. The orders for the forthcoming numbers of the various periodicals which he is in the habit of receiving for some days previously, keep it constantly in his mind's eye; and when it does arrive, the great contest among the trade is who shall be able to supply their customers earliest. Magazine Day can only be said fairly to commence about half-past nine o'clock, and before twelve you will see the various periodicals in the windows of every retail bookseller throughout the width and breadth of the metropolis. Perhaps in no other instance, that of newspapers alone excepted, is an article so rapidly circulated over town, as periodical literature on that day.

The point from which the magazines and other periodicals all start when their distribution is about to take place, is Paternoster Row, which, with that fondness for brevity of expression so characteristic of the people of London, is invariably called "the Row." The Row is not only the great, but may be said to be the only emporium of periodical literature on Magazine Day. Most persons unacquainted with the London bibliopolic trade, fancy that every bookseller in town, who receives an order for a certain periodical from the country, must go for it direct to the particular publisher of that periodical. This is not the fact. The party receiving the order sends at once to the Row, where he gets the periodical in question, and where he gets, at the same time, all the other periodicals which other customers may have ordered. If he had to go for each periodical to the place of publication, he would find it impossible to get through his business, if of any extent, with the requisite expedition, as the publishers of such works are scattered in all directions throughout the metropolis. Only fancy a person having to go, say from the middle of the city, first to a house in Leadenhall Street, for the "Asiatic Journal," and then westward to Regent Street for "Fraser's Magazine," "Bentley's Miscellany," or the "Metropolitan Magazine." Instead of this, however, he has only to go direct to the Row, where he at once gets, from the house he is in the habit of dealing with, all the periodicals for which he may have orders.

The actual publishers of periodicals, therefore, have, properly speaking, nothing to do with the sale of their respective works on Magazine Day, and they seldom have even any idea of the actual number sold of their own publications on that day. I have known instances in which the proprietors of some new periodical, or the new proprietors of some old one, have been extremely anxious to know the effects of the expenditure of a very large sum of money in advertisements, and yet have not been able to form the least idea on the subject on Magazine Day. The plan adopted by the publishers of periodicals, is to send to the various wholesale houses in the Row large quantities of their respective works, either on the evening before or

* This article is contributed by the Author of "Random Recollections of the House of Commons," "The Great Metropolis," &c.

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early in the morning of Magazine Day. Different houses receive different quantities, according to the relative amount of business done. These houses all take them on the condition that the unsold copies shall be returned. They have a small commission on the number sold, over and above the regular trade allowance of twenty-five per cent. This enables them to supply the trade on the same terms as if each periodical were purchased direct from its publisher. These wholesale houses in the Row scarcely ever, by chance, meet with any other customers than the trade; and, consequently, they never get full price for any magazine or other periodical they vend.

The number of these wholesale houses in the Row is not great. Including those whose business is chiefly confined to the cheap publications, it does not exceed a dozen. The leading houses are not above half a dozen in number. The quantity of business which some of these houses go through on Magazine Day is immense. I know one house which draws, on an average, from L.1200 to L.1500. Only fancy the number of periodicals, varying from sixpence to three shillings and sixpence, which must be turned over from the shelves of the establishment to the hands of the purchasers, before such a sum of money could be taken! The house to which I refer, disposes of from five hundred to seven hundred and fifty of some of the more popular periodicals. The business done on Magazine Day is all in ready money. There are no credit transactions whatever. The best customers know, that, without money, they will not be supplied, and consequently no credit is either asked for or expected.

The constant bustle kept up from morning till night in these wholesale houses, exceeds any thing of which a person who has not witnessed it could form any conception. The premises are full of young men and boys, all struggling for a priority of "supply." I have often seen as many as fifty or sixty wedged into a shop of the ordinary size. What between the rapid and noisy movement of their feet on the floor—the clinking of sovereigns, and shillings, and pence, on the counter—the quarrelling among themselves—the loud announcement of the names of the works supplied, and the amount of money to which each person's order comes, by the parties behind the counter, and the calls by the customers for the different publications wanted—what between all these discordant sounds, kept up without one moment's intermission, a stranger becomes literally stupified before he has been many minutes in the place. Any thing more confused, either to the eye or the ear, it were difficult to conceive. I have often thought that some of the houses in the Row would furnish a fine example, on Magazine Day, of a miniature Babel. The unfortunate persons doomed to spend that day behind the counter, undergo an incredible amount of hardship. Negro slavery, under its worst aspects, never exhibited any thing to parallel the labour and fatigue which these persons are fated to encounter. The only thing that sustains them, is the consideration that *the* day happens only once a-month. I am satisfied that a week consecutively of such labour as is undergone in these houses on Magazine Day, would be more than the strongest constitution could endure.

To a person unacquainted with such matters, who chanced to spend a few minutes in a large house in the Row on Magazine Day, all that he heard would be quite unintelligible. The individuals ordering periodicals scarcely ever call the periodicals they wish to procure by their proper names. The love of brevity, to which I have already referred, is observable in every word they utter. The "Gentleman's Magazine" never gets any other name than the "Gents." "Tait's Magazine" is simply "Tait." The "New Monthly Magazine" is the "New Month." The "Metropolitan Magazine" is abbreviated to the first three letters, with the addition of an *s*. The "Encyclopædia Britannica" is the "Ency Brit." The "Court Magazine" is the "Courts;" the "Lady's Magazine and Museum" is reduced to the dissyllable of "Ladies;" so that it is quite common to hear one person sing out, in one breath, "two Gents," "six Taits," "four Blackwood," "dozen Chambers" (meaning monthly parts), "three New Months," "three Mets," "one Court," and "two Ladies." But to form some idea of the ludicrous effect which such unintelligible jargon must have in the ears of a stranger, it will be necessary that the reader imagine to himself that a battery of such terms, levelled, if I may use the expression, at the parties behind the counter, is kept up incessantly by fifteen or twenty persons at once.

The incessant bustle kept up from morning till night in these houses in the Row, coupled with the crowds of persons, chiefly young men, who are always in them, afford excellent opportunities to those youths who may be disposed to exercise their light-fingered capabilities. Handkerchiefs often disappear from one's pockets on such occasions; but when it chances to be a rainy day, and umbrellas are in requisition, the possessors of such articles will require to keep what is called a sharp look-out if they mean to retain them for their own use. A few years since, I had occasion, on a rainy Magazine Day, to be in one of the wholesale houses in the Row. I laid down an excellent silk umbrella while I paid for a magazine; it instantly vanished. I mentioned the circumstance to one of the proprietors of the establishment: his answer was, "Oh, sir, every body must take care of himself on Magazine Day." While mortified at the circumstance, I could not help admiring the remarkable dexterity with which the theft had been committed. I hung the article on the counter, close beside me, and I am sure half a dozen seconds could not have elapsed before I discovered that it was gone.

Magazine Day always occurs on the last day of the month, except when that last day happens on a Sunday. In such a case, Magazine Day takes place on the Saturday. The appearance of the Row on such days, exhibits a remarkable contrast to what it does on any other day of the month. On other days of the month, the Row has a dull aspect. You only meet with a single individual at distances of from twenty to thirty yards. The place has quite a deserted appearance. Very different is it on Magazine Day. Then you see crowds of persons, chiefly young men, flying about in all directions, with bags thrown over their shoulders, either partially or wholly filled with "Mags," as the case chances to be. They could not appear in greater haste though they were running to save their lives.

I have referred to the quantity of business done in one of the largest houses in the Row on Magazine Day. What the entire number of periodicals which are sold by the booksellers in the Row on that day is, I have no data by which I can arrive at a positive conclusion; but, from calculations I have made, I should think the number of periodicals which issue from the Row, on the last day of every month, cannot be much under fifty thousand; and I should think the entire sum received over the counter for these, is not less than L.7000 or L.8000.

The Row is well adapted for being the emporium of literature. It is exactly in the centre of London, being in the immediate vicinity of St Paul's. And yet, while thus in the very centre of this great and busy metropolis, it is, as I have said before, so very quiet, except on Magazine Day, that, if a stranger were taken from the country, and dropped down into it blindfolded, he would, on opening his eyes, conclude that he was in some small provincial town. The Row is almost exclusively occupied by booksellers and stationers. The only premises of any note possessed by any other tradesman, are those occupied by a candlemaker. I have often thought it a pity that he could not be induced by some means or other to go and manufacture his rushlights, his sixes, &c., in some other quarter. The association between tallow and literature is quite an odd one.

I have said that Magazine Day is a sort of era in the history of the bibliopolic trade; so it is also in that of another class of persons—I mean authors of books and contributors to periodicals. Every Magazine Day, by ten o'clock, authors are attracted to the Row, from all parts of the metropolis, to see what is said of their productions in the literary notices; while contributors, or rather would-be contributors, are drawn to the same locality, to see whether their articles are inserted, or whether they can read their fate in the notices to correspondents. Neither authors who expect their books to be reviewed, nor candidates for admission into magazines, have resolution to wait till the periodicals are regularly published. Their anxiety to ascertain their doom, in such cases, is so intense, that they will rather walk from the most distant parts of London to the Row—the magazines being here first seen—than wait for two or three hours till brought to them. When the result is agreeable, they do not regret their early rising, or the distance they have walked; when it is otherwise, they reproach themselves with their folly in having tormented themselves before the time.

Magazine Day is not confined to the metropolitan circulation of periodical literature. On that day, works of this class are collected for all parts of the country, and sent off in packages by the earliest conveyance. Since the late establishment of steam communication between London and almost every port of any importance in the kingdom, the periodicals which first see the light in the Row, on Magazine Day, are in the hands of readers in the remotest parts of the country in less than a week. The quantity of literature thus sent off in monthly parcels to the country is immense, and has been vastly increased since the introduction of cheap publications into the bibliopolic market.

EMIGRATION ON A LARGE SCALE.

During last session of Parliament, a Select Committee of the House of Commons was appointed to inquire into the different conditions on which land is, or has been, disposed of in the British colonies, with a view to ascertain what mode would be most beneficial both to the colonies and to the mother country. The evidence taken before that committee, together with a report founded thereon, have since been published, and contain much interesting and important matter connected with the subject of emigration.

There are very many persons belonging to the poorer classes in Britain, and vast numbers in Ireland, who would gladly emigrate to one or other of our colonies, if they could find means to transport themselves thither, but who, for want of money to pay for their passage, are compelled to remain at home, overstocking the market of labour, and thereby lowering the wages and diminishing the comforts of the class to which they belong. While the advancement of the colonies is retarded for lack of a sufficient number of labourers, recent inquiries into the condition of the poor in Ireland have ascertained that there are in that country *two millions three hundred thousand individuals*, for whose labour there is no demand for thirty weeks in the year; and that such is the prevalence of poverty and destitution, that no poor-law for the relief of *all* the necessitous can be established in Ireland until the enormous mass of pauperism existing there has been diminished by extensive emigration, or the employment of a portion of the population in public works. Nor does a surplus of labour exist in Ireland only; England shares in the evil, and finds itself obliged, in order to check the ruinous increase of poor-rates, to shut up, not only aged and infirm, but even able-bodied paupers, in workhouses, where many, whose labour would be valuable in our foreign settlements, have to lead a life most unpleasant to themselves, and worse than unprofitable to the general community.

Such being the actual state of matters, it is evident that, if a method could be found of gratifying the wishes of those of the poor and industrious classes who are desirous of emigrating, without putting the nation to a single shilling of expense for their conveyance to our healthful and rising colonies in Australia or Canada, an important benefit would be conferred: first, on the emigrants themselves, who would be transferred from a land in which they could find no proper field for their exertions, to one where their industry would speedily procure for them comfort and independence; secondly, on the colonies to which they were sent, and to which their labour would be in the highest degree advantageous; and, thirdly, on the mother country, by restoring the balance between supply and demand in the market for labour, and relieving the community from the burden of supporting as paupers those who were thus removed. But how, it may be asked, is this to be accomplished? How are people who have no money of their own to be conveyed across the Atlantic, nay, even to the antipodes, without expense to the nation? The select committee of which we have spoken above, have in their report given an answer to this question. They state, that they "conceive that it would be perfectly practicable to raise, upon the security of the future land sales [in the colonies], the funds necessary to set on foot a plan of systematic emigration, upon a scale sufficiently large to meet the exigencies of the colonies and of the mother country."

The large sum annually drawn from the sale of waste lands in the United States, shows how fruitful a source of revenue such sales may become, under judicious regulations. The produce of the land sales in the States, from 1795 till 1836, amounted to nearly twelve millions and a half of pounds sterling, having advanced progressively during that period from about one thousand pounds sterling to upwards of two millions sterling per annum (being the amount realised in 1835)—a sum considerably larger than the whole of the public expenditure of that country. And from the evidence given before the select committee, it appears that exacting a price for waste lands, varied of course according to the circumstances of the district, instead of granting ground to settlers for nothing, or at a merely nominal price, is the best mode of promoting the prosperity of a colony or new settlement. On this subject many very interesting statements were made to the committee—all of them tending to prove that the cause of the failure or little success of many of the colonisation projects of modern times, is to be found in the too great facilities afforded to settlers to become landed proprietors; for no man will hire himself to be the servant of another, when he can with ease become a master himself. Thus, all become masters, or, more properly speaking, every man is compelled to be his

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own servant. It is clear, that, in a country where this practice prevails, it must be long before general comfort can be established.

The most remarkable example which has been furnished in recent times of the evil of giving too great facilities to the acquisition of land in new colonies, is furnished by the fate of the Swan River settlement in Western Australia. Mr Wakefield, one of the witnesses examined before the select committee, gave the following account of the progress and most unfortunate result of that undertaking:—"The colony has not quite perished, but the population is a great deal less than the number of emigrants; it has been a diminishing population since its foundation. The greater part of the capital which was taken out, has disappeared, and a great portion of the labourers taken out have emigrated to Van Diemen's Land and New South Wales. The many disasters which befel this Swan River colony, and the second emigration of the people who went out, appear to me to be accounted for at once by the manner in which the land was granted. The first grant consisted of five hundred thousand acres to an individual, Mr Peel. That grant was marked out upon the map in England—five hundred thousand acres were taken round about the port or landing-place. It was quite impossible for Mr Peel to cultivate five hundred thousand acres, or a hundredth part of the grant; but others were of course necessitated to go beyond his grant, in order to take their land; so that the first operation in that colony was to create a great desert, to mark out a large tract of land, and to say, 'this is a desert; no man shall come here; no man shall cultivate this land.' So far dispersion was produced, because, upon the terms on which Mr Peel obtained his land, land was given to the others. The governor took another hundred thousand acres, another person took eighty thousand acres; and the dispersion was so great, that at last the settlers did not know where they were; that is, each settler knew that he was where he was, but he could not tell where any one else was; and, therefore, he did not know his own position. That was the reason why some people died of hunger; for though there was an ample supply of food at the governor's house, the settlers did not know where the governor was, and the governor did not know where the settlers were. The labourers who were taken out under contracts or engagements, which assured them of very high wages if they would labour during a certain time for wages, finding they could acquire land easily, immediately laughed at their masters. Mr Peel carried out altogether about three hundred persons, men, women, and children. Of those three hundred persons, about sixty were able labouring men. In six months after his arrival, he had nobody even to make his bed for him, or to fetch him water from the river. He was obliged to make his own bed and to fetch water for himself, and to light his own fire. All the labourers had left him. The capital, therefore, which he took out, namely, implements of husbandry, seeds and stock, especially stock, immediately perished; without shepherds to take care of the sheep, the sheep wandered and were lost; eaten by the native dogs, killed by the natives and by some of the other colonists, very likely by his own workmen; his seeds perished on the beach; his houses were of no use; his wooden houses were there in frame, in pieces, but could not be put together, and were therefore quite useless, and rotted on the beach. This was the case with the capitalists generally. The labourers, obtaining land very readily, and running about to fix upon locations for themselves, and to establish themselves independently, very soon separated themselves into isolated families, into what may be termed cottiers, with a very large extent of land. Every one was separated, and very soon fell into the greatest distress. Falling into the greatest distress, they returned to their master, and insisted upon the fulfilment of the agreements upon which they had gone out; but then Mr Peel said, 'All my capital is gone; you have ruined me by deserting me, by breaking your engagements; and you now insist upon my observing the engagements when you yourselves have deprived me of the means of doing so.' They wanted to hang him, and he ran away to a distance, where he secreted himself for a time, till they were carried off to Van Diemen's Land, where they obtained food, and where, by the way, land was not obtainable with so great facility as at the Swan River."

Throughout the whole of his evidence, Mr Wakefield insists with much earnestness upon the necessity of combination of labour, in order to ensure the success of any scheme of colonisation. "In looking back," he says, "to the history of colonisation, I have had occasion to change a strong preconceived opinion. I had believed, in common with the greater number of persons who have thought at all upon the subject, that new colonies are generally very prosperous societies; whereas I now know, that of the colonies planted by the states of modern Europe, the greater number, that is, more than half, have entirely perished, have disappeared from the face of the earth; and that of those which did not perish, the greater number by far suffered during their infancy the utmost privations and hardships. I am not aware of a single instance in which an infant colony, planted in a country where there was a great extent of unoccupied land, was such a society as deserved to be called prosperous, until many years after its establishment."

To remedy this evil, Mr Wakefield, and other witnesses who were examined before the committee, are of opinion that such a price should be affixed to all waste lands in our colonies as would prevent an undue draining of the labour market by the labourers becoming proprietors, and the money thus obtained to be employed in conveying young and able-bodied emigrants of both sexes to the different colonies, by which means a constant and regulated supply of fresh labour would be afforded. There can be no doubt that this is the best possible plan that could be pursued; yet we are afraid it will be exceedingly difficult, if not impossible, to bring it into successful operation. The translation of labourers from Britain or Ireland to Upper Canada, on the great scale which is proposed, would never answer, because the United States are quite at hand, and there labour is better remunerated than in Canada. Of course, this and other temptations would speedily clear Canada of its labourers, in spite of all the bargains and contracts that could be entered into. We should, indeed, consider that the giving of a free passage to emigrants to Canada, would be precisely equivalent to making a present of so many citizens to the United States. On this account, the plan could only work to advantage in reference to Van Diemen's Land and New South Wales. But then, how mismanagement and jobbing are to be prevented in such a magnificent undertaking—how the public are to be biassed in favour of such a wholesale system of emigration—how intending emigrants are to be induced to give their confidence to a new scheme after so many other schemes have failed—are questions which it would puzzle a conjuror to answer.

YOUNG NAPOLEON.

The story of this youth's brief and uneventful existence possesses a deep, though in some degree painful, interest. A course of policy over which he had no control, and the propriety of which it is no part of our present purpose to discuss, confined him through life to a strange and unnatural position, and exerted a blighting influence on his fate. From this the chief interest of the young Napoleon's history arises, and not from any incidents by which it was distinguished.

Young Napoleon was born at Paris, on the 20th March 1811. His birth was attended with danger both to the mother and the offspring, insomuch that the medical attendant, a man of the first celebrity in his profession, lost courage, and was afraid to do what was necessary. At this juncture, the Emperor Napoleon appeared in the apartment, and commanded him to proceed as if the patient were the wife of an ordinary burgess. Every thing subsequently went on well, and the emperor in a short time had the satisfaction of presenting his infant son to the assembled officers of the imperial court, by whom the child was hailed "King of Rome"—the title which had been destined for him. At the same moment, the citizens of Paris were informed of the birth of an heir to the empire, by the reverberations of a hundred cannon, which was the signal pre-appointed.

When this event took place, the power of Napoleon was at its height, and the empire, of which the newly-born infant was the undisputed heir-apparent, was the mightiest, certainly, to which any human being had ever had the prospect of succeeding. Reverses, however, one after another, began to shake this great power, even while the unconscious heir to it was passing his infant days in the lap of pomp and adulation. In 1814, the Empress Maria Louisa, who had been left in Paris, while the emperor was engaged against the allied armies, conceived it necessary to leave the capital with her son, then three years old, on account of the approach of the enemy. This was the first time that the changes of the period had affected the boy, and he, according to Sir Walter Scott, "is said to have shown an unwillingness to depart, which, in a child, seemed to have something ominous in it;" as if he foreboded, young as he was, that there would be no return. Such was indeed the case; he never saw his father again. On Napoleon's abdication, and removal to Elba, Maria Louisa was not permitted to go with him, but was taken, along with her child, to the court of her father, the Emperor of Austria. Neither by negotiation, nor by stratagem, could Napoleon ever afterwards procure the restoration of his wife and child.

Though carried to Austria when little more than four years old, the previous life of the young Napoleon had been passed amid scenes of too striking a nature not to leave on his mind some deep impressions. His intelligence, moreover, was precocious, and his manners so grave and reflective, that it was a remark of the people about him, that he "never was a child." Not being of a communicative disposition, he did not talk himself, as ordinary children would have done, out of the recollections of former days. They lay treasured in the heart of the forlorn, and only saw the light in a moment of excitement. One day, for example, when in the midst of the imperial family, one of the Austrian archdukes showed him a silver medal that had been struck in honour of himself, and asked him if he knew whose image was impressed on it. "It is I," said the boy proudly, "when I was King of Rome." The remembrance of his own former consequence, and the greatness of his father, says his early tutor M. Foresti, were constantly present to his mind. From his infancy a love of truth distinguished him, and he used to pronounce the very word *truth* with an air and gesture of solemnity, which frequently made those about him smile. On observing this, he showed his self-command by silently desisting from the use of the word.

In another particular, he evinced the remarkable strength of his early impressions. No entreaties, advices, or commands, could at first prevail upon him to begin the study of the German tongue, which was the first instruction attempted to be communicated to him. He would not even pronounce a word of the language, and maintained this resolution a long time for one so young. When prevailed on at last to begin, he mastered the tongue with uncommon ease and rapidity. M. Foresti, the tutor who remained with him for many years, informs us that the reasoning powers of the young Napoleon were strongly developed even at this period. He yielded a point always on conviction, but only on conviction. He was good-natured to his inferiors, and friendly to his tutors, though without any lively expression of his feelings, "thinking always a great deal more than he said." He received reprimands with firmness, and soon acknowledged their justice, though perhaps annoyed at the time.

Such was the character in boyhood of young Napoleon, as described by M. Foresti, who, along with M. Collins, a German writer of talent, had the charge of his early instruction at Schoënbrun. As the boy's mind opened, a difficulty came in the way, which kept his tutors (says M. Foresti) "in a species of torture." This was the incessant interrogation of them by the youth respecting his father. The Emperor of Austria, on learning the state of matters, gave the teachers permission to speak freely—a wise step, as the event showed. For a short time, the boy drank from the newly-opened fountain, as if his thirst was insatiable. "He overwhelmed us with questions, and exhibited an affluence of ideas perfectly surprising. After a few days, he seemed satiated with what he had heard, and became more calm, more reserved on the subject. It may seem incredible, but it is nevertheless true, that at no time, under any circumstances, was he ever heard to utter one word of regret in connection with his father's fall." When he was ten years of age, the news of his father's death reached Schoënbrun. The boy wept bitterly when the intelligence was communicated to him, and his sadness endured for several days.

After his elementary education was completed, and studies of a higher nature entered upon, the bent of young Napoleon's mind began to develope itself. Of all the classical works, in the dead languages, laid before him, he took heartily only to the warlike commentaries of Cæsar. Indeed, so early as the age of seven, this bias to military pursuits had been shown, and the emperor, though intending him originally for the church, had indulged him with the uniform of a private. He afterwards went through every other rank, and learned the duties of each in its minutest details. Before the commissions appointed to watch over his educational progress, he showed extraordinary aptitude, and many of the performances and essays which he prepared for these examinations, are said to have presented tokens of remarkable genius. They are written in Italian and other modern tongues (which he spoke and wrote with ease), and now lie in the imperial archives at Vienna.

At the age of fifteen, young Napoleon's schoolboy days may be said to have closed. After that period he was permitted access to every book without exception, relative to the history of his father and the French revolution. He read them with inconceivable avidity, and became a more perfect master of every thing that has been written on these subjects than the best informed persons around him. His collections, in French, on history and other useful subjects, are said to be immense. The liberality of the emperor furnished the pecuniary means of indulging these tastes. By an imperial decree, he was created Duke of Reichstadt, and endowed with Bohemian estates yielding L.20,000 sterling, and latterly he had a separate household, with the rank of an Austrian prince. But though his slightest wish was gratified; though he was supplied to excess with books, horses, and equipages; though he was surrounded with attendants and instructors; he was still, in a social sense, in solitude. This was the product of policy, not unkindness; for his grandfather, the emperor, showed always a strong affection for him. In fact, the youth may be said to have given his own assent to the mode of life we have described. After he had reached what was considered a fit age, the minister Metternich, at the emperor's request, gave the son of Napoleon, in a series of interviews, the Austrian version of the history of his father, which had the anticipated effect on the youth's noble and ingenuous mind. His confidence was entirely won, and this had the practical result of rendering all those attempts abortive, which were frequently made by adventurers desirous of engaging the youth in political schemes. He is reported to have said to the emperor and Metternich, "The essential object of my life ought to be to make myself not unworthy of the glory of my father. I shall hope to reach this point of my ambition, if I can appropriate to myself any of his high qualities, taking care to avoid the rocks on which he split. I should be lost to a proper sense of his memory, if I became the plaything of faction, and the instrument of intrigue. Never ought the son of Napoleon to condescend to play the miserable part of an adventurer!" The example of Prince Eugene, who won high military fame without the stain of ambition, was that set before the young Napoleon.

A deserving young officer, M. Prokesch, author of several military works, has given some interesting notices of the subject of our memoir, to whom he was introduced at the emperor's table. This introduction was followed by an intimacy, permitted by the emperor, which appears to have afforded a vast degree of pleasure to the prince. To have a friend, not of his suite, seemed like putting one foot into the world. In all their conversations, M. Prokesch tells us, the theme of the youth was the career of his father, of whom he spoke with deep and passionate admiration. Speaking of his parent's achievements, the prince warmed into eloquence and enthusiasm, and took on all occasions grand and comprehensive views of the

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subjects of his discourse. To M. Prokesch the prince appeared devoured by the desire of military fame. In the Letters on the Duke of Reichstadt (of which, though they are anonymous, M. Prokesch is understood to be the writer), we are told that this military ardour was not without an object—that the hope and aim of young Napoleon was the throne of France, on which he expected to be placed, not by a party in France, but by the general demand of the country, backed by the consent of the monarchs of Europe. To this secret idea, working in the recesses of his heart, must be attributed all his restless labours, his continued studies, his fatiguing exercises, his rage for riding, and his passion for military information. He dreaded that the call would come, and find him unprepared; he, as it were, slept under arms. The revolution of the Three Days in France stimulated the prince to fresh ardour in his military studies, by opening a prospect of war in Europe. It was about this period that he gave a manuscript of singular interest to M. Prokesch to read. In this composition (says that officer), interspersed with shrewd general views, he considered his position in relation to France and Austria; he pointed out the rocks which surrounded him, the means of avoiding those dangers, his own character, its defects, and the remedy for them; in short, he showed the clearest comprehension of his own circumstances, and how deeply he had weighed all the contingencies which it might be his lot to encounter.

The prince made his first appearance in general society at the house of Lord Cowley, the British ambassador, on the 25th January 1831. But the review, not the ball, was the stage for him. Next morning he said to a friend, "How painful and wearisome such a party is to me! What striking contrasts were assembled in that apartment! I saw about me (himself a monument of political change) two princes of the house of Bourbon, Baron Kentzinger, the representative of Charles X., Marshal Maison, the ambassador of Louis Philip, the prince Gustavus Vasa, natural heir of the throne of Sweden, and Count Lowenheilm, minister of Bernadotte. For the first time I spoke with Marshal Marmont; my father quoted him as a man of talent, and I found his conversation accord with his character. I am to receive him to-day. I am glad to find myself in communication with Frenchmen." The interview with Marmont, the only survivor of his father's early aides-de-camps, was a source of deep pleasure to the son of the marshal's ancient master. With consent of the emperor, Marmont saw the prince frequently, and read over with him, or rather read him a series of lectures on, Napoleon's campaigns.

In June 1831, the prince was named lieutenant-colonel, and took command of a battalion in garrison at Vienna. His appearance about this period is thus described by the author of "Austria as it is:"—"The young Napoleon is an interesting youth, beautifully formed, with the countenance and the fine-cut lips of his father, and the blue eyes of his mother. One cannot see this blooming youth, with his inexpressible tint of melancholy and thoughtfulness, without deep emotion. He has not that marked, plain, and familiar ease of the Austrian princes, who seem to be every where at home; but his demeanour is more dignified, and noble in the extreme. He has an Arabian steed, which he strides with a nobleness which gives the promise of as good horsemanship as that for which his father was so celebrated. His soldiers almost adore him, and he commands with a precision and a military eye which prognosticate a future general." The bloom did not continue long on the cheek of this interesting being. His indefatigable exertions in discharge of his duties, as well as his continued studies, made the malady visible, under which he was destined to sink. He had shot up to a great height, and was seized with cough, hoarseness, and other symptoms of pulmonary disease. He was frequently found in a state of extreme lassitude, after returning from his military duties, though he almost hid himself, to prevent its being known, fearing that the comparative frequency of intercourse with his fellow men, which his military appointment had brought about, would terminate, by his being sent again into retirement. One day, his physician, Dr Malfatti, entered, and found him lying on a sofa, completely exhausted; the prince exclaimed, "I abominate this wretched body, that sinks under my will in this manner." "You have set, Monseigneur," replied the physician, "a will of iron in a body of glass, and the indulgence of your will must be fatal." "The life of the prince was at that time, in fact," says the physician, "undergoing a process of combustion. He slept scarcely four hours, though by nature he required a great quantity of sleep; he scarcely ate at all. His soul was entirely concentrated in the routine of the menage and the different military exercises; he was, in truth, never at rest; he continued to increase in height, grew wretchedly thin, and his complexion gradually became livid. To all my questions he answered, '*I am perfectly well.*'" The emperor was at length applied to by the physician, and the prince was sent, much against his wish, to Schoënbrun, where he rallied surprisingly. No sooner was he better, however, than he began to visit the nearest military stations, and to hunt, as the next best thing to war. Consumptive symptoms returned with increased force, and after severe suffering, he died on the 22d of July 1832, in the bed at Schoënbrun which his father had occupied as the conqueror of Vienna. On opening his body, his lungs were found almost entirely wasted away.

The prince enjoyed on his death-bed the kind attentions of a mother. When laid on his bier, his resemblance to his father became much more striking than in life, though at all times it was obvious at a glance. On considering the history of this youth, it is impossible not to feel a degree of melancholy and regret. From what has been recorded of him, it is clear that he possessed great talents—energies but too mighty for the weak frame which contained them. On his birth hung apparently the destinies of an empire, and the event was announced by the thunder of a hundred cannon, and greeted with the acclamations of millions. Though in one sense not ungently dealt with, the developement both of his mind and body, at the period when nature most demands freedom of growth, was cribbed and confined, and he lived and died, under the crushing pressure of a cold policy, little better than a captive in a foreign land. Under different circumstances, and a rational system of education capable of showing the criminality of warfare, this young man, had he been spared, would have shone forth one of the most eminent of men.

YANKEE HUMOUR.

Among the characters introduced to public notice by the unrivalled Mathews, was an American gentleman, who was extremely anxious to rebut an insinuation against his countrymen, that they "had no fun," which he proposed to do effectually by the publication of a Transatlantic Joe Miller. How such an insinuation should have been made against America, is more than we can understand, for it has always appeared to us that there is much quaintness and humour in the genuine Yankee character. Some clever person in Nova Scotia seems to be of the same opinion, for we have just received from that colony a small volume, entitled "The Clockmaker, or the Sayings and Doings of Samuel Slick, of Slickville,"* consisting of letters which originally appeared in the Nova Scotian (newspaper), and the object of which is to bring the humour of a New England clock-pedlar, mingled with his shrewd good sense, to bear upon the errors of the colonists. Of this humour we shall cull a few specimens, in the hope that its originality may excite a smile where more refined and pretending compositions would fail to do so.

SOFT SAWDER AND HUMAN NATUR.

In the course of a journey which Mr Slick performs in company with the reporter of his humours, the latter asks him how, in a country so poor as Nova Scotia, he contrives to sell so many clocks. "Mr Slick paused," continues the author, "as if considering the propriety of answering the question, and looking me in the face, said, in a confidential tone, 'Why, I don't care if I do tell you, for the market is glutted, and I shall quit this circuit. It is done by a knowledge of *soft sawder* and *human natur*. But here is Deacon Flint's,' said he; 'I have but one clock left, and I guess I will sell it to him.' At the gate of a most comfortable looking farm-house stood Deacon Flint, a respectable old man, who had understood the value of time better than most of his neighbours, if one might judge from the appearance of every thing about him. After the usual salutation, an invitation to alight was accepted by Mr Slick, who said, 'he wished to take leave of Mrs Flint before he left Colchester.' We had hardly entered the house, before the Clockmaker pointed to the view from the window, and, addressing himself to me, said, 'If I was to tell them in Connecticut, there was such a farm as this away down east here in Nova Scotia, they would'nt believe me—why, there aint such a location in all New England. The deacon has a hundred acres of dyke—'† 'Seventy,' said the deacon, 'only seventy.' 'Well, seventy; but then there is your fine deep bottom; why, I could run a ramrod into it. Then there is that water privilege, worth three or four thousand dollars, twice as good as what Governor Cass paid fifteen thousand for. I wonder, deacon, you don't put up a carding-mill on it: the same works would carry a turning-lathe, a shingle machine, a circular saw, grind bark, and ——' 'Too old,' said the deacon, 'too old for all those speculations.' 'Old!' repeated the Clockmaker; 'not you; why, you are worth half a dozen of the young men we see now-a-days.' The deacon was pleased. 'Your beasts, dear me, your beasts must be put in and have a feed;' saying which, he went out to order them to be taken to the stable. As the old gentleman closed the door after him, Mr Slick drew near to me, and said in an under tone, 'that is what I call *soft sawder*. An Englishman would pass that man as a sheep passes a hog in a pasture—without looking at him. Now I find——' Here his lecture on soft sawder was cut short by the entrance of Mrs Flint. 'Jist come to say good bye, Mrs Flint.' 'What, have you sold all your clocks?' 'Yes, and very low, too, for money is scarce, and I wished to close the consarn; no, I am wrong in saying all, for I have just one left. Neighbour Steel's wife asked to have the refusal of it, but I guess I won't sell it; I had but two of them, this one and the feller of it, that I sold Governor Lincoln. General Green, Secretary of State for Maine, said he'd give me fifty dollars for this here one—it has composition wheels and patent axles; it is a beautiful article—a real first chop—no mistake, genuine superfine; but I guess I'll take it back; and, beside, Squire Hawk might think it hard, that I did not give him the offer.' 'Dear me,' said Mrs Flint, 'I should like to see it; where is it?' 'It is in a chest of mine over the way, at Tom Tape's store; I guess he can ship it on to Eastport.' 'That's a good man,' said Mrs Flint, 'jist let's look at it.' Mr Slick, willing to oblige, yielded to these entreaties, and soon produced the clock—a gaudy, highly varnished, trumpery looking affair. He placed it on the chimney-piece, where its beauties were pointed out and duly appreciated by Mrs Flint, whose admiration was about ending in a proposal, when Mr Flint returned from giving his directions about the care of the horses. The deacon praised the clock; he too thought it a handsome one; but the deacon was a prudent man: he had a watch, he was sorry, but he had no occasion for a clock. 'I guess you're in the wrong furrow this time, deacon; it an't for sale,' said Mr Slick; 'and if it was, I reckon neighbour Steel's wife would have it, for she gives me no peace about it.' Mrs Flint said that Mr Steel had enough to do, poor man, to pay his interest, without buying clocks for his wife. 'It's no consarn of mine,' said Mr Slick, 'as long as he pays me, what he has to do; but I guess I don't want to sell it, and, beside, it comes too high; that clock can't be made at Rhode Island under forty dollars. Why, it an't possible,' said the Clockmaker, in apparent surprise, looking at his watch; 'why, as I'm alive, it is four o'clock, and if I hav'nt been two hours here—how on airth shall I reach River Philip to-night? I'll tell you what, Mrs Flint: I'll leave the clock in your care till I return on my way to the States—I'll set it a-going, and put it to the right time.' As soon as this operation was performed, he delivered the key to the deacon with a sort of serio-comic injunction to wind up the clock every Saturday night, which Mrs Flint said she would take care should be done, and promised to remind her husband of it, in case he should chance to forget it.

'That,' said the Clockmaker, as soon as we were mounted, 'that I call *human natur!* Now, that clock is sold for forty dollars—it cost me just six dollars and fifty cents. Mrs Flint will never let Mrs Steel have the refusal—nor will the deacon learn until I call for the clock, that, having once indulged in the use of a superfluity, it is difficult to give it up. We can do without any article of luxury we have never had, but when once obtained, it is not in *human natur* to surrender it voluntarily. Of fifteen thousand sold by myself and partners in this province, twelve thousand were left in this manner, and only ten clocks were ever returned—when we called for them, they invariably bought them. We trust to soft sawder to get them into the house, and to human natur that they never come out of it.'"

NOVA-SCOTIAN HORSES.

Among the absurd practices charged by the Clockmaker against the Nova-Scotians, or Blue Noses, as he calls them, is that of keeping great flocks of useless horses, which eat up the greater part of the product of their farms. "If they'd keep less horses, and more sheep, they'd have food, and clothing too, instead of buying both. I vow I've larfed afore now till I have fairly wet myself a-crying, to see one of these folks catch a horse: may be he has to go two or three miles of an errand. Well, down he goes on the dyke with a bridle in one hand, and an old tin pan in another, full of oats, to catch his beast. First he goes to one flock of horses, and then to another, to see if he can find his own critter. At last he gets sight on him, and goes softly up to him, shakin' of his oats, and a-coaxin' him; and jist as he goes to put his hand upon him, away he starts all head and tail, and the rest with him; that starts another flock, and they set a third off, and at last every troop on'em goes, as if Old Nick was arter them, till they amount to two or three hundred in a drove. Well, he chases them clear across the Tantramer marsh, seven miles good, over ditches, creeks, mire holes, and flag ponds, and then they turn and take a fair chase for it back again seven miles more. By this time, I presume, they are all pretty considerably well tired, and Blue Nose, he goes and gets up all the men folks in the neighbourhood, and catches his beast, as they do a moose arter he is fairly run down; so he runs fourteen miles, to ride two, because he is in a tarnation hurry. It's e'en a-most equal to eatin' soup with a fork, when you are short of time. It puts me in mind of catching birds by sprinkling salt on their tails; it's only one horse a man can ride out of half a dozen, arter all. One has no shoes, t'other has a colt, one arnt broke, another has a sore back, while a fifth is so etarnal cunnin', all Cumberland could'nt catch him, till winter drives him up to the barn for food.

Most of them ere dyke marshes have what they call 'honey pots' in 'em; that is, a deep hole all full of squash, where you can't find no bottom. Well, every now and then, when a feller goes to look for his horse, he sees his tail a stickin' right out an eend, from one of these honey pots, and wavin' like a head of broom corn; and sometimes you see two or three trapped there, e'en a-most smothered, everlastin' tired, half swimmin', half wadin', like rats in a molasses cask. When they find 'em in that ere pickle, they go and get ropes, and tie 'em tight round their necks, and half hang 'em to make 'em float, and then haul 'em out. Awful looking critters they be, you may depend, when they do come out; for all the world like half-drowned kittens—all slinkey, slimey, with their great long tails glued up like a swab of oakum dipped in tar. If they don't look foolish, it's a pity! Well, they have to nurse these critters all winter, with hot mashes, warm covering, and what not; and when spring comes, they mostly die; and if they don't, they are never no good arter. I wish with all my heart half the horses in the country were barrelled up in these here 'honey pots,' and then there'd be near about one-half too many left for profit. Jist look at one of these barn-yards in the spring—half a dozen half-starved colts, with their hair lookin' a thousand ways for Sunday, and their coats hangin' in tatters, and half a dozen good-for-nothin' old horses, a-crowdin' out the cows and sheep."

* Halifax, printed and published by Joseph Howe, 1836.

† Flat rich land dyked in from the sea.

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ILLUSTRATION OF SUBTERRANEAN WEALTH.

"It's a pretty province, I tell you [Nova Scotia], good above and better below; surface covered with pastures, meadows, woods, and a 'nation sight of water privileges, and under the ground full of mines—it puts me in mind of the soup at the *Tree*-mont House. One day I was a-walkin' in the Mall, and who should I meet but Major Bradford, a gentleman from Connecticut, that traded in calves and pumpkins for the Boston market. Says he, 'Slick, where do you get your grub to-day?' 'At General Peep's tavern,' says I. 'Only fit for niggers,' says he; 'why don't you come to the *Tree*-mont house; that's the most splendid thing, it's generally allowed, in all the world.' 'Why,' says I, 'that's a notch above my mark; I guess it's too plaguy dear for me; I can't afford it no how.' 'It's near about dinner time,' says the major; 'jist come and see how you like the location.' There was a sight of folks there, gentlemen and ladies in the public room (I never seed so many afore, except at commencement day), all ready for a start; and when the gong sounded, off we sott like a flock of sheep. Well, if there warnt a jam, you may depend: some one gave me a pull, and I near abouts went heels up over head; so I reached out both hands, and caught hold of the first thing I could; and what should it be but a lady's dress. Well, as I'm alive, rip went the frock, and tare goes the petticoat; and when I righted myself from my beam eends, away they all came home to me. If she did'nt scream, it's a pity; and the more she screamed, the more folks larfed, for no soul could help larfin', till one of the waiters folded her up in a tablecloth. 'What an awkward feller you be, Slick!' says the major; 'now, that comes of not falling in first; they should have formed four deep, rear rank in open order, and marched in to our splendid national air, and filed off to their seats right and left shoulders forward.' Well, I gets near the major at table, and afore me stood a china utensil with two handles, full of soup, about the size of a foot tub, with a large silver scoop in it, near about as big as a ladle of a maple sugar kettle. I was jist about bailing out some soup into my dish, when the major said, 'Fish it up from the bottom, Slick.' Well, sure enough, I gives it a drag from the bottom, and up come the fat pieces of turtle, and the thick rich soup, and a sight of little forced meat balls. No soul could tell how good it was—it was near about as hand*sum* as father's old genuine particular cider, and that you could feel tingle clean away down to the tip eends of your toes. 'Now,' says the major, 'I'll give you, Slick, a new wrinkle on your horn. Folks aint thought nothin' of unless they live at Treemont: it's all the go. Do you dine at Peep's tavern every day, and then off hot foot to Treemont, and pick your teeth on the street steps there, and folks will think you dine there. I do it often, and it saves two dollars a-day.' Then he puts his finger on his nose, and says he, 'Mum is the word.' Now, this province is jist like that ere soup, good enough at top, but dip down and you have the riches, the coal, the iron ore, the gypsum, and what not."

OLD MARGARET AND THE MINISTER.

O, wad some power the giftie gi'e us
To see ourselves as others see us.—BURNS.

IT is more pleasing to the eye and to the feelings to look upon an elegantly formed object, than upon one which is clumsy or coarse. It is more agreeable to contemplate a natural flower, with its beautiful and simple tints, than a mock flower, formed of crape or whitey-brown paper. Why we should experience these sensations of pleasure in beholding the beautiful in form and colour, it is here needless to inquire. It is sufficient to know that the mind is constituted to receive impressions of this description; and if we therefore grudge ourselves such impressions, we are doing a violence to nature—making ourselves miserable for no use. In this lies the whole philosophy of the fine arts. Strange as it may seem, it is very certain that there are large classes of people who affect to hold the gratifications we are speaking of in contempt, and yet these very people act on a principle directly the reverse. We can best explain this curious contradiction by telling the following anecdote.

A number of years ago there lived a very decent old woman in a country town in Scotland; her name was Margaret, and she was the widow of a much respected elder of the parish. Margaret possessed an excellent character, and was, on the whole, a worthy woman, but she possessed one failing, which rendered her company sometimes disagreeable. Her failing consisted in an extraordinary idea of her own self-sufficiency. She considered every other person's conduct as lax in comparison with her own. Dressing very plainly herself, with a simple black ribbon bound round a clean starched cap, she considered herself entitled to rail at all the world, for their vain gauds, as she called them. Not a head-dress or a gown in the parish escaped her censure. Above all, she dealed out unmeasured censure on the dress of the minister's wife, who, she imagined, ought to set an example to all around. One day, while in the company of the minister, and an assembly of neighbours, Margaret's wrath burst forth in a torrent of abuse upon the head of the devoted pastor:—"It was a shame and disgrace to him to allow his wife to wear such things"—and so forth. The minister had often heard of Margaret's failing, and he had for some time waited patiently till an opportunity occurred of rebuking her—not by pastoral admonition, for Margaret would have quoted scripture as fast as he could have done, but by a little gentle raillery, which he thought would effectually silence her. "Now, Margaret," said the reverend doctor, leaning forward on his cane in a jocose sort of way—"now, Margaret, I really thought that you, who are a sensible woman, would have seen that we all have a little vanity in our composition; one likes to wear one kind of dress, and another person another; one prefers one colour, another person chooses another, and so on: there, for instance, you delight in wearing a black ribbon round your cap; it is the indulgence you are fond of, and I have no objection to it, none in the world; but it is quite clear that a piece of hempen string would answer the same purpose—would bind your head just as well!" Margaret was struck all of a heap; an entirely new light burst in upon her; she felt herself convicted of the very crime which she had all her life habitually denounced; and ever after, while disusing the ribbon, as if for the sake of doing penance, she took care not to utter a syllable of her wonted contemptuous observations on her neighbours' attire.

MY FRIEND BROMELY.

ONE dull snowy morning in January, while sitting at breakfast in my lodgings in a dull street in London, I received the following note:—"Dear Harry, I am confined to bed—very unwell—come and see me—immediately.—Yours always, T. BROMELY."

This was very laconic. I had seen Bromely a few nights before at the opera in high spirits, and apparently in good health. I was rather surprised, therefore, at the import of the card, but thinking that it might be some trifling indisposition, I finished my breakfast and my newspaper before setting out to call. I found myself about one o'clock at his lodgings, and, on inquiring of the footman how his master was, I learned that he had been confined to bed two days, and was still unable to rise. I entered the chamber, and having shaken hands, began to give the customary consolations—hoped "that the illness was trifling," and so on; but after I had become familiar with the gloom of the apartment, which was darkened, and could distinguish objects properly, I was struck with the change which had taken place in his countenance. To be sure, there must always be a great difference in a man's appearance when he exchanges the gilding of a fashionable exterior for the paraphernalia of a sick-bed; but even after making allowance for this, I thought I discovered symptoms of a serious malady. The worst part of the affair was the utter prostration of mind which he had experienced, for he hardly appeared to listen to what I said; and on inquiring what physicians he had consulted, he answered "None; it was of no use." I of course told him of the madness, the folly of this, and said I would bring Dr Berkely with me at four o'clock, though I hoped that by that time he would be better.

"To tell the truth," said he suddenly, "I am afraid to hear the sentence of a physician, for fear of having my suspicions confirmed; but I dare say it is the best way to be resolved at once. Do bring him. Pray, what day of the month is this, Harry?"

"The sixth," I answered. "Is it?" he exclaimed with an earnestness which made me start. "Harry, I *must* be well by the twelfth."

I told him if there was any thing I could do for him on that particular day, I would do it with pleasure. "No, no, no!" he answered impatiently; "I must be out myself. What *is* to be done? You cannot imagine the horrid necessity for my being out on that day, and I can't tell you."

I tried to make him explain what he seemed so anxious about, but he was impatient of the subject; and seeing I only irritated him by inquiries, I ceased to press them, and took my leave. It was evening before I saw Dr Berkely. The rain was pouring in torrents, and it was pitchy dark. We drove to Bromely's, and I entered the chamber along with the doctor, who, seating himself by the fireside, put the usual medical questions, felt his patient's pulse, wrote a prescription, and was about to move off.

"One moment, doctor, if you please. I shall be obliged to you, if, for once, you will lay aside your professional caution, and speak out. What is the matter?" The doctor hesitated; said that at present he could not say with certainty what was the matter; would call to-morrow; hoped it was only cold; recommended quietness; and desired him to keep his mind free from alarm, as probably there was not much to apprehend.

Bromely was dissatisfied, but the doctor would not speak out. I took my leave along with him, and, on parting, inquired if he feared any thing very bad; and though he gave me no explicit answer, I was satisfied he considered the matter serious. He went to visit his patients, and I went to the opera. In the glitter of the performance, I forgot Bromely and his illness.

Another note next morning. It ran thus: "Dear Harry, I have had a miserable night, and am wretched. Do come and see me; it will be a charity," &c. The note was hardly legible, and had been written evidently in violent agitation. In half an hour after the receipt, I was in his chamber. He was looking miserably, but seemed rejoiced when I entered.

"You must think me very selfish in boring you thus," said he; "but if you knew how miserable I am when alone, I am sure you would not grudge me an hour of your society."

What could I do? Of course I was obliged to say, that, if my presence gave him any satisfaction, I would remain with pleasure. "No, no, no!" he answered quickly. "I know very well no one would prefer being here to enjoying himself in his own way, but I shall accept of your kindness for all that." I offered to read to him, but he declined; and, accordingly, I was obliged to keep up a conversation which was any thing but enlivening.

The doctor called, and having ascertained the state of his patient, wrote another prescription, and was about to retire. "Pray, sit down, doctor," said Bromely, "and do me a favour." The doctor took a chair and looked at his watch, as much as to hint that his time was precious. "Oh, it will be your own fault if you be detained, doctor. Answer me a very simple question: I am determined to know, and I have a reason for it—if you will not tell me, I shall just call another physician, who may not be so scrupulous—am I in for a fever?" The doctor nodded assent.

Bromely sank back on his pillow at this confirmation of his suspicions, and was silent for some time. He seemed greatly agitated. "How long," at last said he, "how long, doctor, may it take to set me up again; that is, supposing I recover?" and he looked rather wildly in his face.

"It is really impossible to say, Mr Bromely. At present, I assure you, I can have no idea, and the less you think about it, the better." "But I may be out by the twelfth?" "Impossible," answered the doctor.

I shall not soon forget the look the sick man gave when he received this laconic answer. Impatience and despair seemed to agitate him fearfully. "Doctor Berkely, come what may, you *must* and *shall* enable me to be out on that day. I think I could walk about just now." He made an effort to raise himself in bed, but a sudden sickness came over him, and, with a groan, his head again sought its pillow.

"Doctor," said he, after a pause, "could you give me such a draught as would enable me to go out for an hour or two? I care not how much I suffer as the consequence. I know," continued he, "you can prolong life at times, though you cannot save it. Come, doctor, have you such a medicine?"

"Mr Bromely, this is foolish. Forgive me, it is sinful. You must not think of going out. I can give no such medicine as you ask. For your own safety, I advise you to compose yourself. Do not think of leaving your bed."

Bromely was suddenly silent, and seemed to be engaged in painful reflection. The doctor departed, promising to call again in the evening. A considerable time elapsed before he broke silence; and when he did so, I thought the tone of his voice had altered considerably. His look was fierce: I thought the fever had gone to his brain.

"Harry," said he, "I don't care for Berkely's opinion. Doctors have their creed, and they must stick to it for the sake of consistency. If disease be in my system, how can outward circumstances affect me? What does it matter whether I lie, or sit, or walk? Besides, I recollect an anecdote of a soldier in a retreat, who kept his saddle for a week, and the man had a malignant fever on him. What is there, then, to hinder me from going out for an hour? Harry, once for all, I must be out on the twelfth, and you must assist me."

"What *is* the meaning of this nonsense?" I exclaimed impatiently, for I had almost lost my temper at his folly—"what *can* there be which so imperiously demands your presence, at the risk, nay, the certainty of your death, being the consequence? It is absurd to talk of moving from your room; and I certainly shall not assist in any such mad attempt."

I was frightened at the expression of his countenance. He was generally an open-hearted and most kind-hearted being, but his look was now dreadful to behold; and when he spoke, though he trembled with passion, the words came slowly and distinctly. "Hear me, Harry: I am fixed in my resolve to be out by the twelfth, and, what is more, you *shall* assist in that very mad attempt." He laughed; but such a laugh! I was terrified. I was afraid that he was deranged—was in a state of raving madness. "Well," said I, with the view of soothing him, "we shall see how you are on that day, and then"—He interrupted me. "Oh, yes; try and soothe me like a child! Yes, we *shall* see on that day." And he was silent.

Days rolled on, and still the same wild determination remained, and every day only saw his resolution become stronger, if possible. He laughed at bodily pain, philosophised upon it, made me read medical books upon fever and delirium, and reasoned upon them as abstract speculations; always ending by repeating his fixed resolution to be out on the twelfth.

It was on the evening of the eleventh that I was sitting with him. He was in a state of high excitement, and talked of going out to-morrow as a thing of course—said I must go with him, in a coach, and implored my acquiescence in terms which distressed me. I had hitherto refrained from contradicting him, as I thought the irritation caused by my opposition made him worse; but now I thought it was high time to tell him my mind, and did so. I represented to him as strongly as possible the madness, the impossibility of his going out—nay, more, that force was to be used to compel him to remain in bed if he persisted in the attempt—and tried by every means in my power to dissuade him from it. He heard me with perfect quietness, though with impatience. When I had finished, he made no answer, but, to my astonishment, got out of bed, threw a dressing-gown about him, walked firmly across the room, and, opening a drawer, took out a pair of dumb-bells, and having exercised them in the

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usual way for about a minute, put them back in their place, and returned to bed.

"Every night," said he, "since I have been confined, I have done this; and as long as I can do it, no one shall persuade me that I can't go out; and, as for force," continued he, "look here!" He opened a case which lay at the back of his bed, and produced a pair of pistols, nodded significantly, and replaced them. It was in vain to remonstrate. I still, of course, thought the necessity of his being out existed only in his imagination, and I determined to take serious measures for his confinement. At night I easily got possession of the pistols.

Next day I called, as he had made me solemnly promise to do. He had discovered that the pistols had been taken away, and I expected a violent scene, which I was prepared for. I was mistaken, however. He lay a few minutes perfectly silent; and when he spoke, he did so slowly and mildly.

"Harry," said he, "are you determined not to assist me in going out to-day—for an hour—or two?" I shook my head.

"When I assure you," continued he, calmly, "when I assure you that my honour, and the honour of my family—nay, that my life depends upon it?"

I was astonished at the calmness and firmness with which he spoke, but I was determined not to give way. "Bromely," said I, "once more for all, I will not be accessary to your death, and it is idle to say another word about it."

"Well," said he, "I have now no alternative but to speak out. Is the door shut?" I answered in the affirmative. "Come near me." I approached the bed.

He moved his lips two or three times as if he had been about to speak, but his tongue refused to perform its office; a flush spread over him as he raised himself on one arm, and, looking me steadfastly and sternly in the face, whispered,

"Harry, I HAVE FORGED A BILL."

I forget what exclamation I made. I sat down by the fire, and was silent for some time. I knew that he was watching every motion, but I knew not what to say. I was thankful that he spoke first, though bitterly.

"Well," said he, "you know all, and I suppose are thinking of a decent excuse for shaking me off. And the truth is, Harry, though you should go this instant, I shall not blame you."

"You wrong me," I said; "but what on earth could have tempted you to such an act of madness?"

"What could tempt me? Do you recollect the night we were at Mallet's, some months ago, when I won eight hundred pounds from young Denson? You won from him yourself, Harry. I thought he was rich. He left the table that night not worth a farthing. A fortnight afterwards, I learned that his boy was lying dead in his house, and he had not the means of burying him; that his wife was distracted, and that he was starving. At that moment there was an execution or some such thing going on in the house for L.1000. What could I do? I had not the money. I had been a cause of his ruin. I forged a bill upon old Denham for L.1500, and gave Denson the money. I expected to have been in funds long before this, but have been disappointed. The bill is due on the 13th—you see I am a correct man of business—and unless it be taken up to-day, all must come out to-morrow; and you remember the fate of Dr Dodd—it will be mine. Now, will you lend me a hand?"

"With all my heart," said I, "but how? I have not half the money."

"God bless you, Harry. I'll get the money. But then I must make another confession." "To whom?" said I. "To my sister Jane, Lady Dashley."

"Will Lady Dashley give you money?" "Will she not, and the honour of the family at stake? Come, assist me to rise."

I did get him out of bed, and his clothes on. He fainted once, and I gave up all for lost; but he recovered, and his resolution was as strong as ever. I had almost to carry him to the coach, and, when seated there, had to support him from falling. By the time we had approached Lady Dashley's, he rallied; and though I trembled for the result, he went out firmly, but deadly pale, and walked into the house. I was left in no enviable state. A quarter of an hour passed away, and no tidings; another quarter had nearly been measured, when a servant came out and requested me to walk in. I was shown into a parlour where Bromely was lying on a sofa. His sister, Lady Dashley, was at a writing-desk, and evidently dreadfully agitated; there was no time for salutations; she advanced to meet me.

"You know this dreadful business. Here is a draft on Coutts for the amount. I know there is not so much, but I daresay they will not refuse; at all events you must try. Hasten; let me know the moment you get the business finished."

Bromely was too much exhausted to go with me. I bolted into the coach, gave the driver a sovereign to drive with all the speed he could—presented the cheque at Coutts's; it was shown to one of the partners. I was in a dreadful state of suspense; but it was passed. I got the money, and drove at equal speed to the bank at which the bill was payable. I alighted, and, for the first time, hesitated. I was in a state of considerable agitation, and I must appear calm to prevent suspicion. After pausing a few minutes to recover myself, I walked calmly into the telling-room of the bank, and asked as coolly as possible for Mr Denham's bill.

There was no such bill. I recollected in an instant that it was due only on the morrow. I mentioned this, and added that it would be obliging if they would take payment of the bill to-day. It was got and paid, and in my possession. My feelings must have betrayed me when I had the fatal document in my hand, for the clerk did look suspicious. However, it *was* in my possession, and I was again at the coach in an instant. Driving with the former rapidity, I was at Lady Dashley's door in a twinkling. I rushed up stairs, and found the parties as I had left them. Neither had power to utter a syllable.

"There is the bill," said I, putting it in the fire.

I never witnessed such a relief to two human beings. It is impossible to record the lady's thanks and Bromely's gratitude. I got him to his lodgings. He was dreadfully ill for months, and raved continually of bills, and banks, and felony, but he recovered.

HE HAS NOT TOUCHED CARD NOR DICE-BOX SINCE.

TRAITS OF SPANISH MISRULE.

SECOND ARTICLE.

IT is now a little more than three hundred years since Cortes, with a legion of Spanish soldiers, vanquished the country in North America, now called Mexico; and during the whole of this period civilisation can hardly be said to have made the smallest advances. Mexico forms a large and beautiful country, lying on the south-west of the United States, and possessing a fine line of sea-coast on the inner part of the Gulf of Mexico. The population amounts to about 9,000,000 of persons, composed of the following classes or races: 4,000,000 of native Indians, the descendants of the original owners of the soil; 2,500,000 Mestizos, or offspring of Spaniards and Indians; 150,000 Creoles, or pure offspring of Spaniards; 100,000 mixed Negro and Indian races; 100,000 Negroes; 10,000 Spaniards; and about 100,000 strangers, including English, and citizens of the United States. It is thus seen that the Indians and Mestizos compose the chief part of the community.

The primary object of the Spaniards throughout the period of their possession of the country, was to aggrandise themselves and the mother country at the expense of the natives. The enlightenment and improvement of the condition of the various Indian races do not appear ever to have engaged their attention. A church was planted, and immense power conferred on its functionaries, but this circumstance was not of the slightest use as regards the moral elevation of the people. Recent travellers in Mexico speak of the condition of the Indian races as being of the most abject kind. One observes, "they are at the lowest degree of intellectual degradation; and the grossest ignorance, superstition, and consequent vice, are the natural result." "The moral condition of the mixed breed," observes the same writer, "is more depraved, and crimes against the community are more frequently committed by them." We formerly mentioned, that the prevailing feature of all countries settled by the Spanish and Portuguese, is the insecurity of life and property. This is amply manifested in Mexico. Tudor describes one of the roads near the capital as presenting a "dismal succession of murder-crosses, principally formed of sticks, and some few deeply cut in the bark of the trees. Several of them were adorned with flowers, while others were surmounted with inscriptions imploring the prayers of the passing traveller for the wretched victims sent headlong into eternity (by robbers) on the very spot where they stood."

Nothing can exceed the grandeur of the churches in Mexico; they surpass in splendour most of the European places of public worship, St Peter's at Rome not excepted; and at the same time, no description can convey an adequate idea of the ignorance and superstition of the people. Latrobe, a late traveller, observes on this subject, "The poor Indian is distinguished by his sandal'd foot, miserable attire, and subdued air. He at least seems to have gained nothing by the change of masters. How should he? He was the slave of the few, now he is the slave of the many. If the Spaniard did little to raise the character of his conquered vassal, the Mexican does less, if possible, to instruct the darker skin whom he pretends to consider politically as his equal, but whom in fact he always treats as his inferior. They are as they ever were—governed by the priests, and kept in utter ignorance. They supply the market with fruits, water, and vegetables."

The following anecdote, illustrative of the general superstition of the people, is given by the same writer: "Some time since, two English dray-horses were procured by a European resident in Mexico, and unshipped at Vera Cruz—colossal, big-boned, muscular animals, compared with which the Mexican breed were but shelties. They may have found their long voyage disagreeable, but they were doomed to find their land journey to the capital yet more so. Wherever they passed, there was a perfect ferment among the populace. The heretical horses!—there was no possibility of smuggling them through the country, or of concealing their unfortunate lineage. They were every where regarded with detestation. They and their grooms were loaded with maledictions at Vera Cruz—pelted at Jalapa—execrated and pelted at Perote—execrated, pelted, and stoned, with might and main, at La Puebla de los Angeles—and hardly escaped with their lives to be repelted and restoned on their arrival at their journey's end. There, however, they arrived; but for any use they were to the possessor, they might as well have been peaceably employed in starting casks in London among their fellow heretics, biped and quadruped; for they had to be confined to their stable morning, noon, and night, such was the tumult excited by their appearance and character. At length the possessor was fairly driven to bow to popular opinion. There is a certain church in Mexico, of which I have omitted to note down the patron saint, but I know that you leave it a little to the left hand as you approach the Garita on the road to San Augustin. To this church, from time immemorial, it has been the custom of the country for the inhabitants of the city and adjoining valley to bring their domestic animals for baptism by the hands of the priest; the popular belief being, that, till this is done, they do not belong to the Catholic church, and cannot possibly prosper. And here, at the proper time, in company with many animals of less pretension, came the two English dray-horses. They were regularly sprinkled, the fee was paid to the Cura, and from that time being considered as *Christianos*, they were allowed to hold up their heads, and perform their labours without molestation."

Since the period of the revolution in Mexico, and the expulsion of the Spanish authorities, the functionaries of religion have been greatly diminished in number, and in many respects treated with contumely. Mr Edward remarks, that there are now few or no Spanish monks in the country, but that "the sons of Creoles embrace the profession, as a wealthy, indolent mode of life; for monks have few restraints. They go out any where, frequenting even gambling-houses, theatres, and places of amusement. Their morals are very low: thus they are despised. The Creoles and Indians are wavering in their former respect, and even in their religious belief. Nothing can better show the state of the public mind on this score, than the fact, that books against the Catholic religion are openly printed and read even by the monks. Every body laughs at them, and the monks join in the laugh."

Frightful as is the picture of moral depravity which Mexico exhibits, it is less shocking than that of Brazil, a country settled by Portuguese. M. Arago, a French traveller, who lately visited Rio Janeiro, the capital, thus speaks of the system of slavery which is there openly carried on:—"I have mentioned the negro slaves to you, but I have not told you that the slave-trade is still permitted in Brazil. Rio contains one hundred and twenty thousand souls, five-sixths of whom are purchased slaves. Fifty vessels are engaged in the slave-trade: I have seen one of these arrive. The idea of these unfortunate wretches crowded together, devoured by vermin, exposed to all sorts of diseases and privations, wrings my heart, and fires it with indignation against a government, which thus traffics with the lives of so many thousands of individuals, because their colour differs from that of its own subjects. How painful soever it may be to visit the place where they are sold, I will overcome my repugnance; and while I behold them, I will drop at least a tear over their fate.

In a damp, dirty, pestiferous room, open on all sides, are huddled together men, women, and children, naked, bent down with misery, who are forced to sing when commanded, or to remain absolutely motionless, upon pain of receiving twenty lashes. Ribbons are tied round their necks; they are taught to make grimaces; they are sometimes burned with a red-hot iron to impose upon the purchaser, who, from the marks which he sees, supposes that the poor creatures have had the small-pox. There for whole months they await the decision of their fate. A customer enters—it is a monk; I know him by his hypocritical look. He casts an eye over the room, which he presently leaves dissatisfied, and comes into that where I am. Here is a number of females, some of them with infants at their breasts. The monk pauses; he desires a young girl to rise; she advances trembling, walks, runs, holds up her head, shows her teeth. 'How much for this?' 'Six quadruples.' 'She has a very large foot.' 'Your lordship will be satisfied with her.' 'But consider only, six quadruples; it was but yesterday that a colleague of mine bought one at this very place for a great deal less.' The bargain is struck; the poor girl casts a last painful look at her companions in misfortune, and walks off before her master, to change her way of life, without having reason to hope for a mitigation of her sufferings.

In the street of Vallonga, there are at least twenty marts for the sale of negroes: there is no street in the city where so much traffic is carried on. These slaves are in general dull and reserved; there are others, of whom it might be said that they rejoice in their chains. They are brought from the coast of Africa. Those who are shipped at Angola are marked on the breast with a large R, and in general tatooed. These belong to the governor. The others are bought at Mozambique and Madagascar. Those of Mozambique have the incisive teeth sawed, and brought to a point. Those of Madagascar are tatooed, and have very regular and well-executed designs on the shoulders and over the whole back. They all subsist on manioc-flour and blows; the allowance of the latter is too great, that of the former sufficient.

It is still considered problematical whether the negroes are men or brutes; they are employed as the first, but beaten like the latter. They are nearly naked, and I have seen negresses without any apparel whatever. When a negro is purchased, his master throws over him a white tunic, bedizened with gold lace, and has him baptised, under the idea that this ceremony is sufficient to make a Christian of him.

A slave who attempts to escape is flogged, and round his neck is put an iron ring, to which is attached a short sword, with the point turned towards his shoulder; and this collar he continues to wear till his master thinks fit to take it off. I have seen two negroes whose faces were covered with tin masks, in which holes were made for the eyes. They were thus

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punished because their misery had induced them to eat earth for the purpose of putting an end to their existence. 'You must go and sell this,' says a master to his slave; 'and you must bring me home such or such a sum:' unfortunately he cannot obtain the sum required, let him run about crying his wares as long as he will. On his return he is cruelly beaten, and the barbarian by whose command this punishment is inflicted, has not, perhaps, during the interval, taken *two vintens* (two-pence) in his superb shop. How atrocious!

A Portuguese, lately going along a narrow path, met a negro, who stepped aside to let him pass; not satisfied with this, he ordered the slave to leap the ditch; the poor fellow muttered an excuse, and screwed himself up still closer. The Portuguese struck him with his cane; enraged at this treatment, and unable to contain himself, the black gave his assailant a blow on the head and ran away. The Portuguese discovered where he lived, signified to his master his wish to buy the negro, offered so large a sum that the owner could not resist the temptation, and the wretched slave expired the following day under the lash. These acts of cruelty are not punished here. Are not such traits characteristic of a nation?

I was waiting the other night for the ship's boat, and walking on the pier, which is contiguous to the royal palace. A negro, carrying before him a basket of fruit, called from time to time, with a low and trembling voice, to the passengers to induce them to buy his commodities. It was late: I asked what custom he hoped to get at ten o'clock at night. 'No great deal, sir,' replied he; 'most likely none at all, but I shall stay a little longer.' 'Why so?' 'Why should I not put off my punishment as long as I can?' Have you any doubt that he was soundly beaten that night?"

MR LOCKHART'S LIFE OF SIR WALTER SCOTT.

THE first volume of this work will have been so long in the hands of the public before the present sheet appears, that any testimony of the pleasure with which we have read it may well be spared. Without the least desire to characterise it generally, we would only intrude the remark, that the account of the early years of its distinguished subject furnishes what appears to us as in many respects a singularly fine model of youthful character—a character good and amiable, without the least tinge of any kind of puritanism, steadying high fancy and feeling with the most perfect good sense, dutiful to all, and yet strikingly manly and independent. After presenting a brief memoir written by Scott himself in 1808, and which comes down to the time of his entering at the bar, Mr Lockhart proceeds to throw all possible additional light upon this period of his existence, from the anecdotes and letters of the friends under whose eyes it was passed. Mrs Cockburn, author of the fine song of the Flowers of the Forest, thus writes of the poet and novelist when six years old—

"I last night supped in Mr Walter Scott's. He has the most extraordinary genius of a boy I ever saw. He was reading a poem to his mother when I went in. I made him read on; it was the description of a shipwreck. His passion rose with the storm. He lifted his eyes and hands. 'There's the mast gone,' says he; 'crash it goes!—they will all perish!' After his agitation, he turns to me. 'That is too melancholy,' says he; 'I had better read you something more amusing.' I preferred a little chat, and asked his opinion of Milton and other books he was reading, which he gave me wonderfully. One of his observations was, 'How strange it is that Adam, just new come into the world, should know every thing—that must be the poet's fancy,' says he. But when he was told he was created perfect by God, he instantly yielded. When taken to bed last night, he told his aunt he liked that lady. 'What lady?' says she. 'Why, Mrs Cockburn; for I think she is a virtuoso, like myself.' 'Dear Walter,' says aunt Jenny, 'what is a virtuoso?' 'Don't ye know? Why, it's one who wishes and will know every thing.' Now, sir, you will think this a very silly story. Pray, what age do you suppose this boy to be? Name it now, before I tell you. Why, twelve or fourteen. No such thing; he is not quite six years old. He has a lame leg, for which he was a year at Bath, and has acquired the perfect English accent, which he has not lost since he came, and he reads like a Garrick. You will allow this an uncommon exotic."

Though a bad school student, he often gained places in consequence of the miscellaneous knowledge he had picked up in his extensive early reading.

"His school-fellow, Mr Claud Russell, remembers that he once made a great leap in consequence of the stupidity of some laggard on what is called the *dult's* (dolt's) bench, who being asked, on boggling at *cum*, "what part of speech is *with*?" answered, "*a substantive*." The rector, after a moment's pause, thought it worth while to ask his *dux*—"Is *with* ever a substantive?" but all were silent until the query reached Scott, then near the bottom of the class, who instantly responded by quoting a verse of the book of Judges:—"And Samson said unto Delilah, If they bind me with seven green *withs* that were never dried, then shall I be weak, and as another man."

At another he accomplished a rise in the class by an expedient which certainly we might call less than honourable, if such boy tricks were to be judged seriously, but which we shall give anyhow in his own words, as reported by Mr Samuel Rogers—

"There was a boy in my class at school, who stood always at the top, nor could I with all my efforts supplant him. Day came after day, and still he kept his place, do what I would; till at length I observed that, when a question was asked him, he always fumbled with his fingers at a particular button in the lower part of his waistcoat. To remove it, therefore, became expedient in my eyes; and in an evil moment it was removed with a knife. Great was my anxiety to know the success of my measure; and it succeeded too well. When the boy was again questioned, his fingers sought again for the button, but it was not to be found. In his distress he looked down for it; it was to be seen no more than to be felt. He stood confounded, and I took possession of his place; nor did he ever recover it, or ever, I believe, suspect who was the author of his wrong. Often in after-life has the sight of him smote me as I passed by him; and often have I resolved to make him some reparation; but it ended in good resolutions. Though I never renewed my acquaintance with him, I often saw him, for he filled some inferior office in one of the courts of law at Edinburgh. Poor fellow! I believe he is dead; he took early to drinking."

His appearance and manners when attending the writing-school of a Mr Morton, are thus beautifully described by Mrs Churnside, a surviving school-fellow—

"He attracted the regard and fondness of all his companions, for he was ever rational, fanciful, lively, and possessed of that urbane gentleness of manner, which makes its way to the heart. His imagination was constantly at work, and he often so engrossed the attention of those who learnt with him, that little could be done—Mr Morton himself being forced to laugh as much as the little scholars at the odd turns and devices he fell upon; for he did nothing in the ordinary way, but, for example, even when he wanted ink to his pen, would get up some ludicrous story about sending his doggie to the mill again. He used also to interest us in a more serious way, by telling us the *visions*, as he called them, which he had lying alone on the floor or sofa, when kept from going to church on a Sunday by ill health. Child as I was, I could not help being highly delighted with his description of the glories he had seen—his misty and sublime sketches of the regions above, which he had visited in his trance. Recollecting these descriptions, radiant and not gloomy as they were, I have often thought since, that there must have been a bias in his mind to superstition—the marvellous seemed to have such power over him, though the mere offspring of his own imagination, that the expression of his face, habitually that of genuine benevolence, mingled with a shrewd innocent humour, changed greatly while he was speaking of these things, and showed a deep intenseness of feeling, as if he were awed even by his own recital. . . . I may add, that in walking he used always to keep his eyes turned downwards as if thinking, but with a pleasing expression of countenance, as if enjoying his thoughts. Having once known him, it was impossible ever to forget him. In this manner, after all the changes of a long life, he constantly appears as fresh as yesterday to my mind's eye."

To this may appropriately be added an anecdote conveyed by his tutor, the Rev. Mr Mitchell—

"I seldom had occasion all the time I was in the family to find fault with him even for trifles, and only once to threaten serious castigation, of which he was no sooner aware than he suddenly sprung up, threw his arms about my neck, and kissed me. It is hardly needful to state, that now the intended castigation was no longer thought of. By such generous and noble conduct my displeasure was in a moment converted into esteem and admiration; my soul melted into tenderness, and I was ready to mingle my tears with his. Some incidents in reference to him in that early period, and some interesting and useful conversations I had with him, then deeply impressed on my mind, and which the lapse of near half a century has not yet obliterated, afforded no doubtful presage of his future greatness and celebrity."

In his days of adolescence we find him displaying, in its full fruit, the noble generosity of nature of which his boyhood, almost his infancy, had shown the bloom. Mr Lockhart adverts to a series of letters addressed to him, relative to an affair of one of his early friends, of which the full details, for reasons of delicacy, cannot be given.

"I feel it my duty," says the biographer, "to record the strong impression they have left on my own mind of high generosity of affection, coupled with calm judgment, and perseverance in well-doing on the part of the stripling Scott. To these indeed every line in the collection bears pregnant testimony. A young gentleman, born of good family, and heir to a tolerable fortune, is sent to Edinburgh College, and is seen partaking, along with Scott, through several apparently happy and careless years, of the studies and amusements of which the reader may by this time have formed an adequate notion. By degrees, from the usual licence of his equal comrades, he sinks into habits of a looser description—becomes reckless, contracts debts, irritates his own family almost beyond hope of reconciliation, is virtually cast off by them, runs away from Scotland, forms a marriage far below his condition in a remote part of the sister kingdom; and, when the poor girl has made him a father, then first begins to open his eyes to the full consequences of his mad career. He appeals to Scott, by this time in his eighteenth year, 'as the truest and noblest of friends,' who had given him 'the earliest and the strongest warnings,' had assisted him 'the most generously throughout all his wanderings and distresses,' and will not now abandon him in his 'penitent lowliness of misery,' the result of his seeing 'virtue and innocence involved in the punishment of his errors.' I find Scott obtaining the slow and reluctant assistance of his own careful father—who had long before observed this youth's wayward disposition, and often cautioned his son against the connection—to intercede with the unfortunate wanderer's family, and procure, if possible, some mitigation of their sentence. The result is, that he is furnished with the scanty means of removing himself to a distant colony, where he spends several years in the drudgery of a very humble occupation, but by degrees establishes for himself a new character, which commands the anxious interest of strangers; and I find these strangers, particularly a benevolent and venerable clergyman, addressing, on his behalf, without his privacy, the young person, as yet unknown to the world, whom the object of their concern had painted to them as 'uniting the warm feelings of youth with the sense of years'—whose hair he had, 'from the day he left England, worn next his heart.' Just at the time when this appeal reached Scott, he hears that his exiled friend's father has died suddenly, and after all intestate; he has actually been taking steps to ascertain the truth of the case at the moment when the American dispatch is laid on his table. I leave the reader to guess with what pleasure Scott has to communicate the intelligence that his repentant and reformed friend may return to take possession of his inheritance. The letters before me contain touching pictures of their meeting—of Walter's first visit to the ancient hall, where a happy family are now assembled—and of the affectionately respectful sense which his friend retained ever afterwards of all that he had done for him in the season of his struggles. But what a grievous loss is Scott's part of this correspondence! I find this correspondent over and over again expressing his admiration of the letters in which Scott described to him his early tours both in the Highlands and the Border dales: I find him prophesying from them, as early as 1789, 'one day your pen will make you famous'—and already, in 1790, urging him to concentrate his ambition on a 'history of the clans.'"

NEW SPECIES OF HAT.

A HAT of a new species has lately been invented by a hat-maker of Paris. The leading principle is, cloth stretched upon a frame of wire. To a brim of ordinary felt is attached a ring composed of a stout slip of steel, of exactly the circumference of the head. Another similar ring, of the desired size of the crown, is connected with the first by means of four double wires curving slightly inwards, and jointed in the middle. By folding inwards at the joints, the intermediate pieces of wire allow of the two rings coming nearly together, in which case the whole mechanism looks like one ring with four radii pointing towards the centre. To bring the frame to its full stretch, a third and moveable ring is introduced, which, being pressed downwards against the curved wires, falls into a series of notches, all of which are upon one plane, where it rests: thus, the whole frame is opened out as far as it will go; when it in some degree resembles, in structure, the well-known species of epergne used for supporting custard at table. It will easily be conceived, that, if a crown be fitted upon the second of the rings, and the space between that ring and the brim filled with a piece of cloth of the requisite kind, a complete hat is formed. It is only further necessary to mention, that, to an interior lining of rather more than the ordinary depth, a false crown is attached, and this crown, again, to the *third* ring, so that the only process required for causing the crown to sink into the brim, is to pull in a particular way at a certain part of the false crown, till the ring is jerked out from the notches, when the whole collapses into a bulk little greater than that of a common round supper plate. The utility of such a hat for travelling, for attending large assemblies, and many other purposes, must be obvious. The invention, after being honoured with several distinguished marks of approbation in Paris, and coming into general use in that city, has been patented with some improvements by a respectable hat-making firm in Edinburgh, who, in constructing it, employ a cloth of deep silk pile, of great fineness, manufactured in France, and which gives the hat a superior appearance to those of the beaver kind. In the important matters of lightness and durability, the mechanical hat, as the French call it, has an advantage over the ordinary kinds, and in Edinburgh it is retailed at a lower rate. We are hopeful, however, that, ere long, as the means for carrying on the manufacture become improved, it will be possible to produce it at a cost little more than half of the present price of a good hat.

SPIDERS THE BEST BAROMETER.

The manner in which spiders carry on their operations, conformably to the impending changes of the atmosphere, is simply this:—If the weather is likely to become rainy, windy, or in other respects disagreeable, they fix the terminating filaments, on which the whole web is suspended, unusually short; and in this state they await the influence of a temperature which is remarkably variable. On the contrary, if the terminating filaments are made uncommonly long, we may, in proportion to their length, conclude that the weather will be serene, and continue so at least for ten or twelve days. But if the spiders be totally indolent, rain generally succeeds; though, on the other hand, their activity during rain is the most certain proof that it will be only of short duration, and followed with fair and constant weather. According to further observations, the spiders regularly make some alterations in their webs or nets every twenty-four hours; if these changes take place between the hours of six and seven in the evening, they indicate a clear and pleasant night.

ECONOMY.

"A slight knowledge of human nature will show," says Mr Colquhoun, "that, when a man gets on a little in the world, he is desirous of getting on a little farther." Such is the growth of provident habits, that it has been said, if a journeyman lays by the first five shillings, his fortune is made. Mr William Hall, who has bestowed great attention on the state of the labouring poor, declares he never knew an instance of one who had saved money coming to the parish. And he adds, moreover, "those individuals who save money are better workmen; if they do not work better, they behave better, and are more respectable; and I would sooner have in my trade a hundred men who save money, than two hundred men who would spend every shilling they get. In proportion as individuals save a little money, they husband that little; and there is a superior tone given to their morals, and they behave better for knowing they have a little stake in society."

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THE FALLACY THAT OLD BIRDS ARE NOT TO BE CAUGHT WITH CHAFF.

THE older the bird, the more he flatters himself that he is worth catching. He is easily caught, were it worth while; but you have caught nothing, perhaps, when you have got him. Chaff is too valuable, too precious, to be expended wastefully; and because you are not so silly as to throw powder away, he conceives himself to be shot-proof. As nobody tries to catch him, he fondly persuades himself that his own exceeding cunning secures him from capture. "Take me if you can," chirps he, and goes dodging about the woods as though a flock of golden vultures were pursuing him. He is quite safe. He has not the felicity of being in peril. The young condor, pressed even by vulgar appetite, will not do him the honour of dining upon him. His toughness and antiquity are sure safeguards. He is only not captured because there is nothing captivating about him. But if, by any chance, he hath a tail-feather fit for plucking, or a bone worthy the distinction of being picked, then is your old bird in imminent danger, for you may catch him when you like with half a pinch of chaff. The tender foxling, not arrived at the maturity of slyness, who never tasted chicken of his own stealing, shall take him without a ruffle of his plumage—only by pronouncing its dingy brown to be rich crimson. What flocks of old birds flutter about in society, all sure that they never shall be caged, and all safe until a lure is laid for them! But the longer they live, the less chance have they of avoiding the trap. The older they grow, the slenderer the means of escape. The starched matron is fain to put faith in the compliment which, in her day of youth and grace, she knew to be nonsense. She is now only half-handsome, and can no longer afford to think her eyes less brilliant than she is told they are. She must make up, by exaggerating what is left, for the loss of what is gone. She is not now in a condition to call a fine remark rank flattery; she is obliged to believe, in self-defence. If her mirror will not admit of this, she has other resources; she has sage counsel, admirable judgment, perfect knowledge of the world. Admire these, and, with a dignity which you call Siddonian, she confesses that she is yours. You have only to convert the compliment to her beauty at twenty into a tribute to her sagacity at fifty-five. Tell her she is not to be imposed upon, and you impose upon her effectually. Admire her penetration, and you will not find her impenetrable. The old bird devoutly believes he is no goose. The grey-headed adventurer, who would not marry at twenty-six because the lady had only a little beauty and five thousand pounds, is taken in, thirty years afterwards, by a plain widow with a large family instead of an estate. The moralist of threescore is ruined in three months by a *figurante*; and a man of refinement, fastidious up to seventy-two, "marries his cook." Not caught with chaff! The old bird sniffs it afar off. Not a curate in the kingdom that does not once a-week unite in holy wedlock threescore-and-ten to fourscore, or fourscore to onescore. The ancient gentleman who has seen the world, who is profoundly experienced, and much too deep to be the dupe of an age so shallow as this, is to be won by an admiring glance at the brilliancy of his knee-buckle; praise his very pigtail, and you may lead him by it. None are so easily taken in as the "knowing ones." The knowing one is generally an egregious ninny. The man who loses his last shilling at Doncaster, is no other than he who was sure of winning; who could prove by his betting-book that he *must* win by backing chaff against the field. He is a fine specimen of the family of the Oldbirds. So is the careful, cautious wight, the original Master Sure-card, the man of many savings, who in his old age falls in love with a loan; who dies in prison from the pressure of foreign bonds, or drowns himself in the New Canal by way of securing what he calls his share. The genuine old bird is a pigeon.—*From a Series of Popular Fallacies in the New Monthly Magazine.*

SHOW OF WASHINGTON'S NURSE.

WE know that Washington, after achieving the independence of the United States, and retiring to private life, did not liberate his slaves. He possessed negro slaves in the shape of salcable property till his death. This circumstance is the only blot that rests on the name of Washington. In Cox and Hobby's Tour in America, the following touching account is given of the public exhibition or show of an old negress, once belonging to Washington's family:—"Slavery presented itself to our view in one of the most extraordinary and offensive forms of which it is possible to conceive, while we were in Providence. The name of Washington, the father of his country, is revered by every patriot of every land. But we here saw, still living, the very woman who nursed his infancy; and she has worn the chain and badge of slavery from that hour till the present time! We blushed for America, and were oppressed with a sickness of the very heart, to think that for more than a hundred years after the infant hero had been pillowed in the bosom of this stranger, Joyce Heth should have remained a slave. We were ready to ask, when we visited her, where are the sensibilities of a people who can tolerate so gross an outrage upon every soft and holy feeling, as to allow this living mummy, this breathing corpse, to be dragged through the country, exhibited to the idle gaze of strangers, and often exposed to the rude, offensive merriment of thoughtless youth? This mysterious antiquity, whose age we found to be 161 years, ought rather to have been cradled in silk, and nursed, in her second infancy, with all the tenderness with which she watched over one of the greatest of men. She was stolen from Madagascar, and was owned by the father of Washington at the time of his birth. It was evident that her person had been shamefully neglected, since she had sunk into the helplessness of an almost miraculous old age—her nails being suffered to grow till they bent, like birds' claws, and those of one clenched hand penetrated into her very flesh. She was left in the extremest destitution, and would have died in Kentucky, had it not occurred to some keen and shrewd calculator, that something might yet be made by exhuming, as it were, this living relic of a former age, to exhibit as a show! During many months, she had been conveyed from place to place, as the last sands of life were thus running out; and more had been gained than the sum for which Washington's father sold her in 1727, when, as appears in the existing copy of the bill of sale, she was fifty-four years of age. It was often necessary for her to be addressed in the authoritative manner with which a slave is commanded, in order to rouse what remained of vital energy, so as to gratify the curious; but, at other times, she spoke with vivacity. She has been the mother of fifteen children, but all have died before her, excepting two or three grandchildren." This extraordinary woman died about eighteen months ago.

SONNET ON "GLORY."

TRANSLATED FROM THE ITALIAN OF REDI.

Glory, what art thou?—thou for whom the bold
Lays bare his breast to danger; and bright youth
Buries itself 'mongst folios: while with *thee*
E'en Death seems radiant, and beautiful!
What art thou, Glory?—with an equal fate
Peace is the forfeit, all pay down who seek
Or who possess thee. And with grievous pain
Is such acquirement made; yet heavier woe
Attends on those who vainly strive for thee;
What art thou, Glory?—a delicious fraud;—
The offspring of long grief;—a passing breeze;—
Which men seek after, toilsomely, in vain;
A whetstone to mad envy 'mongst the living—
Music to closed ears, amongst the dead;
Thou art, oh Glory! scourge of human pride! E. B.

INTERESTING BOTANICAL EXPERIMENT.

In lately perusing a new work—"Outlines of Human Physiology, by Herbert Mayo," we found the following interesting account of an experiment to determine why the roots of plants shoot downwards:—

It is impossible not to be struck with the close analogy which holds between the phenomena of the irritability and movements of the sensitive plants, and many of the instinctive motions of animals. The discrimination evinced by plants is a subject no less curious. Climbing plants stretch towards objects calculated to support them: a shrub growing upon a wall, when it has exhausted the nourishment which its situation afforded, has been known to drop a long root to the soil below. The daisy, in rank grass, bears a flower upon a long stalk; on a close shaven lawn, its flower is sessile. These and similar instances have been occasionally ascribed to an instinct in plants; it is much more philosophical to suppose, that the growth of plants is determined by physical impressions alone, such as variations of moisture or temperature, and exposure to or deprivation of light; and that nature, instead of imparting sense and perception to plants as their guiding principles, has attained her purpose by another method, having so framed and endowed the vegetable economy in accordance with the circumstances in which it is placed, that the common accidents of the elements and of the seasons are likely to bring it to perfection. Several remarkable examples go to prove the correctness of the preceding views, out of which it may be sufficient to adduce the following:—It is well known that, in whatever position a seed is laid in the ground, the plumule invariably rises towards the surface of the soil, while the radicle, on the contrary, shoots downwards. Upon the hypothesis that physical impressions determine the growth of plants, we should expect to find that gravitation is in this instance the influential cause; or that the growth of the radicle necessarily follows the direction of a mechanical force or tendency to motion, while that of the plumule goes against it. Mr Knight ascertained this solution to be just, by experiments, in which another force was made to supersede, or to co-operate with, that of gravity. Seeds of the garden bean, which had been previously soaked in water, were attached at short distances along the circumference of a vertical wheel, which was made to perform more than one hundred and fifty revolutions in a minute. In a few days the seeds began to germinate. In their growth, the plumule of each tended towards the axis of the wheel, the radicle in the contrary direction. In this case, owing to the vertical rotation of the wheel, the influence of gravity was neutralised; in its place a centrifugal force was substituted, by which the growing seed was influenced exactly as before by gravity. In another experiment, beans similarly prepared were attached to the circumference of a horizontal wheel, which was then set in rapid motion; the result was not less conclusive than in the former instance; the plumule of each seed was observed to grow in a direction upwards and inwards, while the radicle tended downwards and outwards, that is to say, in the diagonal of the two forces, by both of which, according to the hypothesis, it should have been blindly influenced. From these and similar instances, it appears reasonable to conclude, that the vital endowments of plants are limited to two; namely, irritability, and some modification of chemical affinity. What an immeasurable interval between *their* mode of existence and that of animals!

HYDROSTATIC BED.

It is well known that the support of water to a floating body is so uniformly diffused, that every thousandth part of an inch of the inferior surface has, as it were, its own separate liquid pillar, and no one part bears the load of its neighbour. Reflecting on this fact, Dr Arnott was led to infer, that if a person were laid upon the surface of a bath, over which a large sheet of the waterproof India rubber cloth was previously thrown, the pressure would be so uniform over the whole body, that no one part could possibly suffer more than any other part, and consequently that one who had already suffered from inequality of pressure, as always happens to bed-ridden people, especially when the constitution has been debilitated from whatever cause, would, on being placed on such a couch, be immediately relieved of the pains and other disagreeable consequences of long confinement to even the softest bed; and the result showed the correctness of his reasoning. A lady who, after her confinement, had passed through a combination of diseases, low fever, jaundice, &c., rested so long in one posture that mortification came on, sloughs formed, inflammation also occurred, terminating in the formation of abscesses. She was watched with the most affectionate assiduity, and every expedient adopted for her comfort that could be devised. She was placed upon the bed contrived for invalids by Mr Barl, with pillows of down and air, and out of the mattress of which, portions were cut opposite to the sloughing parts. In spite, however, of all endeavours, the mischief advanced, the chief slough enlarged, another slough and a new abscess were produced, and her life was in imminent danger. No sooner, however, was she laid upon the hydrostatic bed, than she was instantly relieved; sweet sleep came to her; she awoke refreshed; she passed the next night much better than usual; and on the following day all the sores had assumed a healthy appearance. The healing from that time went on rapidly, and no new sloughs were formed; the down pillows were needed no more. It is impossible, indeed, to convey an idea of the comfortable support afforded by means of this bed to those who have not experienced it. So strongly did this impress the mind of an able and pious clergyman, that he was led to remark, "How great is the goodness of God, that puts it into the hearts of men to provide such comforts for his creatures!!" But though we cannot communicate the feeling of comfort to our readers, we can easily give them a description of the bed itself, and recommend them to make a trial of it. Let them imagine, then, an ordinary bed—on which is laid a wooden trough, a foot deep, lined with zinc or lead, the same size as the bed, filled with water to the depth of about six inches, over which is placed a sheet of the India rubber cloth, upon which again is placed a suitable mattress, ready to receive its pillow and bed-clothes—and they will have a tolerable idea of what is meant by a hydrostatic bed, the only difference between it and a common bed being the substitution of water for the canvass or spars on which the mattress is usually placed. It will naturally suggest itself to every individual, that some plan must be adopted in order to prevent the water escaping from under the India rubber cloth. This is effected by merely fixing it very firmly to the edges of the trough all round, nailing it, and filling up all the crevices by means of white lead, or other cement. The cloth being of such a size as would suffice to line the trough were it empty, leaves ample room for free and easy motion when half filled with water, which is done through an aperture near the top—the water being again drawn off when required by a stopcock at the lower extremity. The trough, instead of being placed upon an ordinary bed, may be, and in fact has hitherto been, made the bed itself, resting on four supports, one at each corner, like an ordinary bed.—*Newspaper paragraph.*

GENERAL STATE OF STATISTICS.

It appears, that, in manhood, when one person in 100 dies annually, two are constantly sick. Calculating from this datum and the yearly mortality of England and Wales, the total number constantly disabled by sickness will be at least 600,000 persons; and if the same proportions be extended to Scotland and Ireland, 1,130,000. Some tables prepared from the statistics of the Portsmouth Dock-yard, give these results:—"In the year, one man in six is seriously hurt—two in five fall ill. Each man on an average has an attack of illness, either spontaneously, or caused by external injury, once in every two years; and at an average each disease lasts fourteen days." And from returns from other yards, it would seem that the sick time of the dock-yard labourers is seven to eight per cent. of the lifetime. The elaborate returns of the East India Company's labourers give a lower proportion.—*M'Culloch's Statistics.*

SINGULAR HARE HUNT.

A person shooting last winter on Mount Lebanon, when near the summit, on the side of a deep declivity, put up a hare, which took a downward course, and which he immediately shot; but the impetus of running caused her to roll over several times. The snow stuck to the skin, and formed a ball, which increased every turn. Dragged down by its own weight, which kept augmenting, it rolled to the foot of the mountain, and was so large and so hard, that the chasseur was obliged to call some peasants to "cut it open with their axes and spades to get puss out of her shroud."—*Sporting Magazine.*

REMARKABLE CIRCUMSTANCE.

Under this head, the Philadelphia Courier gives us the following wonderful snake story:—"There is now residing in the vicinity of Tenth and Callowhill streets, a man who, four years ago, while drinking at a spring, swallowed a small snake, which still remains in his stomach, and has grown so large as to become exceedingly distressing and annoying. He has firmly resisted all efforts to coax or drive it from its, no doubt, comfortable lodgings. The poor man recently endeavoured, by refraining from eating for two or three days, to starve the reptile out, but it ascended his throat, and almost produced suffocation, till he was glad to commence eating again, when the afflicted patient could distinctly feel the pertinacious intruder busy devouring his feast! The sufferer is now under the care of several physicians, to whom he has expressed a desire to be opened, for the purpose of dislodging the enemy; but they have objections against this mode of attack, until they have tried to kill the animal, by introducing some liquid which has been prepared, and which they are obliged to pass down the patient's throat through a quill. We shall watch with interest the result of this singular affair, and let our readers know its termination. We have read of a snake being dislodged from the human stomach by fasting a short time, and holding the mouth over a bowl of boiled milk. We are not aware that it has been tried in this case.

FROGS.

When the animal is about six weeks old, the hind legs appear, and, in about a fortnight, these are succeeded by the fore legs. Not long after, the form is completed, and then it ventures upon land. They now change their vegetable for animal food, of worms and slugs. The structure of the tongue is admirably adapted for seizing and securing their prey. The root is attached to the fore part of the mouth, so that, when unemployed, it lies with the tip towards the throat. The animal by this contrivance is enabled to bend it a considerable distance out of the mouth, and swallows larger animals than could be conceived. They appear in immense numbers. Ray states that acres are covered with them. Hearne says, in Hudson's Bay they are frozen, and the limbs may be broken like a stick without any apparent sensation in the animal: they soon, however, revive with heat; but, if frozen again, they die. Their organs of respiration are curious; their two nostrils are in the upper part of the head; they are always seen with the mouth shut. The mouth seems to form a sort of bellows, of which the nostrils are the air-holes. Frogs live on the land the greater part of the year, and do not retire to the water till the cold nights of October, when they retreat, for the winter, to the bottom of stagnant pools. They arrive at full age in about five years, and are supposed to live about twelve or fifteen. They are so tenacious of life, that they will continue to live, and will even jump about, several hours after their heads have been cut off. The hind legs of frogs are fricasseed, and their fore legs and livers put in soup, on the continent. The edible frog is considerably larger than the common frog, and, though rare in England, is common in Italy, France, and Germany. They are brought from the country to Vienna, three thousand or four thousand at a time, and sold to the great dealers, who have conservatories for them. There are only three great dealers in them at Vienna. They are caught at night, by means of lights and nets, or hooks baited with worms: in Switzerland, by long rakes, with close-set teeth, which are thrown into the water, and drawn suddenly out again. Bull-frogs make a loud noise. When alarmed, they leap to a surprising distance: when full grown, three yards, which, in proportion to their size, is about four times as far again as a man can leap. A cruel wager was made by the American Indians, to prove that a bull-frog, having the advantage of two leaps, would beat their swiftest runner. This was effected by having the race in the direction of a pond, and burning the poor frog's tail.—*Newspaper paragraph.*

PRECEDENCE TO A BULLET.

General Meadows, equally renowned for his wit and bravery, being on a reconnoitering party in the Mysore country, a twenty-four pound shot struck the ground at some distance from the General, and was passing in such a direction as would have exposed him to danger, had he continued his route. Quick as lightning he stopped his horse, and pulling off his hat very gracefully, as the shot rolled past, good-humouredly said, "I beg you to proceed, sir; I never dispute precedence with any gentleman of your family."

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MR JOSEPH HANSON, THE HABERDASHER.

BY MISS MITFORD.

THESE are good days for great heroes, so far at least as regards the general spread and universal diffusion of celebrity. In the matter of Fame, indeed, that grand bill upon posterity which is to be found in the pages of history and the changes of empires, Alexander may, for aught I know, be nearly upon a par with the Duke of Wellington; but in point of local and temporary tributes to reputation, the great ancient, king though he were, must have been far behind the great modern. Even that comparatively recent warrior, the Duke of Marlborough, made but a slight approach to the popular honours paid to the conqueror of Napoleon. A few alehouse signs, and the ballad "Marlbrook," seem to have been the chief, if not the only, popular demonstrations vouchsafed by friends and enemies to the hero of Blenheim.

The name of Wellington, on the other hand, is necessarily in every man's mouth at every hour of every day: he is the universal godfather of every novelty, whether in art, in literature, or in science. Streets, bridges, places, crescents, terraces, and railways, on the land, steam-boats on the water, balloons in the air, are all distinguished by that honoured patronymic. We live in Wellington squares, we travel in Wellington coaches, we dine in Wellington hotels, we are educated in Wellington establishments, and are clothed from top to toe in Wellington boots, Wellington cloaks, Wellington bonnets, each of which shall further have been severally purchased at a warehouse bearing the same distinguished title.

Since every market-town, and almost every village in the kingdom, could boast a Wellington House or a Waterloo House, emulous to catch some gilded ray from the blaze of their great namesake's reputation, it would have been strange indeed if the linendrapers and haberdashers of our good town of Belford Regis had been so much in the rear of fashion as to neglect this easy method of puffing off their wares. On the contrary, so much did our shopkeepers rely upon the influence of an illustrious appellation, that they seemed to despair of success unless sheltered by the laurels of the Great Commander, and would press his name into the service even after its accustomed and legitimate forms of use seemed exhausted. Accordingly, we had not only a Wellington House and a Waterloo House, but a New Waterloo Establishment, and a Genuine and Original Duke of Wellington Warehouse.

The New Waterloo Establishment, a flashy dashy shop in the Market Place, occupying a considerable extent of frontage, and "conducted (as the advertisements have it) by Mr Joseph Hanson, late of London," put forth by far the boldest pretensions of any magazine of finery and frippery in the town; and it is with that illustrious *store*, and with that only, that I intend to deal in the present article.

His shop displayed, as I have already intimated, one of the largest and showiest frontages in the Market Place, and had been distinguished by a greater number of occupants, and a more rapid succession of failures, in the same line, than any other in the borough.

The last tenant but one of that celebrated warehouse—the penultimate bankrupt—had followed the beaten road of puffery, and announced his goods as the cheapest ever manufactured. According to himself, his advertisements, and his handbills, every thing contained in that shop was so very much under prime cost, that the more he sold, the sooner he must be ruined. To hear him, you would expect not merely that he should give his ribbons and muslins for nothing, but that he should offer you a premium for consenting to accept of them. Gloves, handkerchiefs, nightcaps, gowns, every article at the door and in the window, was covered with tickets, each nearly as large as itself—tickets that might be read across the Market Place; and town's-people and country-people came flocking round about, some to stare and some to buy. The starers were, however, it is to be presumed, more numerous than the buyers; for, notwithstanding his tickets, his handbills, and his advertisements, in less than six months the advertiser had failed, and that stock, never, as its luckless owner used to say, approached for cheapness, was sold off at half its original price.

Warned by his predecessor's fate, the next comer adopted a newer and a nobler style of attracting public attention. He called himself a steady trader of the old school, abjured cheapness as synonymous with cheating, disclaimed every thing that savoured of a puff, denounced handbills and advertisements, and had not a ticket in his whole shop. He cited the high prices of his articles as proofs of their goodness, and would have held himself disgraced for ever if he had been detected in selling a reasonable piece of goods. "He could not," he observed, "expect to attract the rabble by such a mode of transacting business; his aim was to secure a select body of customers amongst the nobility and gentry, persons who looked to quality and durability in their purchases, and were capable of estimating the solid advantages of dealing with a tradesman who despised the trumpery artifices of the day."

So high-minded a declaration, enforced, too, by much solemnity of appearance—the speaker being a stout, solid, middle-aged man, equipped in a full suit of black, with a head nicely powdered, and a pen stuck behind his ear—such a declaration, from so important a personage, ought to have succeeded; but somehow or other it did not. His customers, gentle and simple, were more select than numerous, and in another six months the high-price man failed, just as the low-price man had failed before him.

Their successor, Mr Joseph Hanson, claimed to unite in his own person the several merits of both his antecedents. Cheaper than the cheapest, better, finer, more durable than the best, nothing at all approaching his assortment of linendrapery had, as he swore—and his head shopman, Mr Thomas Long, asseverated—ever been seen before in the streets of Belford Regis; and the oaths of the master, and the asseverations of the man, together with a very grand display of fashions and finery, did really seem, in the first instance at least, to attract more customers than had latterly visited these unfortunate premises.

Mr Joseph Hanson and Mr Thomas Long were a pair admirably well suited to the concern, and to each other. Each possessed pre-eminently the various requisites and qualities in which the other happened to be deficient. Tall, slender, elderly, with a fine bald head, a mild countenance, a most insinuating address, and a general air of faded gentility, Mr Thomas Long was exactly the foreman to give respectability to his employer; whilst bold, fluent, rapid, loud, dashing in aspect and manner, with a great fund of animal spirits, and a prodigious stock of assurance and conceit, respectability was, to say the truth, the precise qualification which Mr Joseph Hanson most needed.

Then the good town of Belford being divided, like most other country towns, into two prevailing factions, theological and political, the worthies whom I am attempting to describe prudently endeavoured to catch all parties by embracing different sides—Mr Joseph Hanson being a Tory and High-Churchman of the very first water, who showed his loyalty, according to the most approved fashion, by abusing his Majesty's ministers as revolutionary, thwarting the Town-Council, getting tipsy at Conservative dinners, and going out of his own parish to attend the most orthodox preacher in the borough; whilst the soft-spoken Mr Thomas Long was a Dissenter and a Radical, who proved his allegiance to the house of Brunswick (for both claimed to be amongst the best wishers to the present dynasty and the reigning sovereign) by denouncing the government as weak and aristocratic, advocating the abolition of the Peerage, getting up an Operative Reform Club, and going to chapel three times every Sunday.

These measures succeeded so well that the allotted six months (the general period of failure in that concern) elapsed, and still found Mr Joseph Hanson as flourishing as ever in manner, and apparently flourishing in his trade; they stood him too in no small stead in a matter which promised to be still more conducive to his prosperity than buying and selling feminine gear, in the grand matter (for Joseph jocosely professed to be a forlorn bachelor upon the look-out for a wife) of a wealthy marriage.

One of the most thrifty and thriving tradesmen in the town of Belford was old John Parsons, the tinman. His spacious shop, crowded with its glittering and rattling commodities, pots, pans, kettles, meat-covers, in a word, the whole *batterie de cuisine*, was situated in a narrow inconvenient street, betwixt a great chemist on one side, his windows filled with coloured jars, red, blue, and green, looking like painted glass, or like the fruit made of gems in Aladdin's garden (I am as much taken myself with those jars in a chemist's window as ever was Miss Edgeworth's Rosamond), and an eminent chinaman, his shop itself a picture, with the beautiful and delicate porcelain of Dresden and Sévres, and our own Worcester on the other; that narrow and inconvenient street, situated in the most crowded and oldest part of the town, containing, as so frequently happens, most of the principal shops, and half the wealth of the borough. Many a thriving tradesman might be found in St Anne's Street, and many a blooming damsel amongst the tradesmen's daughters; but if the town gossip might be believed, the richest of all the rich shopkeepers was old John Parsons, and the prettiest girl (even without reference to her father's moneybags) was his fair daughter Harriet.

John Parsons was one of those loud, violent, blustering, boisterous personages, who always put me in mind of the description so often appended to characters of that sort in the dramatis personæ of Beaumont and Fletcher's plays, where one constantly meets with Ernulpho, or Bertoldo, or some such Italianised appellation, "an old angry gentleman." The "old angry gentleman" of the fine old dramatists generally keeps the promise given in the play-bill. He storms and rails during the whole five acts, scolding those the most whom he loves the best, making all about him uncomfortable, and yet meaning to do right, and firmly convinced that he is himself the injured party; and after quarrelling, with cause or without, to the end of the piece, makes friends all round at the conclusion;—a sort of person whose good intentions every body appreciates, but from whose violence every body that can, is sure to run away.

Now, such men are just as common in the real work-a-day world as in the old drama; and precisely such a man was John Parsons.

His daughter was exactly the sort of creature that such training was calculated to produce; gentle, timid, shrinking, fond of her father, who indeed doated upon her, and would have sacrificed his whole substance, his right arm, his life, any thing except his will or his

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humour, to give her a moment's pleasure; gratefully fond of her father, but yet more afraid than fond.

The youngest and only surviving child of a large family, and brought up without a mother's care, since Mrs Parsons had died in her infancy, there was a delicacy and fragility, a slenderness of form and transparency of complexion, which, added to her gentleness and modesty, gave an unexpected elegance to the tinman's daughter. A soft appealing voice, dove-like eyes, a smile rather sweet than gay, a constant desire to please, and a total unconsciousness of her own attractions, were amongst her chief characteristics. Some persons hold the theory that dissimilarity answers best in matrimony, and such persons would have found a most satisfactory contrast of appearance, mind, and manner, between the fair Harriet and her dashing suitor.

Besides his one great and distinguishing quality of assurance and vulgar pretension, which it is difficult to describe by any word short of impudence, Mr Joseph Hanson was by no means calculated to please the eye of a damsel of seventeen, an age at which a man who owned to five-and-thirty, and who looked, and most probably was, at least ten years farther advanced on the journey of life, would not fail to be set down as a confirmed old bachelor. He had, too, a large mouth full of large irregular teeth, a head of hair which bore a great resemblance to a wig, and a suspicion of a squint, for it did not quite amount to that most odious deformity, which added a sinister expression to his countenance. Harriet Parsons could not abide him; and I verily believe that she would have disliked him just as much, although a certain Frederick Mallet had never been in existence.

How her father, a Dissenter, a Radical, and a steady sober tradesman of the old school, who hated puffs and puffery, and finery and fashion, came to be taken in by a man opposed to him in religion and politics, in action and in speech, was a riddle that puzzled half the gossips in Belford. It happened through a mutual enmity, often (it is not saying much for poor human nature) a stronger bond of union than a mutual affection.

Thus it fell out.

Amongst the reforms carried into effect by the Town-Council, whereof John Parsons was a leading member, was the establishment of an efficient new police, to replace the incapable old watchmen. As far as the principle went, the Liberal party were united; but they split upon the rock of detail. It happened that a turnpike, belonging to one of the roads leading into Belford, had been moved by order of the commissioners half a mile farther from the town—half a mile, indeed, beyond the boundaries of the borough; and although there were only three houses, one a beer-shop, and the two others small tenements inhabited by labouring people, between the site of the old turnpike at the end of Prince's Street, and that of the new at the King's Head Pond, our friend the tinman, who was nothing if not crotchetty, insisted with so much pertinacity upon the perambulation of the blue-coated officials appointed for that beat being extended along the high-road for the distance aforesaid, that the whole Council were set together by the ears, and the measure had very nearly gone by the board in consequence. The imminence of the peril saved them. The danger of giving a triumph to the Tories, and reinstating the ancient Dogberrys of the watch, brought the Reformers to their senses—all except the man of tin, who, becoming only more confirmed in his opinion as others opposed it, divided the Council six different times, and had the gratification of finding himself each time in a minority of one. He was about to bring forward the question upon a seventh occasion; when a hint as to a vote of censure for wasting the time of the Board caused him to secede in a fury from the Council, and to quarrel with the whole municipal body, from the mayor downwards.

Now, the mayor, a respectable and intelligent attorney, heretofore John Parsons's most intimate friend, happened to have been brought publicly and privately into collision with Mr Joseph Hanson, who, delighted to find an occasion on which he might at once indulge his aversion to the civic dignitary, and promote the interest of his love-suit, was not content with denouncing the corporation *de vive voix*, but wrote three grandiloquent letters to the Belford Courant, in which he demonstrated that the welfare of the borough depended upon the police parading regularly, by day and by night, along the high-road to the King's Head Pond, and that none but a pettifogging chief magistrate, and an incapable Town-Council, corrupt tools of a corrupt administration, could have had the fatuitous audacity to cause the policemen to turn at the top of Prince's Street, thereby leaving the persons and property of his Majesty's liege subjects unprotected and uncared for, &c. &c. &c.; and as the mayor, professionally indignant at the epithet pettifogging, threatened the editor of the Belford Courant and Mr Joseph Hanson with an action for libel, why, it followed, as a matter of course, that John Parsons considered the haberdasher the only able and honest man in the borough, the champion, if not the martyr of his cause, and one who deserved every thing that he had to bestow, even to the hand and portion of the pretty Harriet.

Affairs were in this posture when one fine morning the chief magistrate of Belford entered the tinman's shop.

"Mr Parsons," said the worthy dignitary, in a very conciliatory tone, "you may be as angry with me as you like, but I find from our vicar that the fellow Hanson has applied to him for a licence, and I cannot let you throw away my little friend Harriet, without giving you warning that a long and bitter repentance will follow such an union. There are emergencies in which it becomes a duty to throw aside professional niceties, and to sacrifice etiquette to the interests of an old friendship; and I tell you, as a prudent man, that I know of my own knowledge that this intended son-in-law of yours will be arrested before the wedding-day."

"I'll bail him," said John Parsons, stoutly.

"He is not worth a farthing," quoth the chief magistrate.

"I shall give him ten thousand pounds with my daughter," answered the man of pots and kettles.

"I doubt if ten thousand pounds will pay his just debts," rejoined the mayor.

"Then I'll give him twenty," responded the tinman.

"He has failed in five different places within the last five years," persisted the pertinacious adviser, "has run away from his creditors, has taken the benefit of the act! You would not give your own sweet Harriet, the best and prettiest girl in the county, to an adventurer, who has been in the Gazette and the Insolvent Court, and who is a High-Churchman and a Tory to boot? Surely you would not fling away your daughter, and your honest earnings, upon a Tory?"

"I'll tell you what, Mr Mallet, or Mr Mayor, if you prefer the sound of your new dignity," broke out John Parsons in a fury, "I shall do what I like with my money and my daughter without consulting you. Go and dictate to your Town-Council and your policemen. Hanson shall have the girl, and your nephew shan't. Go and manage your corporation! For my part, I don't see but the Whigs are as bad as the Tories!—there's little to choose between them. If Hanson is a Conservative and a Churchman, his foreman is a Dissenter and a Radical. He don't pretend to dictate to his elders and wisers; which is more than I can say of some who call themselves Reformers. And, once for all, I tell you that he shall marry my Harriet, and that your nephew shan't. So now, you may arrest him as soon as you like. I'm not to be managed here, however you and your tools may carry matters at the Town-Hall. An Englishman's house is his castle."

"Well," said Mr Mallet, "I am going. God knows I came out of old friendship to yourself, and sincere affection for the dear girl your daughter. As to my nephew, besides that I firmly believe the young people like each other, he is as steady a lad as ever drew a conveyance, and, with what his father has left him, and what I can give him, to say nothing of his professional prospects, would be a fit match for Harriet, as far as money goes. But if you are determined"——

"*I am* determined," roared John Parsons: "before next week is out, Joseph Hanson shall be my son-in-law. And now, sir, I advise you to go and drill your police." And the tinman retired from behind the compter into the interior of his dwelling (for this colloquy had taken place in the shop), banging the door behind him with a violence that really shook the house.

"Poor pretty Harriet!" thought the compassionate chief magistrate, "and poor Frederick too! The end of next week! This is only Monday—something may turn up in that time—we must make inquiries. I had feared that it would be earlier. My old tetchy friend here is just the man to have arranged the marriage one day, and had the ceremony performed the next. We must look about us." And full of such cogitations, the mayor returned to his habitation.

On the Thursday week after this conversation, a coach drew up about eight o'clock in the morning at the gate of St Anne's churchyard, and Mr Joseph Hanson, in all the gloss of bridal finery, newly clad from top to toe, smiling and smirking at every instant, jumped down, followed by John Parsons, and prepared to hand out his reluctant bride-elect, when Mr Mallet, with a showy-looking middle-aged woman hanging upon his arm, accosted our friend the tinman.

"Stop!" cried the mayor.

"What for?" inquired John Parsons; "if it's a debt, I've already told you that I'll be his bail."

"It is a debt," responded the chief magistrate, "and one that luckily he must pay, and not you. Three years ago he married this lady at Liverpool. We have the certificate and all the documents."

"Yes, sir," added the injured fair one, "and I find that he has another wife in Dublin, and a third at Manchester. I have heard, too, that he ran away with a young lady to Scotland; but that don't count, as he was under age."

"Four wives!" exclaimed John Parsons, astounded; "why, the man is an absolute Turk! But the thing's impossible. Come and answer for yourself, Joseph Hanson."

And the tinman turned to look for his intended son-in-law, but, frightened at the sight of the fair claimant of his hand and person, the bridegroom had absconded, and John Parsons and the mayor had nothing for it but to rejoin the pretty Harriet, smiling through her tears, as she sat with her bride-maiden in the coach at the churchyard gate.

"Well! it's a great escape! and we're for ever obliged to you, Mr Mayor. Don't cry any more, Harriet! If Frederick was but here, why, in spite of the policemen——. But a week hence will do as well; and I am beginning to be of Harriet's mind, that even if he had not had these three or four wives, we should be well off to be fairly rid of Mr Joseph Hanson, the puffing haberdasher."

SONG-BIRDS.

In a former number we gave a brief description of the habits and attractions of the more common songsters of Britain—of the finch-tribe, the linnet, and the canary, which last may now be termed a native of the country, though as yet the little warbler breeds only in an artificial state. The subject, however, would be incomplete, were we to pass by without a similar notice the nightingale, the starling, and other feathered vocalists, more celebrated for their powers even than those formerly described.

The darling of the poets, the nightingale, merits our first attention. Being found only in the southern parts of England, and even there only from April till September, in which latter month it wings its way to warmer climes, the appearance of the nightingale is familiar to very few in our island. The body of the bird is about six inches long, the upper part being of a rusty brown, tinged with olive, and the under parts of a pale ash colour, nearly approaching to white. In the beginning of May the nightingale prepares to make its nest, which it builds with leaves, straw, and moss. As if aware that "its wood-notes wild" would make its nest an object of eager research, this most famous minstrel is especially careful in the selection of a secret spot for its dwelling. At the extremity of branches overhanging a pool, or at the bottom of the thickest bushes, the nest is placed, and is rarely discovered even by the prying eyes of schoolboys. This is not to be regretted; for the proud-hearted bird cannot brook confinement, and in a cage its song loses half its charms. Four or five eggs are laid by the nightingale, and owing to the cold climate, all of these seldom come to maturity.

As its name in our language implies, this bird is a singer of the night, beginning its song in the evening, and generally continuing, with little intermission, till the dawning of the following day. In point of brilliancy and delicacy of execution, the music of the nightingale is held to have no parallel among the melodies of the woods. Indeed, so exquisitely finished is the song, that some have regarded it as in this respect faulty, from the laboured and artificial character thrown over it. The notes are mellow and varied, and have, in the opinion of the majority of naturalists and poets, a cast of touching melancholy. All the ancient poets, at least, entertained this belief, and they fabled accordingly that a lady, sad not without cause, was converted by the pitying gods into a bird, which weeps over its sorrows everlastingly. This bird was the nightingale, and modern poets still apply to the sylvan minstrel the term of Philomel, derived from that lady's name.

After having held undisputed possession, for ages, of the throne of song, the nightingale has in recent times found a rival, and, in the eyes of many naturalists, a superior, in the mocking-thrush of the New World. It is only in the quality of their *native* notes that these vocalists will justly bear a comparison; in other respects, the powers of the mocking-bird far transcend those of its rival, as the following description by Wilson will suffice to show:—"The plumage of the mocking-bird, though none of the homeliest, has nothing gaudy or brilliant in it, and, had he nothing else to recommend him, would scarcely entitle him to notice; but his figure is well proportioned, and even handsome. The ease, elegance, and rapidity of his movements, the animation of his eye, and the intelligence he displays in listening and laying up lessons from almost every species of the feathered creation within his hearing, are really surprising, and mark the peculiarity of his genius. To these qualities we may add that of a voice, full, strong, and musical, and capable of almost every modulation, from the clear mellow tones of the wood-thrush, to the savage scream of the bald eagle. In measure and accent he faithfully copies his originals; in force and sweetness of expression he greatly improves upon them. In his native groves, mounted on the top of a tall bush or half-grown tree, in the dawn of the dewy morning, while the woods are already vocal with a multitude of warblers, his admirable song rises pre-eminent over every competitor." The bird's *native* notes are bold and full, and varied seemingly beyond all limits; but such is his fondness and power of imitating other songsters, that, "while he is exerting himself (continues Wilson), a bystander destitute of sight would suppose that the whole feathered tribe had assembled together on a trial of skill, each striving to produce his utmost effect, so perfect are his imitations. He many times deceives the sportsman, and sends him in search of birds that are not within miles of him, but whose notes he exactly imitates: even birds themselves are frequently imposed on by this admirable mimic, and are decoyed by the fancied calls of their mates; or dive with precipitation into the depths of thickets, at the scream of what they suppose to be the sparrow-hawk." In confinement, the mocking-bird shows the variety of his powers still more forcibly. He barks like a dog, or brings that animal to him by imitating the master's whistle; he crows like a cock, and cackles

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like a hen, or, by squeaking like a hurt chicken, rouses the parent hen to desperation; he mews like a cat, imitates the creaking of a wheelbarrow, and is capable of learning and executing pieces of music of considerable length. Wilson's account of the mocking-bird thus concludes: "Both in his native and domesticated state, during the solemn stillness of night, as soon as the moon rises in silent majesty, he begins his delightful solo, and serenades us the live-long night with a full display of his vocal powers, making the whole neighbourhood ring with his inimitable melody."

Though Wilson gives the palm to the mocking-bird over all other songsters, many naturalists of Europe have stood up firmly for the old supremacy of the nightingale, upon the grounds, that, varied as the song of the American bird is, its native notes are inferior in softness, delicacy, and plaintive tenderness, to those of its rival. The opinion of the ingenuous, as well as ingenious, Audubon, may, we conceive, be depended upon, as the conscientious conclusion of one well acquainted with both birds. "Without prejudice," says he, "I have no hesitation in pronouncing the notes of the European Philomel equal to those of a *soubrette* (untaught girl) of taste, which, could she study under a Mozart, might perhaps in time become very interesting in her way; but to compare her essays to the finished talent of the mocking-bird, is, in my opinion, quite absurd." Upon the same principle which led Burns to exclaim, in reference to the simple hymns of his country, "Compared with these, Italian trills are tame!" the chaste song of the nightingale may seem to many more agreeable than that of the mocking-bird with all its range and variety; but with regard to the comparative skill and talents of the vocalists, we believe, with Audubon, that the palm must be assigned to the songster of America. The same ornithologist remarks, that although he has heard of mocking-birds carrying their powers of imitation so far as to mimic the human voice, he has never met with any instance of the display of this faculty. Nightingales are also said to have shown this faculty in some instances, but the accounts are generally discredited.

The vocal powers of birds, as indeed of all animals, depend on certain parts, or organs, situated in the windpipe. In birds, the upper part of the windpipe, termed the *larynx*, is divided into two sections, the under one named the *glottis* inferior, and the upper the *glottis* superior. The use of these parts will be best understood by comparing the whole vocal organ to a bag-pipe, in which the lungs constitute the pouch, or bag, and supply the wind; the lower glottis being the reed or mouthpiece which produces the simple sound, and the upper glottis representing the finger-holes which modify the simple sound into an infinite variety of notes. The *epiglottis*, or valve which closes the top of the windpipe in man and other animals, is wanting in birds. These organs or parts of the windpipe, which bear the name of the upper and lower glottis, are dilatations, or cavities, partly formed of bone, and clothed both internally and externally with strong muscles. In the best singing-birds these muscles are in greatest strength, as might be expected, since it is upon the tension, and the variations in shape, produced by these, that the vibrations in the larynx depend. "The larynx of the nightingale," says Father Kircher, "is extremely fibrous and muscular. We therefore conclude that all the power and variety of the bird's notes are produced from the innumerable fibres by which the glottis is either tightened or relaxed, projected forwards or drawn inwards, and bent in every direction." The structure of the larynx of the mocking-bird is also remarkably muscular. In both birds the windpipe is very wide in proportion to their size, which gives to their notes a soft and mellow tone.

Having thus noticed the structure of the vocal organs in birds, we may, before concluding, allude briefly to the *natural* purposes for which the endowment of voice or song apparently was conferred on them. Most naturalists are inclined to admit that the voice or song of every bird has an intelligible meaning to another of the same species; or, at least, that the call to a mate, the invitation to unite when dispersed, the moan of danger, the cry of alarm, the notice of food, &c., are expressed by each species in distinct and definite sounds, intelligible to all belonging to the same tribe with the utterer. Every one who has paid the slightest attention to domestic birds, will admit that they have separate cries for every important occasion. So is it with wild birds. A sea-mew "skreighs" frequently, without attracting notice from other sea-mews, but, on discovering a sandbank good for fishing, it utters a peculiar note, which speedily brings numbers of its own species to the spot. The same cry is heard by the heron, but makes no impression; a proof that each species has a separate language.

The mocking-bird and nightingale tribes, doubtless, have a communicative vocabulary of this kind; but attentive observation of their habits would lead us to believe that they use their vocal powers frequently from pure love of the employment. "The mocking-bird (says Wilson), during the exhibition of his powers, when alone and in confinement, spreads his wings, expands his tail, and throws himself around the cage in all the ecstacy of enthusiasm, seeming not only to sing, but to dance, keeping time to the measure of his own music."

A story of a contention between a nightingale and a musician was a favourite with the elder poets of England, several of whom have given versions of it, but none comparable, for harmony and grace, with that presented in the play of "the Lover's Melancholy," by Ford. As this is one of the finest pieces of poetry in our language, and by no means generally known, we shall here introduce it:—

(Menaphon and Amethus.)

Men. Passing from Italy to Greece, the tales
Which poets of an elder time have feign'd
To glorify their Tempe, bred in me
Desire of visiting that paradise.
To Thessaly I came; and living private,
Without acquaintance of more sweet companions,
Than the old inmates to my love, my thoughts,
I day by day frequented silent groves,
And solitary walks. One morning early
This accident encounter'd me: I heard
The sweetest and most ravishing contention,
That art [and] nature ever were at strife in.
Amet. I cannot yet conceive what you infer
By art and nature.
Men. I shall soon resolve you.
A sound of music touch'd mine ears, or rather,
Indeed, entranced my soul: As I stole nearer,
Invited by the melody, I saw
This youth, this fair-faced youth, upon his lute,
With strains of strange variety and harmony,
Proclaiming, as it seem'd, so bold a challenge
To the clear choristers of the woods, the birds,
That, as they flock'd about him, all stood silent,
Wond'ring at what they heard. I wonder'd too.
Amet. And so do I; good! on—
Men. A nightingale,
Nature's best skill'd musician, undertakes
The challenge, and for every several strain
The well-shaped youth could touch, she sung her own;
He could not run division with more art
Upon his quaking instrument, than she,
The nightingale, did with her various notes
Reply to: for a voice, and for a sound,
Amethus, 'tis much easier to believe
That such they were, than hope to hear again.
Amet. How did the rivals part?
Men. You term them rightly;
For they were rivals, and their mistress, harmony.—
Some time thus spent, the young man grew at last
Into a pretty anger, that a bird
Whom art had never taught cliffs, moods, or notes,
Should vie with him for mastery, whose study
Had busied many hours to perfect practice:
To end the controversy, in a rapture
Upon his instrument he plays so swiftly,
So many voluntaries, and so quick,
That there was curiosity and cunning,
Concord in discord, lines of differing method
Meeting in one full centre of delight.
Amet. Now for the bird.
Men. The bird, ordain'd to be
Music's first martyr, strove to imitate
These several sounds: which, when her warbling throat
Fail'd in, for grief, down dropp'd she on his lute,
And brake her heart! It was the quaintest sadness,
To see the conqueror upon her hearse
To weep a funeral elegy of tears;
That, trust me, my Amethus, I could chide
Mine own unmanly weakness, that made me
A fellow-mourner with him.
Amet. I believe thee.
Men. He look'd upon the trophies of his art,
Then sigh'd, then wiped his eyes, then sigh'd and cried:
"Alas, poor creature! I will soon revenge
This cruelty upon the author of it:
Henceforth this lute, guilty of innocent blood,
Shall never more betray a harmless peace
To an untimely end:" and in that sorrow,
As he was pashing* it against a tree,
I suddenly stept in.
Amet. Thou hast discours'd
A truth of mirth and pity.

CATHERINE OF RUSSIA.

After the death of Peter I., or Great, of Russia, which occurred in 1725, that extensive empire was for a considerable period distracted by the claims of his successors to the throne, there being no settled constitution defining the rights of the respective branches of the royal family, and no law to enforce the constitution, supposing it had existed. First the widow, then the grandson of the great Peter, held the imperial sceptre for five years, when his race was proscribed, and Anne, daughter of Ivan III., elder brother of Peter, became autocratrix of all the Russias for ten years. Her infant grand-nephew, Ivan IV., succeeded in 1740, but in a few months himself, his father, mother, brothers, and sisters, were all immured in dungeons, and Elizabeth, the daughter of Peter the Great, brought back the succession to the youngest branch of the house of Romanov. Elizabeth, a powerful and vicious woman, reigned till her death in 1762, leaving a son, Peter, as her successor.

Peter III., as this personage was entitled, had been for several years married to a lady the daughter of a petty German prince. The bride had been previously called Sophia Augusta, but on marrying Peter she took the name of Catherine. At the death of Elizabeth, this pair had a son, Paul, whom many expected would have been preferred as a successor instead of his father. Peter III. has been represented as a weak man, but apparently only with the view of raising a prejudice against him. Not being a tyrant or a sanguinary warrior, but a lover of peace and an admirer of the reforms and arrangements of Frederick the Great of Prussia, it was easy to represent him as a fool. One of his first acts was more well-intentioned than judicious: he issued an imperial ukase or law, by which the vast possessions of the church were seized and distributed among the different bodies of the clergy, upon a more moderate and equitable scale. This proceeding cost him his throne and his life. A powerful combination of parties took place, with the design to strip him of his authority, and to place his wife Catherine in his stead. At length, on a certain day, the conspiracy came to a head, and measures had been so well taken, that Catherine met with universal proffers of service. She addressed the soldiers, telling them "that the Czar had intended to put her to death that very night, together with her son; and having no other means of escaping death, she had resolved to put herself into their hands." All swore to die in her defence. She was escorted to the church of Kasan, where the Archbishop of Novgorod consecrated her Empress of all the Russias, under the name of Catherine II. In the course of the day she was absolute mistress of St Petersburg, and of all the forces it contained.

Peter III. was unable to make any resistance to his ambitious wife. Upon receiving the news of the revolution, he attempted to fly to Cronstadt and gain the fleet, but that fortress was already secured, and he was denied admittance. He returned to Oranienbaum, and on the approach of the empress with her army, was induced to surrender himself, upon a promise of being sent to Holstein in safety. He was carried to Peterhoff, where the insults and execrations of the soldiers met him on every side. Being carried into a room, he was violently stripped, and left for some time standing on his bare feet with only a shirt on. He was afterwards favoured with an old morning-gown, and in this state Count Panin waited upon him with an act of renunciation, in which he was made to bear ignominious testimony to the incapacity which had marked his short reign. This was signed on the 29th of June 1762, six months after his accession. That same evening he was conveyed to Ropscha, a small palace about twelve miles from Peterhoff. Here the wretched Czar in some degree recovered his spirits, under the idea that he would be immediately sent to his native duchy of Holstein. Vain expectation! In Russia there is but one step from the throne to the dungeon or the cord of the assassin. Alexius Orloff and a party of officers, favourites of the empress, arrived at Ropscha, and, with every circumstance of barbarity suited to such ferocious minds, strangled the deposed monarch.

Thus, by the murder of her husband, was Catherine raised to the Russian throne, a stranger, a foreigner, without a vestige of right or title save that of force. But detestable as were the means by which she gained the sceptre, it is nevertheless undoubted that she afterwards displayed an admirable capacity for ruling, and that her reign was brilliant, and fortunate for her new country. In her earliest intercourse with foreign nations, she assumed a haughtiness and superiority, which her vast power and uninterrupted good fortune permitted her ever after to maintain. The peace Peter III. had made with Prussia she confirmed, but it was in such a manner that she seemed to pardon the transgressions of Frederick rather than to negociate with an equal. But Poland was the country where she made her will most imperiously felt. The death of Augustus III., king of Poland, in 1763, left that throne vacant. The diet was summoned to elect a monarch, but its decision was not intended by Catherine to be free. Her armies marched to Warsaw, and her ambassador ordered the diet to elect Poniatossky, who had been favourably known to the empress when she was grand-duchess. No person could be more distasteful to the Poles, since his birth was far beneath that of many of the nobility. A remonstrance was made to Catherine, that Stanislaus Poniatossky was unfitted for the throne of Poland, since his grandfather had been intendant of a little estate belonging to the Princes Lubomirsky. "Though he had been so himself," replied she, "I would have him to be king, and king he shall be!" The Poles found it expedient to submit to so truly autocratic a declaration, and her choice was confirmed.

But in spite of the impression her government made abroad, she felt her throne insecure at home. The rage of the soldiers against Peter was appeased by his dethronement, but his assassination excited the sympathy not only of their rough hearts, but of the whole population. The clergy became even more exasperated against Catherine than they had been against Peter; for, now that her purpose of exciting odium against the late Czar, on account of the adjustment of church property, was served, she knew too well that the measure was of advantage to the empire to rescind the regulation. She answered the clergy with a rare assurance, that respect for her late husband prevented her from altering his acts. The Archbishop of Novgorod retired from court with precipitation, and an universal ferment arose in the minds of the people. The eyes of many were at this time cast upon the unfortunate Ivan, who, since he was saluted emperor in the cradle, had been kept a close prisoner in a dungeon of the Castle of Schlüsselburg. It was well known that Peter had visited him, and had entertained serious thoughts of declaring him his successor, to the prejudice of his son. He thus became the object of jealousy to the imperial court, and it was sufficient to seal his fate. The circumstances of his murder are enveloped in mystery; but on the evening of the 15th July 1764, a commotion was excited at his prison door, and whilst he was flattering himself that some change for the better was at hand, he was hewed down by the two officers on guard in his dungeon, to prevent him, as was asserted, from being freed by the insurgents. Thus another emperor was sacrificed to the ambition of Catherine, and she now seemed secure from every internal shock. But at this period of her life direful feelings of remorse haunted her, and so restless was her agony at times, that she forsook her bed, and even her palace, in the middle of the night, and attempted to fly from her own thoughts.

From the terrors of a guilty conscience she sought refuge in labours, which, if they had originated in simply good intentions, would have entitled her to unmingled approbation. The jurisprudence of the country was in a

* That is, *dashing*.

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most deplorable state, and its administration was in the last degree venal and corrupt. The latter evil she remedied, by making the judges independent, and increasing their salaries. She then drew up her famous Instructions for a Code, which were submitted to a convention of deputies from the different nations under her sway. They were received with tumultuous applause, but one of the most beneficent recommendations, the affranchisement of the degraded serfs, gave rise to fierce objections, and was subsequently dropped. Although some of her instructions did not become laws, the spirit of the whole was excellent. Whilst possessing despotic and autocratic power, she recognised no law but that which is founded on justice, her great purpose and design being to form a solid, and not an arbitrary, legislation. In this respect her views were of the most enlarged and enlightened nature; and though she drew largely from Montesquieu as to the fundamental principles which should regulate wise laws, it by no means detracts from her fame that she had the sagacity to render the speculations of the philosopher available for the purposes of the practical legislator.

To education amongst her illiterate and barbarous subjects she was from the commencement of her reign the decided friend. Although Peter the Great had stimulated the Russian empire into a premature greatness, the nation, with the great body of the nobles, still retained its original fierceness and brutality. As is usual amongst an ignorant population, crimes prevailed to a great extent, and Catherine was soon convinced that the mere terror of punishment is insufficient to restrain vicious inclinations. She acknowledged that the only means of diminishing the number of criminals was to disseminate instruction, effectually to establish the principles of sound morality, and to honour those who put them in practice. While legislators have been for ever multiplying laws against vice, they have been too negligent of making institutions in favour of virtue. This error she was determined to avoid; and not only by the brilliant rewards she bestowed on merit and learning, whether native or foreign, but also by her academical institutions, her scientific expeditions, and her own contributions to literature, she gave so powerful a support to mental cultivation in Russia, that the country may be said to date its general civilisation from her accession.

But her labours for the internal improvement of her vast territories did not interfere with her plans for their yet further extension. A war with Turkey broke out in 1768, in the prosecution of which the empress reaped infinite advantages.

Previous to the termination of the Turkish war, that flagrant and diabolical act, the partition of Poland, had taken place. In the perpetration of this enormous robbery, Catherine was the chief participator; and though she was equally guilty with her associates, Joseph II. and Frederick II., she certainly deserves some credit for the humane treatment she vouchsafed to her new subjects, when the atrocious conduct of the courts of Berlin and Vienna is considered. To such of the wretched Poles as were comprised in her division of the spoil, she permitted three months to realise their property, if they declined the benefits of her government; whereas the other partitioning powers did not allow even so miserable a privilege, but confiscated the goods of all who hesitated for an instant to take the commanded oath of allegiance.

From the termination of the war with the Turks in 1774, until its recommencement in 1787, the time of Catherine was sufficiently occupied in completing the internal regulations of her states, in strengthening her influence amongst other powers, and maturing her plans for the entire subversion of the Turkish empire. The new favourite whom she had raised to dignity and wealth, the celebrated Prince Potemkin, kept her mind incessantly bent on this grand enterprise. She formed a close alliance with Austria, that power agreeing to attack the Turks simultaneously with herself, whenever she was ready to strike the blow. Her triumphal procession from St Petersburg to Kerson, where she met the Emperor of Germany, and her solemn assumption of the sovereignty of the Crimea, aroused the suspicions and indignation of the Sublime Porte, and, agreeably to the expectations of Catherine, it declared war against her. Nothing could exceed the joy with which she and her people entered on this war, the almost avowed purpose of which was to drive the Turks from Europe, and to found for her second grandson, Constantine, a new Greek empire at Constantinople. We need not enter into the history of the war which followed. It was successful on every side. The crowning victory was the carrying Ismail by assault, under Suvaroff, when 30,000 persons are estimated to have been butchered by that general and his barbarians. Notwithstanding these victories, Catherine was for once in her life desirous of being at peace with the Turks, the French revolution having excited apprehensions in her, in common with the other sovereigns of Europe. A treaty was signed between the powers on the 9th January 1792, at Jassy, by which Russia gained little beyond a pecuniary indemnification of twelve millions of piastres, which the empress had the extraordinary generosity to forego. In the course of this sanguinary war, the Austrians are estimated to have lost 130,000 soldiers, Russia 200,000, and Turkey 330,000.

If the reputation of Catherine suffered for such acts of unbridled ambition in the eyes of the rest of the world, in those of her own people she appeared crowned with glory. The Russians were fond of repeating that all sprung from the empress herself. Though she had favourites, ministers and generals, yet she was herself the effective ruler in every branch of government. In some respects she lived very simply and methodically, but her private hours were devoted to the foulest vices.

All the projects of this powerful sovereign were at length suddenly arrested. On the 17th November 1796, Catherine breathed her last, after an illness of only a few hours, in the sixty-eighth year of her age, and thirty-fifth of her reign. In Russia, where the benefits of her improvements were observable, she left behind her a name which was almost adored by the people; but when her conduct through life is examined by the historian and moralist, she is justly ranked among the most worthless and criminal of her species. Her private behaviour was licentious and loathsome to the last degree of vileness. She was the cool murderess of her husband, and of his cousin Ivan. She was the despoiler of nations, and the slayer of millions of her fellow-creatures. Since the days of Timour Beg, Europe and Asia had not witnessed the atrocities of such a monster. Her character may be summed up in a few words—She was the greatest female criminal whose life is recorded in the page of history.

She was succeeded on the throne by Paul I., whose vagaries we shall afterwards make the subject of an article.

THOUGHTS ON COMMONPLACE SUBJECTS.

ENGLISH AND FRENCH.

Some writers have observed that there is a strong analogy betwixt the character of the English people and their language. As a people, the English are expert and sagacious managers, and their language is so constructed that it does not hamper them. As far as sentiment is concerned, the French tongue excels the English; but as the English are not a sentimental but a working people, they care little for refinement of terms; they prefer a plain spoken, come-to-the-point language, with which they can tell their mind in the twinkling of an eye. The trick of the English tongue, that which adapts it to a working people, consists in the placing of the adjective before the substantive. This little point alone gives it an immense power, and causes a considerable saving of words, which, by causing a saving of time, is every thing to an Englishman. Just, for instance, see what a cleverness there is in saying the words *steamboat;* an idea is crammed into a single compound word; and as if even that word were too long—cost too much time to write or speak—behold it abridged into the still more smart expression, *steamer*. The French can never match this, because they place their substantives before their adjectives, and must therefore use a small intervening word. Thus, they call a steam-boat a *batteau a vapeur*, or boat with vapour; and a railroad *chemin de fer*, that is, a road of iron. It is clear that the English would never have time to speak in this roundabout way. Observe how tedious is the following expression:—"La fabrication des draps en Belge." We can give this in half the time—"The Belgian Cloth Manufacture." Such is the clumsiness of these modes of expression, that we anticipate that the French will in time adopt a number of English phrases into their language. They have indeed begun to do so. While we were at Paris, a few years ago, we remarked, that, in some of the advertisements stuck on the walls, they used the clipped phrase *stem-bot;* though it is possible this was done partly with the view of catching the eye of the English stranger.

A WORD UPON THE HIGHLAND POOR.

There has been a good deal said lately regarding the destitute condition of the Scottish Highlanders. It seems that many thousands of them have for some time been in a state of almost perfect starvation. Means have very properly been taken to meliorate this dreadful state of suffering, by the contributions of the charitably disposed. But the administration of alms is at the best a miserable mode of relief, and the benefits which arise from it are only temporary. The crust that is given is soon eaten—and what next? It is obvious that quite a different plan must be pursued to eradicate or permanently meliorate the evil. Every writer has given his nostrum on the subject. One recommends a poor law to compel the landed proprietors to support the starving population; and another hints at emigration to America. We beg to give our opinion. In the multitude of counsel there is safety.

When we are told that there are a hundred thousand people, less or more, starving in wretched mud hovels on the barren sea-shores of the Highlands and Islands, we naturally put the question—what business have these people there? Why, we ask, are a hundred thousand human beings quartered in such a sterile, hopeless locality? Perhaps we may be told that they have been born and bred there. But that is no answer. Men are not vegetables: they have the power of locomotion: they have been designed to spread abroad over the earth, and not grow to it like plants. In this, as in thousands of similar instances, the unhappy love of place—a prepossession for a particular locality, is the grand obstacle to social advancement. At the present moment, the person who writes this has been unsuccessfully striving for weeks to procure a particular class of workmen, to whom at least a guinea a-week of wages per man has been offered. The men are not to be had—or those who apply are drunkards, and are therefore unfit for regular employment. Other individuals known to the writer are similarly circumstanced. Advertising is of no use; neither men nor boys are to be obtained. The same want of hands prevails in different large towns and particular districts of Great Britain. Now, it appears to us a most remarkable circumstance, that at some places there should be so much work that it cannot be executed, and at other places there should be a vast number of persons destitute of employment, and almost starving. The surprising thing is, that the people who have no work and no food, do not remove to the places where both work and food are to be procured in plenty, at least where their children would have an opportunity of rising above the condition of paupers. It is the fatal attachment to local situation, which produces this state of things. Many families will rather starve than remove a distance of twenty miles—sometimes, rather than go over a hill to the next town, where comfort predominates. The excuse that they are uncertain of getting employment, is always ready in these cases. The truth is, they are averse to the trouble of removing, or of forming new habits. Hence, the curious fact in statistics, that, although hand-loom weaving was finished as a profession twenty years since, still numbers of young men continue to enter it. They voluntarily embrace a line of life, which yields them only about a shilling a-day, rather than leave the place of their birth to enter other professions which would yield them three shillings a-day. Such is human nature.

It has always appeared to us that, in regard to the Scottish Highlanders, we are too much under the influence of feeling, and too little under that of reason. The romantic circumstances of the people in former and even in present times, seem to unfit us for forming cool judgments respecting what is best for their interests. In a late number of the Statistical Account of Scotland, the inhabitants of large tracts are described as to the last degree poor and miserable, and to the last degree (with few exceptions) pious and contented. We have there the most incontestible evidence that a large population clings to a country in which there is no use for their services (being now chiefly devoted to pasture), and which refuses them, even in ordinary seasons, a proper sustenance; being, in fact, ignorant of any thing better, and perhaps unable of themselves to accomplish a removal. Surely a part of the machinery now at work for educating this forlorn people might be well employed in enlightening them as to the absurdity of their growing up to idleness and misery on their native soil, when they might do better elsewhere. We would also press upon the attention of persons in authority, the propriety of forming some regular system for the gradual removal, under humane regulations, of the Highlanders to the great seats of industry. In the hands of a few active committees, composed of persons engaged in manufacturing pursuits, the process would neither be difficult nor tedious.

THE TWO BLIND FIDDLERS.

Willie Hodge was a quiet, inoffensive man, moving in a very humble walk of life, which he filled with great credit to himself, and with great satisfaction to every body else. His calling was not, perhaps, a very dignified, but it was at least a very honest one. Willie was by profession an itinerant fiddler. He had the misfortune at an early age to lose his eye-sight by the small-pox; and as this calamity, aggravated as it was by poverty, precluded him from competing with the world in any of its more ordinary occupations, he turned his attention to music, as a means of earning a livelihood; and he could not, perhaps, even although he had had his eye-sight, have made a better choice, or one better suited to his genius; for he possessed a natural talent for the musical art, had a correct ear, and an excellent taste.

Thus qualified by nature for the profession which necessity had compelled him to adopt, Willie made rapid progress in the art of handling the bow, and soon became an expert and skilful fiddler. Having attained such a degree of proficiency as he thought might warrant him in making a public appearance, Willie, one evening, fiddle in hand, sought a quiet, retired street, where he believed he should not be known, and there made his debut. It was a successful one. He bagged a brace of sixpences, six brace of penny-pieces, and somewhere about a score of half-pence. Willie went home rejoicing; and enthusiast as he was in his profession, he thought the music of the *clink* in his pocket that night far surpassed the finest tones of his fiddle. From this hour, Willie became a regular public performer, and soon after, a well-known and much admired public character. Besides his street practice, Willie enjoyed a fair share of private employment. He was very frequently engaged for weddings, balls, and other festive meetings, in the environs of Edinburgh; and it was on one of these occasions that Willie became acquainted with Jamie Dowie, a brother in trade and in misfortune; Jamie being also blind, and a fiddler.

The acquaintance of these two worthies first began by Willie borrowing Jamie's rosin, which was given with a frankness and cordiality that at once won Willie's heart. Their intimacy, thus begun, soon ripened into a sincere and ardent friendship. They became inseparable companions, and finally went into a partnership, playing together in the streets, and dividing the benevolence of the public between them. Their fiddles were not more in unison than were the sentiments and dispositions of the fiddlers. In all respects, the harmony between them was perfect, and was most pleasant to behold. If Willie got an invitation in his professional capacity to a merry-making, he was sure, if the thing was at all practicable, to lug in Jamie along with him; and Jamie, when he happened to be the person who was preferred, did the same kind office by Willie. In short, no friendship between two mortal men could be more disinterested or more intense. There was no rivalry, no feeling of jealousy, between them. Willie rejoiced at Jamie's jobs, and Jamie felt no less happiness in Willie's. They assisted each other, too, with the greatest readiness and cordiality, on occasions when remuneration for one only was al-

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lowed, without fee or reward beyond the stray tumblers of porter, or half tumblers of toddy, that were from time to time handed up to them, by way of increasing the energies of their elbows. It is true that on such occasions as those alluded to, the employed party invariably offered the other the half of his earnings; but equally true is it, that this offer was never accepted.

For many years this most exemplary friendship between Willie Hodge and Jamie Dowie continued with unabated fervour; nor, during all that time, had there ever been the slightest difference even of the most temporary nature between them. No quarrel, not an angry word. Some people thought it was too good to last; but those who thought so, knew nothing of the intensity of their feelings—knew nothing of the more than brotherly love that existed between the two blind fiddlers, and the test of years should have satisfied them of the groundlessness of their fears. The occurrence must have been an extraordinary one indeed, that could have divided two such fond hearts. Certes, however, such an occurrence *might* present itself.

Although the street and the dancing-room were the chief marts to which Willie and Jamie brought their music, yet they did not always confine themselves to these fields of operation. They were both possessed of an adventurous and enterprising spirit, and given to occasional speculations in steam and track boat excursions, when they sometimes picked up something considerable; but, as Willie often said, "it was just a lottery, and couldna be depended on. I hae seen us," he would add, when speaking confidentially to a friend, "play frae Port Hopetoun to Lock 16 without turnin' a penny, and at anither time I've seen us bag half-a-croon before we got to Ratho." This state of the case, Jamie, when present, always corroborated. Both Jamie and Willie, therefore, gave a decided preference, on the whole, to the regular, steady business of the street, where the average of their earnings was at once pretty regular, and fair in amount.

One little trait, amongst many, in the friendship of the two fiddlers, was their occasionally retiring after the labours of the evening, and taking a social gill together. No more, however—not a drop; and even this only on occasions of unwonted success.

We have said that there were those who doubted the uninterrupted duration of Willie's and Jamie's love, but we at the same time remarked, as the reader will recollect, that these persons had no good grounds to go upon for any such insinuation. We also admitted, however, that it was certainly quite possible that something might occur to disturb the harmony between them, perfect and long-continued as it had been. In truth, such a circumstance, sorry are we to say it, did occur. The demon of mischief, envious of their felicity, resolved to mar it, but, using no supernatural agency, he set about effecting his diabolical purpose by mere human agency. We will explain.

One night, as Willie and Jamie were performing together in a certain quiet street in the city, a person dressed like a gentleman, and in other respects, to all appearance, really such, came up to them, and after listening for a short time with evident satisfaction to their music, which was indeed very agreeable to hear, he requested them to play a particular air. They complied. The stranger bespoke another and another; and when they had played somewhere about half a dozen tunes, he plunged his hand into his pocket, making a jingling noise with the silver it contained. Then withdrawing his hand—"You play uncommonly well, my good fellows," he said, in a loud and kindly tone of voice; "there's half a crown for you." In the same instant both Willie's and Jamie's hands were at their hats in grateful and respectful acknowledgement of the generous donation. Nothing further passed at the moment. The donor departed, and the musicians resumed their occupation.

It is not known whether it was by accident or design—whether it was the natural emanation of a happy frame of mind, or proceeded from a sense of appropriateness; but the first tune Willie and his colleague played after the annunciation of "there's half a croon for you," was "Money in both Pockets," and it was remarked that all the tunes they played subsequently that night were of a lively character.

The stranger who had thus made the two street minstrels so happy, had, in the meantime, as already noticed, departed; but it was some little time before the fiddlers ascertained this, and not knowing but he was still present, they refrained from making any remarks to each other on the windfall which had just come their way. On becoming aware of his absence, however, which they shortly did by that sort of intuitive tact for which the blind are remarkable, Jamie sidled towards his colleague, and whispered in his ear, "You'll staun a gill, the night, Willie, eh?" Willie smiled, and daresaid he might. "A liberal gentleman yon," remarked Jamie. "Just uncommon," said Willie. "A gude judge o' music," rejoined the former. "Pays weel for't, at ony rate," replied the latter. "What wad ye think, then, o' our drinkin' his health?" inquired Jamie. "Nae objection in the world," replied his colleague; and the two blind musicians slipped their fiddles into their green bags, and taking each other lovingly by the arm, they immediately proceeded to a certain tavern which they were in the habit of frequenting. "Weel, what shall it be?" quoth Jamie. "Ou, I fancy just the auld thing o'er again, Jamie," replied Willie; "a gill o' the best—real Ferintosh."

"Exactly, so be it," said his friend, and in a few seconds the liquor was before them.

Delighted with each other, and in high spirits with the good luck of the evening, Jamie proposed what he called a repetition of the dose, that is, another gill. Willie at once assented, and another gill was accordingly ordered, and in due time discussed; the love and kindness of the parties for each other having in the meantime gradually advanced towards a climax.

Having finished the second gill, and some little desultory conversation after it, Willie proposed that they should "be moving." "It's full time," responded Jamie. "We've had a lang sederunt, but it's been a happy ane. I'll pu' the bell, and ye'll settle the reckonin'."

Willie sniggered and laughed, having reasons of his own for believing that his friend was trying his hand at a joke, and said, "I'm thinkin' ye're better able to settle the reckonin' the nicht than I am, Jamie."

Jamie now smiled in turn, for he also had reasons for thinking that his colleague was jesting with him. "I dinna see how that can be, Willie," he said, "an' you wi' half-a-croon in your pouch." "*Me* half-a-croon in my pouch!" exclaimed Willie with considerable earnestness, perceiving something serious in the tone of his friend's last remark; "the deil a half-croon's in my pouch; but I'm thinkin'," he added with a smile, "I could fin't in yours, Jamie." "My word, but ye wad be clever if ye could," said Jamie somewhat drily; a suspicion, for the first time, of his friend's perfect integrity crossing his mind.

"Ah, ye're a cunnin' shaver," said Willie, laughing. "But come, man, Jamie, settle, for it's gettin' late."

"Settle *you*, Willie," replied Jamie with decided impatience in his manner; "are na ye the purse-bearer? Hae na ye the half-croon?"

"*Me* the half-croon!" exclaimed Willie in amazement. "What do ye mean, Jamie? I suppose ye ken weel eneuch that I have na the half-croon, and as weel do ye ken, I'm thinkin', that ye hae't yoursel. It was to *you* he gied it."

"Are ye in earnest, Willie?" said Jamie, gravely and emphatically. "If no, it's a' weel eneuch between freens; but if ye are, and mean to deny that *you* got the half-croon, ye're no the man I took ye for, but nae better than ye should be—may be no sae gude."

"To be sure I do mean to deny that I got the half-croon," replied Willie, sternly, indignant at the hypothetical insinuation unfavourable to his honesty which his colleague had just made. "*You* got the half-croon, and it's a dirty trick o' you to deny't. I wad na hae expected it o' ye, Jamie."

"What! wad ye mak a rogue o' me?" shouted Jamie fiercely, and at the same time seizing Willie roughly by the collar.

"Ye've made a rogue o' yoursel, man," roared out Willie, returning the hostile grasp of his late friend.

"*You* got the half-croon!"—"*You* got the half-croon!"—"It was *you* got the half-croon!"

"It was *you* got the half-croon," was fiercely bandied from the one to the other for several seconds, while they stood in the belligerent attitude just described.

The choler of both being at length excited to fighting pitch by the provoking iteration of the obnoxious accusation, and their reason being for the time blinded by the effects of the Ferintosh, a deadly struggle ensued. At the first roll of the combatants, the table, with all its furniture of glasses, jugs, and bottles, was sent over with a tremendous crash. At the next, down went Willie with all his weight, and some additional impetus besides, from the nervous arm of Jamie, on his own fiddle, crushing it into a thousand pieces. It had been lying on the seat beside its owner, and down on it, as we have said, Willie had been vigorously planted by his antagonist. On ascertaining that it was *his* fiddle that had perished, Willie loosened his hold of the enemy, and, groping about for an instant, got hold of Jamie's violin, which, having drawn from its receptacle, he grasped by the neck, and in a twinkling battered it to pieces about the ears of its owner.

The bread-winners demolished, the combatants again closed in deadly strife, and hugged and tugged each other with the most relentless ferocity. At this moment two gentlemen who had witnessed the progress of the quarrel, and subsequent combat between the two musicians, from an adjacent part of the room, stepped up to them, and after separating them, inquired what was the cause of quarrel.

"That—that—man—there," said Willie, breathless with agitation and exertion, and pointing to his colleague, "has cheated me o' half-a-croon, or at least o' fifteen pence." "It's a lie, gentlemen—it's a barefaced lie," shouted Jamie in great wrath, and as breathless as his antagonist; "it's him that has cheated *me*. *He* got the half-croon."

"What half-crown?" said one of the gentlemen.

The history of the half-crown was forthwith given by Jamie. "But are you perfectly sure that *either* of you got it?" inquired the gentleman.

The question at once took Willie and Jamie all aback. It was a poser. A new light on the subject instantly and suddenly fell upon them, and the possibility of the real facts of the case for the first time crossed their minds, but they did not immediately admit it.

"Why, I suppose there can be nae doot that ane o' us got the half-croon," said Jamie, rather sheepishly, and with an expression that plainly enough showed that he did now very much doubt it. "I heard the gentleman distinctly say, 'There's half-a-croon for ye,' so that ane o' us maun hae got it, I should think."

"I should doubt it, however," replied the gentleman. "You are two honest-looking men, and would not, I am sure, cheat each other out of a paltry half-crown. *I* rather think you have been tricked—made the subject of a hoax."

The two unfortunate minstrels could no longer withstand the conviction that they had been regularly duped, and a deep sense of shame took possession of their hearts, for having, even for an instant, suspected each other's honesty. The truth, moreover, flashed upon them, that they had in their drunken folly destroyed their fiddles, the sole means of their support. The agony of the poor repentant wretches can hardly be described. Lamenting with bitter tears the folly of their conduct, they sate them down and cried over the shattered fragments of their instruments, declaring they should now have no other resource but in begging from door to door for their subsistence.

The case having attained this dismal juncture, the gentleman who first addressed them, spoke as follows:—"Now, my good fellows, since you have had your pipe out, and seen what a couple of fools you have made yourselves, I have to tell you that it was *I* who played you the trick that has caused all this mischief."

"*You*, sir! and how could you do sic a cruel thing to us?" cried both the lachrymose fiddlers at once. "That I shall tell you," replied the gentleman. "You must know I wished to perform an experiment upon you. Every body told me that your friendship for each other was inviolable; but this I doubted; and so I executed the plan of pretending to give one of you half-a-crown, knowing that you would in all likelihood adjourn to a public-house, where, on this occasion, you would be certain to quarrel. If you had been persons who never took drams, I should never have thought of trying such a scheme. Take my advice, my good fellows: in future, save your money, and have nothing more to do with gills—remember the auld Scots proverb, 'when drink's in, wit's out.'"

"That's ower true a tale," answered Willie; "but what are we to do noo? We'll just be twa objects without our fiddles. Oh, dear sir, we canna stand it, canna stand it; you've been ower sair on us, sir; you shouldna have looten us gang this length."

"Well, Willie, to show you that it's all a piece of fun, though done to try if your friendship would stand the test of whisky, here is a crown-piece for each of you, by way of solatium, and call upon me to-morrow morning, when I will give each of you as good a fiddle as those you have demolished." So saying, and putting the money into their hands respectively, along with a note of his address, the gentleman departed, followed by the thanks of the now happy and reconciled friends.

This lesson was not thrown away upon Willie Hodge and Jamie Dowie. An understanding was established between the two fiddlers that they should never in future take any one's word for giving them half-a-crown, or any other sum, so far as to suspect each other's integrity, far less to engage in mortal combat on such hypothetical grounds. And moreover, what was best of all, they vowed they should henceforth abstain from tasting a drop of spirits, justly observing, that "there was nae saying what might be the consequences; for drink was sure to lead to mischief ae way or another."

TEXAS.—THIRD ARTICLE.

We now approach the difficult task of giving a history of the civil disturbances in Texas. In order to prepare for the narrative we have to present, two articles, entitled "Traits of Spanish Misrule," have been given; and if these have been perused by the reader, it will be comparatively easy to comprehend the merits of the quarrel between the Mexicans and the Texian settlers. Let us commence by a sketch of Mexican management, or rather mismanagement, since the revolution of 1822.

On the dissolution of the connection between Mexico and Spain in 1822, a military adventurer of the name of Iturbide, by force and corruption seized the government, and established himself as emperor by the title of Augustin I. On arriving at supreme power, he found that vast portion of Mexican territory east of the Rio Grande, known by the name of Texas, in the possession of various tribes of Indians, who not only prevented the peopling of Texas, but committed incessant depredations on the Mexican frontier. The previous Spanish authorities, from a wish to keep the country entirely to themselves, had carefully prevented the intrusion or settlement of foreigners or emigrants, except on a limited scale, not worth mentioning; consequently, the country was suffered to remain in a state of nature, for the Spaniards were too idle to encourage any industry, mining excepted, among themselves. Augustin altered this deadening policy. He invited settlers from the United States, by holding forth promises of protection, liberty, and guaranteed civil rights; every colonist was to receive 4428 acres of land in Texas, for which he was to pay thirty dollars. It is asserted by the Americans, that the leading object of Augustin, in holding out these inducements, was the suppression or expulsion of the savages—a result which was finally accomplished by the intrepidity of the immigrants from the States. Soon after the national institute or council, in 1823, had sanctioned these arrangements, Augustin was deposed from

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the supreme authority, and banished. He returned, however, from his exile, and was put to death. This first act in the tragedy of Mexican Independence being over, Victoria was elected president of the republic. During the whole term of service of Victoria, the country was torn to pieces by civil wars and conspiracies, and a great deal of blood was shed. Victoria remained president for only four years, and General Pedraza was elected his successor, but he was dispossessed by violence, and Guerero, in 1829, put in his place. Guerero was scarcely seated before Bustamente, with open war, deposed him, put him to death, and, aided by the military, placed himself at the head of the government. Bustamente continued for a year or two as president or director, when he in turn was dispossessed by Santa Anna, and the country was again plunged into civil war. Thus, fourteen years of Mexican independence present an unbroken history of treachery, crime, and carnage; and connecting this melancholy detail with the character of the Spaniards, who debased the population by their vices and unsettled habits, we can hardly help coming to the conclusion, that the Mexican people have amply demonstrated their incapacity for self-government in the spirit of peace and rational liberty.

In the meanwhile, during the commotions which agitated Mexico, the district of Texas—that beautiful country which we have described in the two former articles—was silently peopling from the United States and other countries, but not with the same favour as at first. The laws relative to the settlement of immigrants were at different times altered, and one law in particular gave great annoyance to those who had been induced to attempt the acquisition of land. This consisted in an intolerant obligation to become Roman Catholics, no other form of religion, and no Protestant place of worship, being allowed in the Mexican States. Accordingly, parties who had been previously married by Protestant clergymen in the States, had to be married over again in Texas, and, what was more, be baptised over again. "One day (says the author of the Visit to Texas) during my stay at San Felippe, I witnessed a ceremony which would have been regarded as a very extraordinary thing in our own country. A Roman Catholic priest had arrived there, on a tour of visitation through the colony, and offered to perform baptismal and marriage ceremonies for all who might wish to receive them. Having been invited where he was to receive applications and administer, at a particular house in the village, I attended with two or three friends to see what would be done. Several settlers from the United States, who I knew had no inclination in favour of Roman Catholicism, and though they had received a Protestant education, presented themselves for baptism. These, as I had reason to believe, acted merely on a wish to recommend themselves to the favour of the government. Several afterwards came with their wives, and were married again, lest the legality of the Protestant ceremony should not be acknowledged, and stand as a bar between their descendants and their estates. The priest stated that he had married about five-and-twenty in one evening in some place in the country, where many colonists had assembled on timely notice being given of his visit." We do not know whether this intolerant practice was formally abandoned or has been quietly set aside.

Whatever were the regulations under which immigrants settled in Texas, it is certain the country received a constant accession of inhabitants, many of whom were sheer adventurers and land-jobbers from the States, regardless of every thing but the prospect of acquiring property in a country possessing such bounteous resources. In 1824, when the Mexican republic was divided into states, by the convention that formed the constitution, the district of Texas, not being sufficiently populous to form a state, was attached provisionally to Coahuila. It was speedily decreed, however, by the same convention, that, whenever Texas was sufficiently populous to become a state, it should be admitted by the general congress. This was a most fatal arrangement for Mexico. Texas soon increased in population from the United States, and, in 1833, finding that its people exceeded the requisite number to compose a separate state, it met in solemn convention, and sent a delegate to the general congress, with a respectful petition, praying to be admitted into the Union. Instead of granting this request, the executive at the capital city of Mexico seized and imprisoned the delegate, General Austin. It is declared by the Mexican party, that this petition was a mere pretext; that it was a scheme to create such an opposition, that the Texians might have a decent excuse to seek their independence. There can be little doubt that the Texians at this period were most desirous of being quit of the Mexican government, which gave them constant annoyance. Shortly after the seizure of Austin, which enraged the Texian settlers, they had further cause for discontent in a project carried into execution by the president. The constitutional general congress, which was decidedly republican and federal, was dissolved in May 1834, by a military order of the president, before the constitutional term expired; a new revolutionary congress was convened in January 1835, and very speedily established quite a new constitution, of a central or consolidated form, by which the separate state governments were in a moment annihilated. Against these proceedings the legislature of Coahuila and Texas protested. That body was immediately dispersed by the troops of the government. A civil war in Texas was the immediate consequence.

It is perfectly obvious, from all the documents which we have before us, that the Anglo-American settlers in Texas seized with avidity every pretence for quarrelling with the Mexicans. But it is equally apparent that the Mexicans behaved with extreme impropriety, and gave far too great room for complaint and rebellion. The Mexican party, though having few Spaniards amongst them, must be viewed as Spanish in almost every moral feature—ignorant, idle, capricious, proud, and tyrannical, having no correct idea of peaceful industry or social advancement. Taking these points of character, in connection with the revolutionary attitude of the country, and the legal, or rather illegal, abolition of local government in Texas, we are not the least surprised that the Anglo-Americans should have attempted, by every means in their power, to separate themselves from a people from whom it was impossible to expect justice or the display of common sense. In looking into the proceedings of the Mexicans, we are glad to find one good point which commands our approbation. This is a law for the total abolition of slavery, which was passed by the republic shortly after the dissolution with Spain. Considering that two-thirds or three-fourths of the population of the Mexican States are Indians, or a mixed race of Indians and Spaniards, with a large number of negroes, the ready manumission of slaves in all parts of the republic was perhaps a matter of necessity; nevertheless, we are bound to give full credit for the act to the governing party, whose conduct in this respect contrasts favourably with the unprincipled system of slavery in the southern states of the North American Union. The Texians, so far from complaining of the abolition of slavery, at first seemed heartily pleased with it; but as the causes of quarrel with the Mexicans accumulated, it began to form a reason for the establishment of an independent government, and, finally, became the grand though secret argument for a thorough separation. How the Texians should have desired the perpetuation of slavery is very obvious, when it is remembered that the country is chiefly suitable for the culture of cotton, sugar, and other articles which have usually been produced by slave labour. Besides, a considerable number of the settlers were from the slave-holding districts in the States, and the producers of slaves in these quarters (slaves being there reared for sale in the same manner that cattle are bred in particular parts of this country) were anxious to establish a market for their exuberant negro stock. It is undeniable that these were among the causes of the animosity which sprung up betwixt the Mexicans and the Anglo-American settlers of Texas; and to these it may be added, that the government of the United States had expressed a desire to purchase the territory, with a view to an extension of the limits of the Union. Thus, though the Mexicans be in the wrong, the Texians are not in the right. The attempt made to hold slaves in Texas was a clear contravention of law, and is in no manner palliated by the shabby trick of giving slavery the aspect of ordinary servitude. "Among the persons on board the vessel who were going to live in Texas (says the author of the Visit), there was an old Tennessean and his wife, with their sons, two young men, who were going 'to hunt land,' as the familiar term is for exploring new regions, for a place to form a settlement. There was also a very intelligent man from Alabama, who had several negroes with him, going to take up his abode in Texas; but he had nothing to communicate concerning the country, except some very favourable general accounts he had received from friends. On reaching New Orleans, he had learnt for the first time that slaves cannot be held in the Mexican territory, and had taken measures which had been recommended to him, to evade the general law of abolition, which does so much honour to the patriots of that republic. He had obtained their attested signatures to articles of indenture, by which they bound themselves to serve him for ninety-nine years. He counselled another man, who was on board with his wife and several slaves, to do the same, and gave them such instructions as were necessary to be regarded to render the pretended agreement binding on the negroes."

ROBBERY OF A POST-LETTER.

The following case of the robbery of a post-letter, and the combination of circumstances which led to a discovery of the delinquent, shows that the tellers of banks may not be out of their line of duty when mixing in public amusements, and keeping all their eyes about them. We quote from a pamphlet on "Post-Office Reform, by Rowland Hill," just published.

"In January 1834, Mr Duncan, a merchant at Liverpool, put into the post-office there a letter addressed to his mother, at Broughty Ferry, in Forfarshire, and containing a Bank of England note for L.50 sterling. The letter, which had been expected on a particular day, not having reached the old lady, she immediately wrote to her son on the subject, and he again, being a mercantile man, and having kept a memorandum of the date and number of the note, immediately wrote to the Bank of England to stop payment of it. Inquiry was also immediately made at the different post-offices of Liverpool, Edinburgh, Dundee, and Broughty Ferry, through all of which it should have passed in the proper course of transmission to the place of destination, but no trace of it could thus be got; no trace as to where it was lost, or even that it had ever been seen in the possession of the post-office at all. All that could be learned was, that the letter containing the bank note had been put into the Liverpool post-office, and had not reached its destination.

It happened, however, that one of the tellers of the Commercial Bank of Edinburgh, being one night in the pit of the theatre, had his attention particularly attracted, by some accidental circumstance, to a person sitting immediately in front of him. The very next day a person, whom the teller at once recognised to be the same individual, although completely altered in dress, being now muffled up in a cloak, and wearing green spectacles, and having a fur cap drawn much over his face, called at the Commercial Bank, and presented to the next teller a L.50 Bank of England note, to be exchanged in Commercial Bank notes, who, according to custom, requested the person to write his name and address on the back. The person then wrote on the back of the note the words, 'Jo. Wilford, College Post-Office,' and the money was paid him. When he had gone, the brother teller, who had been in the theatre, asked, from mere curiosity, who that was, and was shown the signature upon the note. The note was then transmitted in the usual course to the Bank of England, and was there discovered to be the note stolen from Mr Duncan's letter. It was then returned to the Commercial Bank for inquiry, and from the accidental circumstance already mentioned, the teller who had been in the theatre at once recollected the appearance of the person who had presented it. A clue being thus got, it was thought proper first to ascertain whether that person could be found amongst the officers of the post-office at Edinburgh. The teller was therefore placed in a room into which every officer of the post-office, as he arrives in the morning, comes to enter his name in a book, and amongst them the teller there saw the person who had presented the stolen note. This person was J—— W—— N——, who was of course apprehended, and in his lodgings, which were immediately searched, were found the fur cap, the spectacles, and a considerable portion of the Commercial Bank notes, or at least the same description of notes, for they could not be expressly identified. It was also ascertained that N—— had borrowed the cloak in which he had appeared at the bank, and the whole had been so adroitly managed, that if the proof had not been particularly strong against him, he might have broken it down by proof of an *alibi*, as his absence at the post-office had not been noticed, he having quietly slipped out at a favourable moment, run to his lodgings and disguised himself, got the note changed, thrown off his disguise, and returned to his place in the post-office, in an unaccountably short time.

It appeared that N——, who was well connected, and it is understood of previously good character, was tempted to abstract the letter, from having observed the presence and value of the note it contained, when, in the discharge of his duty, he held the letter up to a strong light for the purpose of ascertaining whether it was single or double. He pleaded guilty to the charge of theft, and was sentenced to transportation for life."

PRESENT CONDITION OF BELGIUM.

Of the various countries, foreign to Britain, which are animated with the desire for moral and intellectual improvement, two appear to take the lead, Belgium and the United States of America. France, Prussia, and some other kingdoms, are improving, but their system is based upon or associated with military and police domination—the law of physical force—and no good can possibly come of any country till it centre its energies on qualities of a very different nature. Considering that Belgium has only, within the last few years, risen from a civil war, and only begun the business of self-government, its present flourishing condition is matter of considerable surprise. The principal reason for the advancement of the Belgians appears to be the satisfaction which prevails with respect to their civil institutions. There is little or nothing to dispute about; and the people, not being affected, like the French, with a military frenzy, are busy contriving all possible means of improving the national resources, manufactures, and social institutions.

Belgium has followed the example of England in different arrangements, while in others, particularly as relates to popular education, it has taken a step in advance. In Belgium, all denominations of religionists, Christians and Jews, endeavour to promote a system of national education, and in such a manner as to give no offence to any sect or party. A society is established at Brussels for the promotion of primary and popular instruction, which has issued a considerable number of treatises, at a price inconceivably low; the charge per volume being not more than from twopence to sevenpence halfpenny each. The last published of these useful productions has just reached us, and is entitled, "Almanach Belge pour 1837." This is an exceedingly instructive work. Instead of being, like some of our British almanacks, chiefly a list of office bearers in local institutions, it comprehends a pretty extensive range of statistical information on matters of national importance, as they stood at the beginning of the present year. For the entertainment and edification of our readers, we shall translate a few chapters which seem most interesting.

BELGIAN INDUSTRY.

The superficial extent of Belgium is about twelve thousand English square miles—that is, nearly one-seventeenth of the area of France; the population of the former country amounts to a little more than four millions, or about an eighth part of that of France. But Belgium, though small, possesses an admirable combination of resources of every kind. For ages the possession of it has been disputed by the great powers of Europe; they made it their common battle-field,

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and watered it with their blood, concluding the scene by joining in the determination that the country should belong, not to any foreign state, but to its inhabitants themselves. No part of Europe surpasses Belgium in fertility. Its vast continuous plains, which seldom present to the eye any other elevations than small tree-encircled mounds—monuments under which sleep entombed multitudes of the victims of war; these plains are covered with the finest pasturage and the richest harvests, traversed by excellent roads and deep canals, and strewed with flourishing villages, towns, and cities. In the most westerly provinces, for example, and on the picturesque banks of the Meuse, vineyards are abundantly sprinkled on the hill-sides, and refresh the eye, fatigued with the monotony of the green fields in the plains; presenting thus, at one view, the mingled character of the valley of the Rhone, and the richest cantons of Normandy.

Belgium, however, is not solely agricultural; she possesses beds of coal and iron mines, more valuable than the silver veins of Peru, or the gold of Brazil. The coal-beds of Belgium are superior to any on the European continent. In the basin of Mons, for instance, we find from a hundred and ten to a hundred and twenty strata, or layers of coal, disposed one above another, all workable, and all wrought. The four principal collieries of Mons, Marimont, Liege and Charleroi, yield annually 3,200,000 tons of coal. The whole produce of the French coal-pits, in 1834, did not exceed 2,500,000 tons. Nor is Belgian industry less striking as regards iron than it is with respect to coal. It is remarkable, and somewhat inexplicable, that, to this day, no attempt for the fabrication of iron after the English fashion—that is, by extracting it from the iron-stone or ore—has succeeded in France, though many districts abound in natural advantages for the purpose. In Belgium, on the contrary, the undertaking has been accompanied with the most marked success. Seven years ago (in 1830), some capitalists at Charleroi erected a furnace, where they treated the mineral of the district with the coal which likewise exists there. On the first trial, an article was produced which was greedily bought up by the Parisian iron-founders. From that time till this, establishment has followed establishment so rapidly, that, in the district of Charleroi alone, there are, at this day, twenty-five coke-furnaces in action, producing annually 75,000 tons of metal, without reckoning furnaces where wood is employed. In 1834, the iron produce of all France, from the combustible mineral as in Belgium, amounted only to 47,000 tons; the French castings in the same year, of every kind, amounted in whole to 269,000 tons. So rich in iron and coal, Belgium could not fail to have flourishing manufactures; the woollen stuffs of Verviers, and the flaxen goods of Flanders, are familiar to the world.

It is known that the French manufacturers of linen, woollen, and other soft goods, have declared the impossibility of competing with the manufacturers of Verviers and Ghent, on account of the greater excellence and abundance of the landed produce, lint, flax, &c. of Belgium; and it is also known, that the iron-workers of France have expressed similar opinions, on the ground of the greater fertility of Belgium in coal. Thousands of French operatives, it is said, have been reduced to beggary from these causes. These remarks are confirmed by the conduct of the French government, which, in consequence of the national inferiority in these respects, has judged it impolitic to unite France and Belgium by the strong bond of a commercial association. By this conduct, however, a chance has been left of the accession of Belgium in self-defence to the Prussian commercial league, which is decidedly hostile in its tendency to the interests of France.

The Belgians follow out their manufacturing and mining pursuits with a boldness and energy most honourable to the national character. Six hundred feet was not long ago reckoned an extraordinary depth to push a mine down into the earth; recently, the Belgian miners have penetrated above thirteen hundred feet; they wrestle fearlessly with subterranean torrents, and with steam-engines raise their waters from their hidden sources. With the lamp of Davy, they defy the treacherous air-damp, which has involved so many in instantaneous destruction. Not less active and industrious are those among the labouring classes of Belgium, whose lot it is to toil in the eye of day.

While the French are building senseless monuments, the Belgians are busy raising structures for manufacturing industry, such as fabrics for the reception of furnaces, plating or boring machines, or forges. One capitalist of Belgium has been known to erect, for the convenience of his own individual business, more buildings than the French artillery destroyed at Antwerp. The establishment of Seraing, near Liege, extends, in regular buildings, for a quarter of a league (three quarters of an English mile). On the side opposite the Meuse are situated the mines, from which issue the mountains of coal, to be converted into coke. Next to these are the great round towers, sixty feet high, and fortified with iron, from the mouths of which flames are continually darted as from a crater. One of these furnaces has been in action for six years, and during that time there have been thrown into it, each day, nearly one hundred thousand killogrammes of materials. The numerous other buildings attached to this establishment are filled with steam-engines, forges, refining places, &c. Almost ere the manufactured iron be cold, it is delivered over to expert artizans, well provided with every species of instrument, who make from it machines and tools of all possible kinds, and, above all, rails for railways, which may be regarded as a sort of steam-horses, surpassing all the Arabian barbs that ever cropped the scanty herbage of the desert. The whole neighbourhood of this establishment is traversed by railroads and canals. The workmen at Seraing are three thousand in number.

The boldness of modern industry, and the colossal range of its operations, exact, on the part of the men who direct these, an expansion of views and a rapidity of comprehension and decision similar to what is required in a general; and, not unfrequently, to carry the parallel farther, a degree of courage is demanded on the part of the workmen similar to that which often ennobled the common business of the soldier. We allude to the occasional bursting of furnaces and other accidents liable to occur both above ground and in the mines, at which times a degree of intrepidity and nobleness of spirit has been repeatedly evinced by common workmen, surpassing, from the superiority of the object in view, all the exploits that were ever performed in the "imminent deadly breach" of war. Many instances of this kind might be related of the workmen of Belgium.

A nation, cultivating industrious pursuits with so much sagacity and intelligence, so completely absorbed, in fact, in active business, might be expected to avail themselves with ardour of the prospects recently opened up by railroads. On the 1st of May 1834, a law to the following effect was promulgated by the Belgian government:—

"Article 1. There will be established a system or chain of railways, having Malines for a centre point, and stretching to the eastward toward the Prussian frontier by Louvain, Liege, and Verviers—to the north as far as Antwerp—to the west as far as Ostend, by Termond, Ghent, and Bruges—and to the south by Brussels, and towards the frontiers of France through Hainault.

2. The railways will be executed at the public charge, and under the direction of the government."

Thus, while France is resting in shameful inactivity, in accordance with the ridiculous principle, that it is not proper for a government to interfere with the course of national industry, the little kingdom of Belgium is marching straightforward in the path of prosperity, without embarrassing itself with any prejudicial question of the sort—this line of railroads, crossing to all the cardinal points of the compass, being at this hour in the course of execution. The line from Antwerp to Brussels is completed, and has been travelled for several months. The revenue derived from it has exceeded the highest expectations. With the exception of the line from Brussels to the French frontier, the construction of which must depend on an understanding between the two countries, the whole of the projected Belgian railways will be completed within two years. It is supposed the eastern, western, and northern lines, the aggregate length of which is 222 English miles, will be finished at an expense of forty-five millions of francs (L.1,875,000 sterling). The proportionate expense per mile must, of course, vary according to the difficulties or facilities of the ground. That portion of the line which extends between Brussels and Antwerp, a distance of thirty-three miles, passes over ground naturally level, and cost L.4350 a mile. More inaccessible districts will cost much more than this, as has been said; but it may be questioned whether any part of the Belgian railways will approach near to the expense of the line between Paris and St Germains, which is estimated at above L.24,000 sterling per mile. The abundance of iron in Belgium will render all public works of this kind comparatively cheap.

In addition to the 222 miles of railway first projected, nearly 100 miles additional have been subsequently resolved upon, in order to perfect the internal intercourse of the country. When these plans are all completed, the industry of the people will then have every facility in their way that art can afford them; and, as they possess immense internal resources, instead of being a plaything in the hands of every nation that may choose to go to war, Belgium must become a rich and important state. That its inhabitants will also be amongst the happiest on earth, may also be pronounced, from the attention which they pay to that inestimable and indispensable possession—education. This must form the subject, however, of another extract from the "Almanach."

STEAM IN BELGIUM.

The progress which the Belgians have made in the establishment of steam power is very considerable. In this department of the arts, they have beat France—a statistical fact, of the most valuable nature. According to the statements, it appears that there are at this moment in the province of Liege, 216 steam-engines in action, forming in the aggregate a power equal to that of 5445 horses. Of these 216, 137 are upon the right bank of the Meuse, and the aggregate power of these equals that of 2176 horses; the remaining 79 are upon the left bank, and their power equals that of 3269 horses. Of all these engines, three only are of foreign construction.

The largest of these steam-engines has a 300 horse-power; the weakest has one of about 12. None of the steam-engines of France has above a 100 horse-power. In the province of Liege, there are 18 engines with a power of from 100 to 300; 20 from 50 to 100; 38 from 20 to 50; 139 from 5 to 20; and one of 11½. If we add the steam-power in action in the other Belgic provinces to that existing in Liege we find an aggregate force equal to that of about 20,000 horses. The most powerful engines, and the greatest number of them also, are to be found in Hainault, at Charleroi, and in the Borinage.

According to the statement published by authority in France, the 916 steam-engines in that country represent in the aggregate a power equal only to that of 14,051 horses. Those of Belgium exceed this, as we have seen, by nearly one-third. By comparing the respective numbers of inhabitants in the two countries, it will be found, that the manufacturing industry of Belgium, as shown by the preceding statements, is ten times more developed than that of France.

INSTINCT AND REASON.

The actions of the inferior animals, in as far as they conduce to some particular end, and appear, therefore, to imply motive and foresight, are in general referred to Instinct; while all those of man of a similar character are in turn traced to Reason. There is commonly displayed the utmost unwillingness to allow any glimmerings of *Reason* to brutes, since such an admission seems to exalt them beyond their proper sphere, by conceding to them a portion of what we have been accustomed to consider the chief attribute of man; and an equal repugnance to acknowledge that any of the actions of man are *Instinctive*, since he appears to be humbled by being represented as ever actuated by any principle in common with brutes. The epithet of Rational Being is very generally appropriated to man, as the direct antithesis to that of Brute, which is applied to all other animals; and prejudiced people are always disposed to make this assumed line of demarcation as distinct and as wide as possible. Nor is this prejudice confined to the vulgar—nay, it is, in all probability, from philosophers that they have originally imbibed this, as well as most other fallacies. It has been from the earliest ages assumed in most schools of philosophy, that the lower animals are guided by definite instincts to the full attainment of all their wants, and all the ends for which Providence has designed them—that they do not require reason, and therefore do not possess it; whereas that man, being destitute of any such definite instincts to guide him, and requiring a full share of reason, at once to direct him to the accomplishment of his wishes, and to minister to the other and more important ends for which he was created, has been, on these accounts, endowed with this faculty. But this does not appear to be a legitimate way of disposing of the question. We should not begin by assuming that brutes are actuated by instinct alone, and man by reason; and then endeavour to reconcile all the actions of the former to the one, and all those of the latter to the other: but we should commence by expressly stating what are the conditions of an instinctive, and what those of a reasonable action, as discovered by a patient scrutiny of all the actions belonging to the relative functions of the animal kingdom, all of which, as we shall presently see, must belong to one head or to the other; and afterwards rigorously refer to either head any action, whether of brutes or of man, which corresponds to the established definition of each.

As it appears to us, then, an instinctive action is one which, however directly it may minister to some important end, is performed without any consciousness, on the part of the agent, of that end; which is effected as perfectly the first time it is attempted as at any subsequent period, and which is quite unsusceptible of any adaptation to particular emergencies; while a reasonable action, on the contrary, is one which always implies a consciousness, on the part of the agent, of the end in view, which becomes only progressively perfect, and which is capable of being variously modified according to existing circumstances.

Now, can it be reasonably doubted, but that many of the actions, both of the lower tribes of animals and of man, are referable respectively to both these heads; or affirmed, that there exists any primary and essential distinction, on the one hand, between the principle which directs the young chick to pick up grain the instant it is hatched, and that which prompts the new-born infant to draw milk from the nipple of the mother the first time it is applied to it; or, on the other, between the principle which actuates an old bird in its manifest stratagems, either in the pursuit of advantage, or the shunning of danger, and that which guides an experienced man, in his various measures, towards either the attainment of good or the avoidance of evil? In the two former cases, there is no consciousness on the part of the animal, that the aliment taken is to repair the waste of the body; the action of taking it is performed as perfectly the first time it is attempted, as it could have been after a long course of experience and instruction; and it is invariably the same. In the two latter, on the contrary, the animal has a distinct consciousness of the object in view; he becomes, by experience, better and better acquainted with the most effectual means of attaining this object; and he can change or modify his measures, in proportion as such a change or modification seems requisite. We conclude, therefore, that, while some of the actions of the inferior tribes of animals are instinctive, others spring from reason; and again, that, while some of the actions of man are the result of reason, others spring from instinct—the only difference appearing to consist in this, that, in brutes, the great majority of the actions are instinctive, while, in man, the great majority of the actions are rational; and that, in him, the faculty of reason very far surpasses, not in kind, but in degree, the same faculty in brutes.

Accordingly, while there is no tribe of man so savage as not to have acquired, by experience, some rude notion of tilling the ground, and learned at once the uses of fire and the means of kindling it, and of applying it to their necessities, there is no description of brutes so far advanced as, however necessary to their existence roots, fruits, and grain may be, or whatever comforts they may

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have derived from heat, ever to have attained to the means of artificially rearing the one, or producing, or even keeping alive, the other; and while, even in the wildest and most uncultivated tribes of the human race, some traces of a barbarous religion are constantly to be met with, no rudiment of such a sentiment has ever betrayed itself in the most highly gifted of the brute creation.

Still, these are differences in degree only, and not in kind; and the faculties and sentiments with which many brutes are endowed, appear to be quite competent, were they enlarged and expanded in a high degree, to lead, without any alteration in kind, to all the results which, as displayed by man alone, we commonly attribute to a distinct source; and those who adopt the opposite opinion, seem to differ from us only in as far as they fix their standard of reason somewhat higher than we do. They admit that most of the inferior animals learn many things by experience and education; but affirm that they are guided, in these cases, by memory alone, without observing that memory can only recall past events, and must be quite inadequate, without reason, to prompt an animal, either to repeat an action from which it has previously derived advantage, or to refrain from one from which it has already suffered injury. Again, there are few of the lower animals which do not manifest, besides hope and fear—which must have actuated them in the instances already adduced—gratitude to those who have been kind to them, and dislike to those by whom they have been ill used, as well as frequently a decided love of justice, and a hatred of oppresssion in general. Such impulses as these meet the definition which *we* are disposed to adopt of reason, without any addition of those strictly intellectual or highly moral qualities, which by some persons are made essential to this principle. In these, brutes are unquestionably deficient; they want the more exalted degree, as well as the more continued exercise, of the faculty of reason, which distinguishes man, in his most abject state, from the higher tribes of other creatures, and which, as it renders him alone a responsible agent, opens upon him alone the prospect of eternal retribution, as his actions shall have been conformable, or otherwise, to those precepts of religion and morality, which he alone is capable of understanding.—*From a forthcoming work by Dr Bushnan of Dumfries, entitled "The Philosophy of Instinct and Reason."*

LONDON MERCHANTS.

The peerage, as well as the baronetage of England, exhibits numerous proofs of voluntary respect paid to commerce by British sovereigns. The noble house of Osborne, which has attained the first honours of a subject, had for its founder Edward Osborne, apprentice to Sir William Hewet, a merchant who lived in London, and was lord mayor in 1559. Sir William had only one daughter, Anne, who, when a child, was, by the carelessness of her nurse, dropped in the Thames. The apprentice, Edward Osborne, jumped into the river and saved her life. When the child grew up to womanhood, as she was rich, she had many suitors, among whom was the Earl of Shrewsbury, but the father refused them all, saying, that as Osborne had saved her, he should have her. They were married, and their descendant is Duke of Leeds.—The Marquis Cornwallis is lineally descended from Thomas Cornwalleys, merchant, who was sheriff of London in 1378.—The noble house of Wentworth was founded by Sir W. Fitzwilliam, who was an alderman of London, and sheriff in 1506; he was a retainer of Cardinal Wolsey, and knighted by Henry VIII. for his attachment to that prelate in his misfortunes. He built the greater part of the present church of St Andrew, Undershaft.—The Earl of Coventry is descended from John Coventry, mercer and lord mayor in the year 1425: he was one of the executors of the celebrated Whittington.—Laurence des Bouveries married a daughter of a silk mercer at Frankfort on-the-Maine, and, returning to England, laid the foundation of the house of Radnor.—The ancestor of the Earl of Essex was Sir William Capel, lord mayor of London, in 1503.—The ancestor of the Earl of Dartmouth, T. Legge, or Legget, a skinner, was twice lord mayor—in 1347 and 1354, and lent King Edward III. no less a sum than L.300 for his French war.—Sir William Craven, merchant tailor and lord mayor of London, was ancestor of the present Earl of Craven; and the present Earl of Warwick is lineally descended from William Greville, a citizen of London, and "flower of the woolstaplers."—Thomas Bennet, mercer, sheriff in 1594, and lord mayor in 1603, laid the foundation of the fortunes of the Earls of Tankerville, who are lineally descended from him.—The ancestor of the Earls of Pomfret was Richard Fermour, who, having amassed a splendid fortune as a citizen in Calais, came to England, and suffered attaint under Henry VIII., and did not recover his property till the 4th of Edward VI.—The Earl of Darnley owes the first elevation of his family to John Bligh, a London citizen, who was employed as agent to the speculators in the Irish estates forfeited in the rebellion in 1641.—John Cowper, an alderman of Bridge Ward, and sheriff in 1551, was ancestor of Earl Cowper; and the Earl of Romney is descended from Thomas Marsham, alderman, who died in 1624.—Lord Dacre's ancestor, Sir Robert Dacre, was banker to Charles I., although he lost L.80,000 by that monarch, left a princely fortune to his descendants.—Lord Dormer is descended from Sir Michael Dormer, lord mayor in 1541.—Viscount Dudley and Ward's ancestor was William Warde, a goldsmith in London, and jeweller to the consort of Charles I.—Sir Rowland Hill, who was lord mayor in the reign of Edward VI., was ancestor of Lord Berwick, Lord Hill, and "all the Hills in Shropshire."—*Newspaper paragraph.*

DRESSING FOR COMPANY.

In a small and neat treatise just published, called the "Philosophy of Manner," we find the following good advice:—"When you receive company into your house, you should never appear in full dress. This is a circumstance of the first importance in good breeding." It might have been as well to say that the rule is, "never to dress better than your company—always dress in an inferior style," because if you dress better, you are apt to hurt their feelings by making them appear your inferiors.

SHARP RETORT.

"Will you lend father your newspaper, sir?—he only just wants to read it!" "Yes, my boy—and ask him to lend me his dinner—I only just want to eat it!"—*American paper.*

MALTHUSIAN CAT.

We had a cat in our house, which ought to have belonged to Mr Malthus. Her first litter of kittens was drowned, excepting one, which she brought up. Of the next litter, one was also preserved: but the cat had no further desire to experience the transports of maternal love; for, the first time she saw the servant standing by a pail of water, she brought the kitten in her mouth, and laid it beside it, looking up, as much as to say, "put it in:" and from that time never would nurse it.—*Literary Gazette.* [We doubt this story].

ESCAPE OF NELSON.

In 1781, Captain Nelson was chosen to conduct the naval part of the expedition against St Juan's. Being one day excessively fatigued, he ordered his hammock to be slung under some trees. During his sleep, that extraordinary animal called a monitory lizard (from its reputed faculty of warning persons of the approach of any venomous animal) passed across Nelson's face, which being observed by some of the Indian itinerants, they shouted and awoke him. He immediately started up, and throwing off the quilt, found one of the most venomous of the innumerable serpents in the country coiled up at his feet. From this remarkable escape, the Indians who attended entertained an idea that Nelson was a superior being.

HOW TO MAKE A MAD DOG.

Tie a dog that is little, and one that is large
To a truck or a barrow as big as a barge;
Their mouths girded tight with a ragged old cord (or
They'll put out their tongues) by the magistrate's order;
So you save 'em the trouble of feeding, I think,
Or the loss of your time by their stopping to drink.
Lend 'em out, 'tis a neighbourly duty, of course,
And mind they've a load that would stagger a horse.
If you've nothing to draw, why, yourselves let 'em carry, (sons
Of she dogs!) or else they'll be drawing compari-sons.
With a stick or a kick make 'em gallop away,
And smoke through the streets in a piping hot day,
Where Macadam is spreading his pebbles about,
And they'll pick up their feet all the quicker, no doubt;
More than all, don't allow them their noses to wet;—it
Will keep 'em alert by the "wish they may get it."
All pleasures must end:—when they drop head and tail,
With their muzzles all froth, like a tankard of ale,
Turn 'em loose in the road with a whoop and a hollo,
And get all the thieves and the blackguards to follow.
It's a precious good lark for the neighbours, you'll find,
With the mad dogs before and the sad dogs behind,
And you'll ne'er be molested, rely on my word,
If you keep 'em from biting a bishop or lord.
—*From the Comic Almanack.*

NUMBER OF DEAF AND DUMB.

The number of persons born deaf and dumb far exceeds what is generally supposed, but absolute deafness is comparatively rare, and consequently, with proper remedies and attention, the hearing might be improved. A circular issued by the Institut Royal de Surdsmuets de Paris, shows, that in France, with a population of 23,000,000, there are 20,189 deaf and dumb, that is, one in every 1585; in Russia, one in 1584; in America, one in 1556; for all Europe the proportion is as high as one in 1537; so that there is ample scope for institutions of this nature. Those at present existing are inadequate for the admission of all, or even a large portion, of congenital cases of deafness and dumbness; it being a well-attested fact, that three, four, five, and in some instances even seven, children in one family are so afflicted. According to a report of the London Deaf and Dumb Asylum, it appears that a list of 64 candidates was presented to the governors, out of which they were under the painful necessity of electing only 21, though all seemed to have powerful, if not equal claims on their notice. By the same report it will be seen, that in seventeen families, containing 136 children, there are no fewer than 78 deaf and dumb. The state of mind in deaf persons has frequently been noticed: the deaf, indeed, are generally low-spirited and fretful; the blind, on the contrary, are usually cheerful. The former brood hopelessly over their misfortune; the latter confidently anticipate relief. The deaf, too, according to M. Andral, are short-lived; while daily observation shows us that the blind are remarkable for longevity.—*From Observations on the Preservation of Hearing, by J. Harrison Curtis.*

SMART RETORT.

A Pennsylvania paper contains the subjoined "*amende honorable*," which ought to satisfy any reasonable being:—"AMENDE HONORABLE.—We yesterday spoke of Mr Hamilton, of the Chestnut Street Theatre, as a 'thing.' Mr H. having complained of our remark, we willingly retract, and here state that Mr Hamilton, of the Chestnut Street Theatre, is *no-thing*."

EDIFICATION OF MARRIED MEN.

"Ven you're a married man, Samivel, you'll understand a good many things as you don't understand now; but vether it's worth while goin' through so much to learn so little, as the charity-boy said ven he got to the end of the alphabet, is a matter o' taste. *I* rayther think it isn't."—*Pickwick.*

QUICK TRAVELLING.

An Irish gentleman recently remarked, that such probably would soon be the speed of travelling by steam, that one could go from London to Brighton in a shorter time than he could stop at home.

REASONS FOR THE CHOICE OF A HUSBAND.

"What in the world could you see in Lord A. to marry him?" "Why, I saw a house in town," said the marchioness, "and a box at the opera!"

SOLDIERS.

English soldiers were at one period distinguished by badges, like those worn by watermen. The general colour of their dresses appears to have been white; though in 1544, a part of the forces of Henry VIII. were ordered to be dressed in blue coats, guarded with red, without badges, the right hose red, and the left blue. In 1584, Elizabeth ordered the cassocks of the soldiers sent to Ireland to be a sad green, or russet; though the cloaks of the cavalry were red. In 1693, the dresses of the soldiers were grey, and those of the drummers purple, but the red uniform was probably adopted when the House of Hanover acceded to the throne.

ANECDOTES OF BONAPARTE.

In the midst of a dreadful cannonading, Bonaparte stood leaning, nearly exhausted with several days' hard fatigue, against the carriage-wheel of a cannon, and was in the act of taking a pinch of his favourite stimulant from the box of an officer, when a cannon-shot came and killed the latter on the spot. Without moving a limb or a muscle of his countenance, except in pity to his fallen friend, Bonaparte turned to another, and asked if he had a box; "for," said he, "our poor friend I suppose has taken his with him."—Napoleon being in the gallery of the Louvre one day, attended by Baron Denon, turned round suddenly from a fine picture, which he had viewed for some time in silence, and said to him, "That is a noble picture, Denon." "Immortal," was Denon's reply. "How long," inquired Napoleon, "will this picture last?" Denon answered, that, "with care, and in a proper situation, it might last, perhaps, five hundred years." "And how long," said Napoleon, "will a statue last?" "Perhaps," replied Denon, "five thousand years." "And this," returned Napoleon, sharply, "this you call immortality!"

A FINE STYLE OF ADVERTISING.

We find the following prettily written advertisement in a bygone newspaper:—"D——— recommends to the nobility his fashionable peruques, particularly to those who wear false hair. Having invented a head dress for ladies and gentlemen, without the use of unpleasant elastic springs in the neck, and which adheres most pleasant and light on the head, and a perfect imitation of nature, and no doubt they will supersede all others in their elegant and becoming appearance. Warranted not to shrink, and may be washed, so that they may always be perfectly clean; improve and suit the colour of every countenance, which may be made not to weigh one ounce. Only to be had at," &c.

TWO WILLS IN ONE BODY.

The Chevalier d'Angos, a learned astronomer, carefully observed, for several days, a lizard with two heads, and assured himself that this lizard had two wills, independent of each other, and possessing nearly equal power over the body, which was in one. When a piece of bread was presented to the animal, in such a manner that it could see it with one head only, that head wished to go towards the bread, while the other head wished the body to remain still.—*Philosophical Dictionary.*

UNCOMMON GOOD SHOT.

The late Sheridan was more celebrated in the senate than in the field. It chanced that he once paid a visit to an old sportsman, and in order to avoid the imputation of being a down-right *ignoramus*, took a gun, and at the dawn of day went in pursuit of game. He was accompanied by a gamekeeper, a true Pat, who lost no opportunity of praising Sheridan's prowess. The first covey rose within a few yards of the Statesman's nose, who waited till they were out of "harm's way" before he fired. Pat immediately observed, "I see you know what a gun is; it's well you wasn't nearer, or them chaps would be sorry you ever came into the country." Sheridan's second shot was not more successful. "Oh!" cried Pat, "what an escape. I'll be bound you rumpled some of their feathers." The third shot was as little effective as the former. "Hah!" exclaimed the Irishman, although astonished at so palpable a miss, "I'll lay a thirteen you don't come near us to-day. Master was too near you to be pleasant." On they went, without a bird in the bag; at last, on their return home, Sheridan perceived a covey, and unwilling to give them a chance of flight, he resolved to have a fire at them on the ground. He did so; but they all flew away untouched. Pat, whose excuses were now almost exhausted, still had something to say, and he joyfully exclaimed, looking at Sheridan, "You made them *leave that* any how;" and with this compliment to his sportsman-like qualities, Sheridan closed his morning's amusement, laughing heartily at his companion, and rewarding him with half a crown for his patience and encouragement.—*Old Scrap Book.*

THE PASSIONS.

When Kean paid his last visit to Ayr, his performance of Othello happened to be the subject of conversation in a shop, when a butcher who was present asked very gravely whether Mr Kean spoke all he said out of his own head, or if he learned it from a book? Being told how the thing was, he exclaimed against paying to hear a man repeat what every one who could read might do as well as himself; an objection which was met by some one observing that the actor "did not only recite the play, but he delineated the various passions which belonged to the character." "Passions! passions!" cried the butcher, "Gang to the fish-market, if ye want to see the passions; that's the place for passions!"—*Ayr paper.*

PRESENCE OF MIND.

When the Opera-house at Stockholm was on fire, the life of the king, who was present, was saved by the presence of mind of Madame Kayser, an actress. Already the machinery at the end of the stage was in flames, without the audience knowing it, when Madame Kayser gradually approached the royal box, without interrupting her singing or action. At first she made signs to the king, who did not understand her; she then, seizing a favourable moment, said to him in a low voice, "Leave the theatre, sire, it is on fire." The king instantly quitted the house; when, after giving him time to escape the crowd, she vociferated *fire!* and gaining her box threw herself out of a window, which not being very high from the ground, she escaped without injury.

HOW TO DETECT ADULTERATED BREAD.

The following useful directions for discriminating pure from adulterated bread are given in the Economist:—"Pure bread is of a clean colour and mellow texture; the crust is brown, the crumb soft when moderately new, the smell is fresh, pleasant, and wholesome, and the taste sweet. On the contrary, the crumb of adulterated bread is harsh, and the crust pale; the smell is raw and disagreeable, and the taste has nothing of that sweetness; neither has the crumb at any time the due consistence, for it is made up of ingredients which will not mix with the yeast and water in the manner that flour does. The paleness of the crust is one great test, and it depends upon this plain cause: flour when burnt becomes brown; but the ingredients added to bread by those who adulterate it, remain white in the fire. Whiting, lime, alum, and ashes of bones, are alike in this respect; they will continue white when burnt; and, therefore, the more there is of them in the bread, the paler will be the crust. There cannot be a more obvious way of discovering the fraud, than by comparing the crust of an honestly made loaf with that of one of the others."

FOOD FOR HORSES.

A practice is becoming general in Silesia of feeding horses with bread, made by taking equal quantities of oat and rye meal, mixing it with leaven or yeast, and adding one-third of the quantity of boiled potatoes. To each horse is given 12lbs. per day, in rations of 4lbs. each. The bread is cut into small pieces, and mixed with a little moistened cut straw. It is stated that by this means there is a saving in feeding seven horses of 49 bushels of oats in 24 days, while the horses perform their common labour, and are much better in look, health, and disposition.—*Newspaper Paragraph.*

POST-OFFICE IN FRANCE.

A gentleman of Dublin having occasion to write to a lady near Metz, in France, to whom he had not written since the renewal of the war in 1803, his letter was dated 23d January, 1833, and directed, as formerly, to the care of a shopkeeper in her post town, Pont-a Mousson, and he wrote on the left corner, "Letters were thus addressed to Mrs ——— in 1803; she lived then at Arnaville." Her husband having obtained a situation under government, he was ordered to Spire, in Germany, where he removed with his family, after having disposed of his property. The lady died at Spire in 1813, her husband died in 1830. The shopkeeper of Pont-a-Mousson, who received their letters, had died long before, yet the letter reached her eldest daughter at Strasburg, who, being married many years, had, of course, another name. It was acknowledged by her husband on the 14th of April 1833. So that, notwithstanding the length of time, changes of residence at more than one hundred miles distance, and the change of name, the post-office found out the nearest heir in about two months' time. In other countries the letter would have been marked, "Not to be found," or "Not called for," and sent to the Dead Letter-office.—*Newspaper Paragraph.* [We do not altogether assent to the insinuation that in other countries the letter would have been marked "Not to be found." Both in London and Edinburgh, we have known instances of extraordinary diligence on the part of letter-carriers in discovering persons for whom letters were addressed. Considering the limitation as to time for delivering letters, the letter-carriers in general show amazing alacrity, and are a meritorious class of men.]

CURE FOR THE EAR-ACHE.

Steep a clove of garlic for a few minutes in warm salad oil, put it in the ear rolled up in thin muslin; after a time the garlic will be dissolved, and the pain removed; then substitute some lint or cotton to keep out the cold air.—*Magazine of Domestic Economy.*

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THE TWO FUNERALS.

In attending the funerals of departed friends, I am apt, as is probably a general case, not only to moralise within my own breast on the shortness and uncertainty of life, but to review the circumstances of the life and death of the individual whom I am to assist in consigning to the earth, with a view to extracting from those circumstances hints and maxims, for guidance and for warning, or at least to make them an occasion for chewing the cud of sweet and bitter fancy. Two funerals at which I have lately been a mourner, awakened in me unusually deep feelings. To external observation, the cases were alike: in each instance, a young married woman, erewhile gay, handsome, and accomplished, was to be borne to the last narrow house. But, to those who knew the domestic circumstances of the parties, no two individuals could appear to have died from such opposite causes. And it was this occult diversity in what was apparently so much alike, that chiefly served to rivet my attention to two natural calamities which might have otherwise passed without further notice, though, singly, they could have at no time failed to interest my feelings.

The first of the two ladies had been married about two years before, to a man in every respect worthy of her. When their union took place, any one, observing the graces of person and mind possessed by the wife, and knowing the integrity and liberality of nature of the husband, would have been disposed to say, "There is a couple, who, as far as natural circumstances give reason to predicate, must surely lead a long and happy life." The first months of their union were spent in such a manner as would have justified such a prediction. In a handsomely furnished house, with all the comforts which an honourable industry could command, they enjoyed that happiness which their own excellent dispositions and mutual attachment rendered almost inevitable. Too well satisfied with their own society, to need much of that of their fellow-creatures, they rarely went abroad; but, when they did so, they were the grace of every company they entered. It was impossible, indeed, for the most invidious or misanthropical nature to contemplate so beautiful a social arrangement as that which this pair exemplified in their married life, without a sympathetic pleasure. The most obstinate bigot to celibacy must have confessed, that surely that was a divine institution which could place two human beings in a relation so nearly realising what the blessed think of heaven. I saw the lady on one occasion of festivity, when her light figure and lovely countenance, as they flitted through the dance, were the delight and admiration of all present. I thought a fairer vision had never come before my eyes, nor ever been present to my dreams. Could I have supposed that, in a few months, I was to be present when that blooming form, deprived of all its grace and animation, was to be laid in the darkling tomb?

To trace the causes of the final illness of this fair creature would, I have been informed, have been a difficult task for her physician; much more so would it be to one who knew her by little more than hearsay. The Author of Nature, we can well see, has decreed that all the highest moral qualities which can engage our love or esteem may be united to a frame of the weakliest structure, and that no merit of whatever kind will avail to ward off a single physical evil which may have been, however inadvertently, incurred. A general provision, it is evident, has been made, in order that the human frame may perform all its functions healthily till old age; but no power has been given to save it from certain mischances which ignorance or chance may bring upon it. Certain it is, that this good and gentle being never recovered from her first confinement. From that day, her life was one continued indisposition, under which her body wasted away, until it at last manifested all the too-well known symptoms of consumption.

When I first thought of submitting this case to public notice, it was with no conviction of its possessing, in itself, any extraordinary features which might serve to fix general attention. It is in its contrast with the case which follows that the interest of this very unpretending paper, if it have any, must lie. In the decline of the unfortunate lady there was not even, as far as I am aware, a medical peculiarity. Consumption, with her, pursued simply its ordinary course, leaving her friends, from the first, scarcely the slightest ground of hope. The conduct of her husband on this occasion was nothing more than a natural duty; but it is worth while to state what a good man has deemed a duty on such an occasion. He in the first place devoted himself, as far as his engagements would allow, to the company of his wife. He denied himself every amusement that he might study her comfort, and soothe her wasting spirit. His fortune was expended liberally in bringing to her couch such medical skill as was supposed by his friends to hold out the slightest hope of benefit, and in suiting her chamber, by a thousand little devices and furnishings, to the requirements of her delicate condition. No mother could have lulled an ailing baby of a month old with more tenderness, than did he exhibit in cheering the last moments of his dying wife. She sunk amidst the sighs and prayers of an affection for which it would have indeed been worth while to live.

The details of the opposite case are of too painful a nature to be long dwelt upon. A young lady of pleasing person and manners, and reared in a sphere of society, which, though no way elevated, allowed her in early life to enjoy many indulgences, and acquire many ornamental accomplishments, disappointed in obtaining the hand of an individual who had won her affections, gave herself to another suitor who was totally unfitted in ordinary circumstances to have conciliated the least share of her regard. While to ordinary observers the situation and character of the husband were respectable, those who knew him closely were aware that his nature was cold and harsh, his manners rude and grovelling, and that he was the slave of a sordid economy, which would not allow him to indulge in any of what are called the elegancies of life, though it never restrained him in his own coarse amusements. Hitherto, his house had been managed by a mother, who thought no servile office beneath her, and had no inclination to live in a style above that of the plainest rustic families. It may readily be supposed that the young lady, on commencing her married life, found herself in an element most unsuitable to her nature. The house and furniture which had hitherto accommodated the husband and his mother, were expected still to be sufficient, though no provision was made, or proposed to be made, for the separate residence of the old lady. The same humble style of living was, moreover, kept up, and, to make sure that it should be so, the old lady was continued in her office of general manager—a violation of the usual practice, for which it did not seem to be supposed that any apology was necessary. The young wife thus found herself altogether without power and without freedom, and, at the same time, condemned to a manner of living far beneath that to which she had been accustomed. When any of her friends came to visit her, she was unable to receive them as if she were mistress of the house, or to extend to them the simplest forms of hospitality. Her husband and his mother at the same time showed very unequivocally, that no person of genteel appearance was welcome there. Vexed by the embarrassment of her manner, and disgusted by the vulgar rudeness of her new relations, her old friends soon discontinued their visits, and thus she was in a short while entirely cut off from the more amiable and refined world in which she had formerly moved.

It is one of the greatest drawbacks from the boasted virtues of the humbler class of minds, that they are unfurnished with the means of regulating their feelings. The relation of mother-in-law towards daughter-in-law is a trying one, and, where the mind is completely unregulated, is almost certain to be an unhappy one. In the present case, the husband's mother, though qualified to fulfil all common duties creditably, being quite unaccustomed to control her feelings or make allowances for the feelings of others, soon became a source of unspeakable torment to her daughter-in-law; and still, in all their variances, the husband was sure to take part with the more sordid of his two housekeepers. If the young lady had possessed a vigorous character, she might have contended successfully with some of her difficulties; but she was in reality of a mild and pliant nature, and yielded readily to the pressure of circumstances. In no long time, it was ascertained by her friends that her elegance of form and of habits was gone, that she had sunk into the drudge which her new friends wished her to be, and could now have been scarcely recognised by those who had been accustomed to meet her in gay assemblies a few years before. But though she thus submitted to her destiny, it was not without the severest suffering. Her life was one of pure wretchedness—wretchedness without hope, for she knew of no refuge from the gross scene to which she had been introduced. Beings so miserable as she rarely live long. We soon heard that she had become afflicted with a very painful malady, and that, in its severest accesses, there was no mitigation to the ordinary sorrows of her fate. Her husband, professing not to believe that her ailment was of a dangerous nature, not only paid her no personal attention, but refused to afford her the requisite medical attendance. Continuing his usual avocations, as if his wife had only been suffering from a slight indisposition, he was surprised, one night, on returning home from a gross carouse, to find that she was released from all her troubles.

I have no wish to expatiate upon the claims which this tale presents to pity or to indignation. Neither am I disposed to moralise on the imprudence by which, in one sense, the unfortunate lady might be said to have occasioned her own ruin. Whatever sentiments the tale is fitted to excite, it will already have excited; whatever moral it is calculated to convey, it will already have conveyed. For my own part, I can only, with an emotion of deep sympathy, think of the fellow-beings whom I lately knew, beautiful, gay, and hopeful, forming part of a multitude, living, hoping, and enjoying, like themselves, but who are now, by the force of circumstances traceable and untraceable, struck from the roll of life, and made the prey of dumb forgetfulness. Unlike, alas, were the latter days of these two fine beings; but now the grass grows with equal greenness over the lowly beds of both, and in a few short years there will be none to tell that they were either alike in their original beauty and apparent destiny, or in the end so woefully different!

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PAUL CUFFEE.

It is with much pleasure that we introduce to our readers a sketch of the history of Paul Cuffee, a negro not unworthy to be classed with Jenkins, Lott Cary, and Phillis Wheatley, persons of colour, with whose talents and virtues the readers of the present work were formerly made acquainted. After the explanatory remarks which accompanied the notices alluded to, it is scarcely necessary to repeat here, that, in recording these instances of mental capacity and goodness of disposition in the dark races, it is not our intention to represent the black as possessed of a native equality of intellect with the white, and that education and other circumstances operate all the difference which is observable between them. This is a proposition, we believe, of too ambitious and extreme a character to be sustained, however pleasing it may be to the philanthropist. A much more moderate proposition seems to be the one which approaches nearest to the truth; and this is, that while, in the mass, the coloured races are far behind the whites, such examples of intellect and virtue as are seen in Cary and Jenkins prove that there is no absolute difference in specific character between the black and white races, and lead us to hope that the former, by cultivation through successive generations, may reach the same point to which the latter have attained. This slow mode of advance, generation by generation, is shown, indeed, by the history of civilisation among the white races, to be the universal law of social progress. Ages have been required to make the white race what it now is, and the improvement of the African mind must in like manner be the work of ages, and of ages, too, judiciously employed.

With this explanation of our views, we turn to Paul Cuffee, who presents us with an example of great energy of mind in the more common affairs of life, as Cary and Wheatley exhibited the finer and higher degrees of intellectual endowment. The father of Paul was a native of Africa, from which country he was brought as a slave to Boston, in North America. Here he remained in slavery for a considerable portion of his life, but finally, by industry and economy, he amassed a sum which enabled him to purchase his personal liberty. About the same period he married a woman of Indian descent, and continuing his habits of industry and frugality, he soon found himself rich enough to purchase a farm of a hundred acres at Westport, in Massachusetts. Here a family of ten children was born to him, four sons and six daughters, all of whom received a little education, and were ultimately established in respectable situations in life. Paul, the fourth son, was born in the year 1759. When he was about fourteen years of age, his father died, leaving a considerable property in land, but which, being at that time comparatively unproductive, afforded only a very moderate provision for the large family which depended on it for subsistence. After assisting his brothers for a time in the management of this property, Paul began to see that commerce then held out higher prospects to industry than agriculture, and being conscious, perhaps, that he possessed qualities which, under proper culture, would enable him to pursue commercial employments with success, he resolved to betake himself to the sea. A whaling voyage was his first adventure in the capacity of a mariner, and on his return from this, he made a trip to the West Indies, acting on both occasions as a "common man at the mast." His third voyage occurred in the year 1776, at which period Britain was at war with America. Paul and his companions were taken prisoners by the British, and detained for about three months at New York. On being liberated, Paul returned to Westport, where he resided for several succeeding years, assisting his brothers in their agricultural pursuits.

We have now to mention a circumstance most honourable to Paul Cuffee. The free negro population of Massachusetts was at that period excluded from all participation in the rights of citizenship, though bearing a full share of every state burden. Paul, though not yet twenty years of age, felt deeply the injustice done to himself and his race, and resolved to make an effort to obtain for them the rights which were their due. Assisted by his brothers, he drew up and presented a respectful petition on the subject to the state legislature. In spite of the prejudices of the times, the propriety and justice of the petition was perceived by a majority of the legislative body, and an act was passed, granting to the free negroes all the privileges of white citizens. This enactment was not only important as far as regarded the state of Massachusetts; the example was followed, at different periods, by others of the united provinces, and thus did the exertions of Paul Cuffee and his brothers influence permanently the welfare of the whole coloured population of North America.

After accomplishing this great work, our hero's enterprising spirit directed itself to objects of a more personal character. In his twentieth year, he laid before his brother David a plan for opening a commercial intercourse with the state of Connecticut. His brother was pleased with the scheme; an open boat, which was all that their means could accomplish, was built, and the adventurers proceeded to sea. Here David Cuffee found himself for the first time exposed to the perils of the ocean, and the hazard of the predatory warfare which was carried on by the private refugees on the coast. His courage sank ere he had proceeded many leagues, and he resolved to return. This was a bitter disappointment to the intrepid Paul, but he was affectionate, and gave up the enterprise at his elder brother's desire. After labouring diligently for some time afterwards in the fields, at the family farm, Paul collected sufficient means to try the scheme again on his own account. He went to sea, and lost all the little treasure which by the sweat of his brow he had gathered. Not discouraged by this misfortune, he returned to his farm labours only to revolve his plans anew. As he could not now purchase what he wanted, he set to work, and with his own hands constructed a boat, complete from keel to gunwale. This vessel was without a deck, but his whaling experience had made him an adept in the management of such a bark. Having launched it into the ocean, he steered for the Elizabeth Isles, with the view of consulting one of his brothers, who resided there, upon his future plans. Alas, poor Paul!—he was met by a party of pirates, who deprived him of his boat and all its contents. He returned once more to Westport, in a penniless condition.

Ardent indeed must the spirit have been, which such repeated calamities did not shake. Again did our young adventurer prevail on his brother David to assist him in building a boat. This being accomplished, the respectability of Paul Cuffee's character, and his reputation for unflinching energy, procured him sufficient credit to enable him to purchase a small cargo. With this he went to sea, and after a narrow escape from the refugee pirates, disposed of his cargo at the island of Nantucket, and returned to Westport in safety. A second voyage to the same quarter was less fortunate; he fell into the hands of the pirates, who deprived him of every thing but his boat. Paul's inflexible firmness of mind did not yet desert him; he undertook another voyage in his open boat, with a small cargo, and was successful in reaching Nantucket. He there disposed of his goods to advantage, and returned in safety to Westport.

Hitherto we have not alluded to the condition of Paul Cuffee, as far as regarded mental culture. In truth, up almost to manhood, he can scarcely be said to have received any education whatever, beyond the acquirement of the English alphabet. Ere he was twenty-five years of age, however, he had obviated this disadvantage by his assiduity, and had taught himself writing and arithmetic. He had also applied to the study of navigation, and had mastered it so far as to render himself capable of engaging in nautical and commercial undertakings to any extent.

The profits of the voyage already alluded to, put Paul in possession of a covered boat, of about twelve tons burthen, with which he made many voyages to the Connecticut coasts. In these he was so successful, that he thought himself justified in undertaking the cares of a family, and married a female descendant of the same tribe of Indians to which his mother belonged. For some years after this event, he attended chiefly to agricultural concerns, but the increase of his family induced him to embark anew in commercial plans. He arranged his affairs for a new expedition, and hired a small house on Westport river, to which he removed with his wife and children. Here, with a boat of eighteen tons, he engaged in the cod-fishing, and was so successful that he was enabled in a short time to build a vessel of forty-two tons, which he navigated with the assistance of his nephews, several of whom had devoted themselves to the sea-service.

Paul Cuffee was now the most influential person in a thriving fishing community, which depended chiefly on his enterprise and voyages for employment and support. How deeply he interested himself in the welfare of those around him, may be estimated from the following circumstance:—Having felt in his own person the want of a proper education, he called the inhabitants of his village to a meeting, and proposed to them the establishment of a school. Finding some disputes and delays to start up in the way, Paul took the matter into his own hands, built a school-house on his own ground at his own expense, and threw it open to the public. This enlightened and philanthropic conduct on the part of a coloured person, the offspring of a slave, may serve as a lesson to rulers and legislators of far higher pretensions. Though the range of his influence was limited, the intention of the act was not less meritorious than if it had extended over an empire.

About this time Paul proceeded on a whaling voyage to the Straits of Belleisle, where he found four other vessels much better equipped than his own. For this reason, the masters of these vessels withdrew from the customary practice on such occasions, and refused to mate with Paul's crew, which consisted of only ten hands. This disagreement was afterwards made up, but it had the effect of rousing the ardour of Cuffee and his men to such a pitch, that out of seven whales killed in that season, two fell by Paul's own hands, and four by those of his crew. Returning home heavily freighted with oil and bone, our hero then went to Philadelphia to dispose of his cargo, and with the proceeds purchased materials for building a schooner of sixty or seventy tons. In 1795, when he was about thirty-six years of age, Paul had the pleasure of seeing his new vessel launched at Westport. The "Ranger" was the name given to the schooner, which was of sixty-nine tons burthen. By selling his two other boats, Paul was enabled to put a cargo worth two thousand dollars on board of the Ranger; and having heard that a load of Indian corn might be procured at a low rate on the eastern shore of Maryland, he accordingly directed his course thither. It may give the reader some idea of the low estimation in which the African race were held, and of the energy required to rise above the crushing weight of prejudice, when we inform the reader, that, on the arrival of Paul at Vienna in Nantichoke Bay, the inhabitants were filled with astonishment, and even alarm; a vessel owned and commanded by a black man, and manned with a crew of the same colour, was unprecedented and surprising. The fear of a revolt on the part of their slaves was excited among the inhabitants of Vienna, and an attempt was made to prevent Paul from entering the harbour. The prudence and firmness of the negro captain overcame this difficulty, and converted dislike into kindness and esteem. He sold his cargo, received in lieu of it three thousand bushels of Indian corn, which he conveyed to Westport, where it was in great demand, and yielded our hero a clear profit of a thousand dollars. He made many subsequent voyages to the same quarter, and always with similar success.

Paul Cuffee was now one of the wealthiest and most respectable men of the district in which he lived, and all his relations partook of his good fortune. He had purchased some valuable landed property, in the neighbourhood where his family had been brought up, and placed it under the care of one of his brothers. He built a brig, likewise, of a hundred and sixty-two tons, which was put under the command of a nephew. As may be supposed, he had in the mean time fitted himself, also, with a vessel suited to his increasing means. In 1806, the brig Traveller of a hundred and nine tons, and the ship Alpha, of two hundred and sixty-eight tons, were built at Westport, and of these he was the principal owner. He commanded the Alpha himself, and the others also were engaged in the extensive business which he carried on at Westport.

The scheme of forming colonies of free blacks, from America and other quarters, on the coast of their native Africa, excited the deepest interest in Paul Cuffee, whose heart had always grieved for the degraded state of his race. Anxious to contribute to the success of this great purpose, he resolved to visit in person the African coast, and satisfy himself respecting the state of the country, and other points. This he accomplished in 1811, in the brig Traveller, with which he reached Sierra Leone after a two months' passage. While he was there, the British African Institution, hearing of his benevolent designs, applied for and obtained a licence, which induced Paul to come to Britain with a cargo of African produce. He left his nephew, however, behind him at Sierra Leone to prosecute his disinterested views, and brought away a native youth, in order to educate him, and render him fit to educate others, on being restored to the place of his birth.

On arriving at Liverpool, with his brig, navigated by eight men of colour and a boy, Paul Cuffee soon gained the esteem of all with whom he held intercourse. He visited London twice, the second visit being made at the request of the members of the African Institution, who were desirous of consulting with him as to the best means of carrying their benevolent views respecting Africa into effect. This excellent and enterprising man shortly after returned to America, to pass the remainder of his days in the bosom of his family, and to do good to all around him, with the ample means which his industry had acquired. Whether he is yet alive, it is not in our power to say; his family, at least, we know, are still engaged in the commercial pursuits in which he led the way.

The following description is appended to a notice of him which appeared in the Liverpool Mercury at the time of his visit to Britain, and to which we have been indebted for the materials of the present article:—"A sound understanding, united with indomitable energy and perseverance, are the prominent features of Paul Cuffee's character. Born under peculiar disadvantages, deprived of the benefits of early education, and his meridian spent in toil and vicissitudes, he has struggled under disadvantages which have seldom occurred in the career of any individual. Yet under the pressure of these difficulties, he seems to have fostered dispositions of mind which qualify him for any station of life to which he may be introduced. His person is tall, well formed, and athletic; his deportment conciliating, yet dignified and serious. His prudence, strengthened by parental care and example, no doubt guarded him in his youth, when exposed to the dissolute company which unavoidably attends a seafaring life; whilst religion, influencing his mind by its secret guidance in silent reflection, has, in advancing manhood, added to the brightness of his character, and instituted or confirmed his disposition to practical good. Latterly, he made application, and was received into membership with the respectable Society of Friends."

THE BRAGGE FAMILY.

The accession in 1820 of the Hon. Augustus Theophilus Bragge to the property of a maternal uncle in a central English county, caused a prodigious sensation. Mr Bragge was the younger brother of an Irish peer, and, having been previously limited to a very small income for the support of a large family, had been one of the first persons to repair to the Continent after the restoration of the Bourbons, in order to educate his daughters with less expense than would have been incurred at home. This circumstance, however, did not transpire, and he entered upon his estate with all the eclat of his connection with an old baronial family, unalloyed by the stigma of previous poverty. The eldest of Mr Bragge's growing up daughters had reached her twenty-second year; the youngest was about fifteen; there was a baby besides, and three or four sons. All the girls were remarkably handsome; their beauty was of that striking and attractive kind which is recognised at once, and cannot be disputed. The three elder girls were out, the fourth coming out, and the two others ready to come out whenever a marriage in the family should afford a vacant seat in Mrs Bragge's carriage.

Seventeen years ago, the quiet society of the English counties was comparatively little acquainted with foreign manners. The admiration, therefore, excited by the Misses Bragge, was not unmingled with surprise. Their natural vivacity, aided by a French education, rendered them very different from the pattern young ladies of their circle. Fortunately, they were very good-tempered and obliging; and though they waltzed to excess, and wore shorter petticoats than ever had been seen before, it was only the very rigid and censorious who ventured any disparaging remark. Mr Bragge commenced his career in England by keeping open house. He made no invidious distinctions respecting his visitors, receiving all comers with a hearty hospitality worthy of old times. The family took possession of the estate in the month of August, and immediately a scene of festivity commenced, which lasted without intermission until the return of the season called them to London. Such riding, and driving, and pic-nicking to every place in the neighbourhood where there was any thing to be seen! It was thought nothing to go fifteen or twenty miles to a ball; and the intention of the Bragges to be present was sure to congregate all the beauty, fashion, and bachelorhood of the vicinity.

The place in which public assemblies were held at Singleton, at the period of which we write, was a building erected over the market, and rather oddly constructed—no unusual circumstance in a country town. It had at first been approached by an outside stair; but, this being found very inconvenient, another entrance had been opened under cover, and the company now walked through the butcher's shambles into a small dark vestibule, which

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led, in the first instance, to a large kitchen, in which on market-days the farmers usually dined from the smoking joints roasted at immense fireplaces at either end. On ball nights, this apartment was dedicated to the tea kettles which supplied boiling water for that beverage which cheers but not inebriates, together with negus and lemonade, forming the liquid refreshments provided on such occasions. A gloomy ill-lighted staircase led to a suite of four apartments, one being a small antechamber, in which stood the persons who received the tickets of the subscribers; the largest of the remaining three formed the ball-room, the two others being dedicated to tea and cards. All were dismal enough, being panelled with dark wood, or hung with dingy paper, and badly illuminated by a few very old-fashioned chandeliers, and girandoles made of an uncouth mixture of glass and brass, and calculated to hold a very small number of candles.

In 1820, the balls at Singleton had fallen off considerably. They had been for the most part limited to the genteeler sort among the town's-people who were eligible to be subscribers; and in consequence of the lame manner in which quadrilles were executed, country dances had maintained their ascendancy upon the floors long after they had been exploded from every other town. Six or eight lugubrious-looking couples would take their places in the centre of the dismal ball-room, and go through the evolutions in that spiritless manner, which a paucity of numbers upon any occasion of hilarity generally produces. The arrival of the Bragge family in the county changed the aspect of affairs. Mr Bragge senior, to oblige his daughters, consented to take the office of steward upon himself; and in consequence, a vast concourse of people were collected together—crowds which brought to mind the good old times in the remembrance of the oldest inhabitants of the place. Previously to this era, the Misses Tollemache had led the fashion in the neighbourhood of Singleton. They were very fine girls; very correct in their deportment, and had the character of being proud and difficult. Hitherto an attendance at the balls at Singleton had been considered too great a condescension by these young ladies; and their absence kept many others away, few liking to go to a place which the Tollemaches despised. A spirit of rivalry now operated as a stimulant, and determined them to take the field against the Bragges. The latter family were at first wholly unconscious of the jealous feelings which they excited; they entered the ball-room solely in pursuit of pleasure, and gave themselves up to the unrestrained indulgence of the gaiety of their hearts. They were constantly surrounded by all the beaux, while the Tollemaches were comparatively neglected, being only asked to dance by those who had failed in securing a hand of the Misses Bragge. Three of the four sisters, for the one who was coming out in London had come out in the country, were nearly equally the objects of admiration; but Miss Bragge, the eldest, was universally pronounced to bear away the palm, and to her standard the elite of the male portion of the assembly flocked. Amongst many others, she attracted the great man of the neighbourhood, Sir Charles Dorrington, a young baronet of large fortune, who was supposed to be looking out for a wife. This gentleman had paid some attention to the elder Miss Tollemache, and had been universally set down as her admirer; but before matters had gone too far, the appearance of Miss Bragge changed the spirit of his dream, and he now exhibited himself as the devoted slave of the new beauty.

The card-players of the balls at Singleton had been, time out of mind, subjected to two distinct species of annoyance, the one being the smoke, which, when the wind set in a particular direction, poured down the chimney, whether there was any fire in the apartment or not—the other, the irruptions of young ladies with their partners, who would sit down and talk, sometimes in a loud key, about nonsense, which distracted the attention of all the whist players, and sometimes in a low tone, which would occasion some very inquisitive old lady or gentleman, anxious to catch the purport of the conversation, to revoke. Upon the present evening, Miss Bragge and Sir Charles Dorrington proved the greatest delinquents. After almost every dance, they bolted in, seated themselves behind the door, and talked incessantly. Some people averred that an offer was certainly made and accepted; but as the parties had never met before, this seemed premature. Miss Tollemache looked on with suppressed rage. The tide of popularity ran so strongly in favour of the Bragges, that prudence dictated a pacific appearance, since any show of hostility would have been attributed to jealousy; and therefore the Misses Tollemache admitted at once, that the Bragges were very fine girls, with exceedingly enviable spirits. "It was certainly merely a matter of taste," they continued, "but, for their part, they liked less display; these foreign manners did not quite suit them." The Misses Tollemache had a brother, with whom they waltzed in turn; thus showing off their figures, without incurring the odium which attached itself to those who were less scrupulous in the choice of a partner. Young Tollemache, who would rather have danced with one of the Bragges, thought the duty a bore, and wished that his mother would take the girls to France to get rid of their starch; but Lady Jane Tollemache, who had been a great favourite of old Queen Charlotte in her day, loudly expressed her determination that her daughters should never make such an exhibition of themselves. She drew a small circle around her, who fully concurred in her views of propriety, and who felt assured that the example of a few persons like herself would check the progress of that general licence which threatened to change the face of society.

The balls at Singleton were generally over by two o'clock in the morning; it seemed quite impossible to sustain life till a later hour upon tea, bread and butter, and weak negus. At an early hour in the evening, Sir Charles Dorrington had suggested the scheme of a supper at a neighbouring inn. The Bragges eagerly acceded to the plan, and a few choice spirits were collected for the purpose. The Tollemache family were invited as a matter of form; but Lady Jane gave a dignified refusal, and looked daggers at her son, who, having packed up his sisters in the family coach, ran to offer his arm to Emily Bragge, who skipped across the street and over the gutters in her white satin shoes, with some flimsy thing of a shawl over her head. It was reported next day that the Misses Bragge sang after supper, which, though allowable in the mansion of a friend, was deemed highly improper at a public inn. The party, however, was a very joyous one, and it led to the proposal of a ball to be given by the bachelors at the same place. So brilliant an affair had never been heard of at Singleton before. The Bragges were the queens of the evening, while the eldest daughter might be called the empress; their dresses had come direct from Paris, and were unlike any thing that had been seen in England before, while it was remarked that the eternal white satin of the Tollemaches had a very heavy appearance. If any doubt could have remained upon the minds of the spectators respecting the intentions of Sir Charles, they were now dissipated. It was very certain that he desired nothing so much as to become the husband of the beautiful girl, whom, against all the rules of etiquette, he led to the supper room, and seated at his right hand at the top of the table, above all the matrons and dowagers of the party. Henrietta Tollemache almost made up her mind to the loss of the young baronet, and by every body the marriage of the happy pair was looked upon as a settled thing.

No such marriage, however, took place. Miss Bragge, having the vision of a ducal coronet flitting before her eyes, refused the baronet. Sir Charles, though at first disposed to give way to despair, consoled himself with the idea that time and assiduity would work a change in his favour. He was not aware of the ambition which lurked in the bosom of the lady of his affections, while she, satisfied with having assured him of her determination, considered herself at liberty to receive attentions paid under, what she chose to consider, a full knowledge of the state of the case. Mrs Bragge, who was of an indolent disposition, and had no voice in the family, regretted this rejection. With so many daughters, she thought it a good thing to get one off her hands, and was of opinion that Geraldine's marriage with Sir Charles would save a great deal of trouble. Other offers were made, and refused; and some of the cavaliers, either more or less sensitive than the baronet, withdrew upon the failure of their hopes; the remainder, assured of the consequences of hazarding a proposal, contented themselves with laughing, and talking, and flirting, and in this manner time sped upon its lightest pinions. The shooting season brought quantities of young men to Mr Bragge's manors, to the great detriment of the game, and the no small diminution of the contents of the cellar. Every body went out in the morning, either to knock down the hares and the partridges, or to lunch with the sportsmen in some approved spot. Riding and driving occupied the remainder of the day until dinner, and in the evening there was music and dancing. With the addition of the female visitors, the Bragges could always get up a ball without extraneous aid, and the arrival of Christmas brought with it fresh sets of company, and fresh methods of beguiling time. Meanwhile, Mr Bragge's grown-up sons thought themselves entitled to live in the style becoming their expectations. One, who was with his regiment, kept up a very gay establishment; and the eldest, being the heir, divided his time between Melton Mowbray and home, with occasional visits to distant parts of the country, in which good hunting was to be had.

At length Easter arrived, and the Bragges took their departure for London, leaving the county in a state of quietude which it had not enjoyed for many a long day. Intelligence of the festivities in which the family had been engaged in the great metropolis, was duly forwarded to Singleton through the medium of the fashionable papers. The coteries of the town learned that four of the Misses Bragge had been presented at court, and though rather puzzled by the mystical language in which the account of their dresses was conveyed, understood that they made a very brilliant appearance. Frequent mention was subsequently made of the beautiful sisters; and in the course of a few weeks the following announcement showed that the expectations entertained by the family of an alliance with the peerage, were not without foundation:—"Married, at St George's Church, Hanover Square, by the Hon. and Rev. the Dean, &c., Lord Viscount Rossallan, &c., to Letitia Eugenia, third daughter of the Hon. Augustus Theophilus Bragge, of —— Hall, in ——shire." This was rather a surprise to the good folks of the country, since, according to their unsophisticated notions, Letitia Bragge seemed to be the least amiable of the family. There was an expression in her countenance which might be taken for a sneer; she had not the vivacity which characterised her sisters, and there were some persons who went so far as to say that they thought her a little stupid, and rather ill tempered. How it so happened that the qualities of her mind, which were thus stigmatised in the country, procured her more favour in London than was accorded to the other Misses Bragge, they could not make out. In the simplicity of their hearts, the Singletonians felt quite assured, that, as the third daughter had become a viscountess, the oldest would be a marchioness at least, and might look up to a ducal coronet. Geraldine unfortunately thought the same, and the illusion was fostered by the attentions of a young duke, which, however, never came to any thing; and at the end of the London season, Mr Bragge returned into the country, with all his family about him, Lady Rossallan alone excepted. Soon after their arrival, Lady Jane Tollemache discovered, greatly to her vexation, that her only son George, who was just of age, had engaged himself to Emily Bragge. She had perceived a good deal of dancing and flirting going on between the parties during the spring; but as she had given her opinion pretty strongly regarding the young lady, she concluded that an only son, so well brought up, and so fully warned respecting the consequences of such an alliance, would never think of doing so mad a thing. She was mistaken; and George proclaimed that he had arrived at the age of indiscretion, by leading Emily to the altar, which proved a severe blow to Lady Jane and her daughters. Sir Charles Dorrington was observed to be as attentive as ever to Miss Bragge, but with the success of Lady Rossallan before her eyes, and a young duke in her head, she could not be prevailed upon to listen to him.

The recess passed away nearly in the same manner that the preceding one had done; the two younger girls came out, so that there were still four Misses Bragge to be seen at all the balls and races; Geraldine, however, continuing to be considered the flower of the family. The next London season produced nothing, at least nothing of consequence; the young duke who had been so attentive, married somebody else, but his place was supplied by an earl, who, it was thought, would certainly propose. This nobleman had promised to spend a part of the shooting season at Bragge Hall; consequently there could be no hope for Sir Charles Dorrington; and, either tired of the pursuit, or convinced of the utter heartlessness of its object, he withdrew his pretensions. In a mood of mind to be grateful for the flattering conviction that he had been long favourably regarded by another, he fell in with Henrietta Tollemache, who very adroitly drew him into matrimony. The earl did not fulfil his engagement, and Miss Bragge, for the first time in her life, found herself without any professed dangler. She determined to make good use of the following season, but it brought out some formidable competitors. Lady Rossallan was on the Continent, and the circle which George Tollemache drew around him, did not offer any thing of sufficient consequence to induce her to relinquish the chances of another season. People now began to reckon the number of years during which Miss Bragge had been out. Her sister Stella had deemed it full time to marry, and, failing to procure a suitable establishment, accepted the hand of an officer who held a high command in a South American service, and who, having been well introduced, and covered with orders, had passed himself off as a very great personage at Notaxcanpaia, or some such place. Mr Bragge's estate was now discovered to be not quite equal to the demands made upon it. The family, therefore, not finding it convenient to return to the country, went to rusticate at Boulogne. A winter in Paris was subsequently tried, and some very ruinous expenditure incurred, and, after various chances and changes, the family settled at Cheltenham. It happened, shortly afterwards, that Miss Bragge, in paying a visit to her sister Mrs Tollemache, came to Singleton by the stage-coach, and, while waiting for the carriage, which her brother-in-law had promised to send for her, gazed upon the site of the theatre of her former glories. The site only remained, for, in the progress of improvement, the market-place and the clumsy building above it had disappeared, the former being removed to another part of the town. Some better feelings passed across her mind, and, turning from the window, her eyes encountered a looking-glass. The form reflected there was certainly very different from that which, years before, had been displayed upon its surface. All its youth and freshness were gone; the face was haggard and care-worn; the figure had lost its roundness; and she sighed as she reflected upon the waste of years, and the foolish ambition which had led her to despise the blessings within her reach. Her mortifications did not end here, for she was obliged to meet Sir Charles and Lady Dorrington very frequently, and many a bitter tear did she shed in secret over the wreck of all her hopes. On her return to Cheltenham, she found it impossible to settle down. The appearance of the house, its mean decayed furniture, bearing marks of the destructive propensities of many a former tenant, the apology for a man servant, the ill-served dinner, and the difficulty of procuring fitting apparel for the parties which still formed the sole amusement of her life, impressed her with the necessity of striking some bold stroke. There were still two sisters besides herself unmarried—one who was a confirmed invalid, and upon whose account they were obliged to continue at Cheltenham—and another, the baby mentioned in a preceding paragraph, who had grown up into rather a fine girl, but very inferior in personal attractions to her elder sisters. This young person, who had never known the splendour formerly enjoyed by the family, was quite as eager after amusement as her sisters had been, and carried on the same sort of pursuits, though in a very limited sphere. During a visit to Lady Rossallan, Geraldine had succeeded in captivating a man of large property, and hopes which had long lain dormant, now revived. She was unfortunately obliged to return home before the affair could be settled, but was speedily followed by her admirer. He had been charmed by the spirit, elegance, and intelligence of Miss Bragge; but the sight of her youngest sister, who, though immeasurably inferior to what she had been, had now, with some resemblance, the advantages of youth and natural brilliancy, changed the object of his pursuit, and he made an offer to Elizabeth. Mr Bragge, too happy to marry a daughter so well, gave his consent. The young lady had been brought up in a school in which self-interest was more considered than any finer sentiment. She therefore made no objection, and Geraldine was obliged to conceal her feelings of mortification as best she might.

At this time several other very disagreeable things occurred. Mrs Huddersfield, who had come back a widow from South America, with four children, and the promise of a pension from the Notaxcanpaian government, was very much in the way of Miss Bragge. The family finances also grew worse and worse, and they were threatened with a terrible affair between the Tollemaches. George Tollemache, inexperienced and indiscreet, had been guilty of many acts of worse than folly; and his wife, writhing under his neglect, had, by way of recalling him, endeavoured to excite in him the dangerous sentiment of jealousy. Her mother and sisters-in-law, by whom she was hated, took advantage of this mistaken policy to poison the mind of her husband against her. A separation, under very painful circumstances, was anticipated; and though, through the generous interference of Sir Charles Dorrington, the breach was to outward appearance healed, the ill treatment which she had received, and the sense of the rashness of the attempt which she had made to revive her husband's affection, sank deep in Emily's heart. She never recovered it; and her death, which took place soon afterwards, proved the result of

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the wretched system of education which had left the happiness of the Bragge family to the direction of chance.

The Hon. Augustus Theophilus, long compelled to find all his amusement at the card table, had sunk into the second stage of a gambler's existence, and, having acquired experience, preyed in turn upon the unwary. Disagreeable stories of the Bragges, some entirely false, and all exaggerated, now furnished a large portion of the conversation of the place. Geraldine, though smarting under the wounds inflicted by these reports, and suffering from the slights which she daily sustained, could not bring herself to contemplate a life of seclusion, and felt as little inclination as ever to receive lessons of wisdom. She still, however, hoped that fortune had something in store for her; but, meanwhile, nothing could be more dismal than her prospects, or more disagreeable than her situation.

At length—to come to the conclusion of our story of the Bragge family—an elderly nobleman, who had buried three wives, and was suspected of an intention of taking a fourth, arrived at Cheltenham. He was guarded by a couple of dragons in the shape of unmarried daughters, who watched him with the utmost circumspection. They were, however, obliged to enter society, and to renew an acquaintance with Lady Jane Tollemache, notwithstanding their secret dread of Isabella, who, quite as anxious to be married as Geraldine could be, smoothed her brow, and enlivened her usually sour aspect with a smile. Notwithstanding all her misfortunes, smiles were more naturally familiar to the lips of Geraldine; and Lord Wreldesworth, just as he was beginning to wish that Miss Tollemache did not look quite so precise and old-maidish, encountered his old acquaintance Miss Bragge. His eyes might have been a little dim, but it appeared to him that she did not seem a month older than on the night when, in his second wife's lifetime, he had been so enchanted with her waltzing at a fashionable London assembly. Lord Wreldesworth, who had been for some time exceedingly manageable, now broke through all control. He would go and visit the Bragges; lent the father a hundred pounds, just for old acquaintance sake; and, finally, in despite of the rage and vexation of his daughters, and the talk of all Cheltenham, he married Geraldine Bragge. It would be preposterous to say that this late alliance possessed a single redeeming feature. On both sides, it was like most marriages in what are called the higher ranks, perfectly heartless, and was attended with the usual heartless results.

[In the preceding paper the reader will probably recognise the lively descriptive power of an English female writer, who has lately contributed some equally entertaining and correct sketches of provincial manners. We cannot allow the Bragge family to pass from under our notice without expressing our deep regret—living, as we do, and *feeling*, like Singletonians—that, in the superior spheres of English society, the love of splendour and distinction should be so absorbing a passion. With all the advantages of the present advanced state of things, it is to be feared that the more generous and unselfish feelings have yet but little play amongst us. To quote the language of a work, of which a short critical notice has chanced to fall under our attention,* "The very arts which seem most to raise and embellish life, introduce in their train habits of effeminacy and self-indulgence. They create new wants, which become, in turn, from servants, masters. They concentrate the entire being within self; they render self-sacrifice an absurdity, duty a difficulty; they add to riches a fictitious value, measured by the lowest passions of our nature." These are sad truths; nor do we see, in existing institutions, the means of giving a different current to mind in the superior circles of society. From causes, however, now in operation, it is not improbable that the light of a superior morality will soon dawn in the lower departments of our community, whence it can scarcely fail in time to ascend to the higher.]

BETTING AT NEWMARKET AND DONCASTER.

The principal race-ground in England is at Newmarket, where the Jockey-Club have been the proprietors of the course since 1753. Betting is here carried on to an inconceivable extent. "Betting-posts (says the author of "the Chase, the Road, and the Turf") are placed on various parts of the heath, at some one of which the sportsmen assemble immediately after each race, to make their bets on the one that is to follow. As not more than half an hour elapses between the events, the scene is of the most animated description, and a stranger would imagine that all the tongues of Babel were let loose again. No country produces such a scene as this, and he would feel a difficulty in reconciling the proceedings of the gentlemen of the betting-ring with the accounts he might read the next morning in the newspapers of the distressed state of England, or that money was scarce any where. All bets lost at Newmarket are paid the following morning, in the town, and L.50,000, or more, have been known to exchange hands in one day." The writer might have added, that in all probability a principal share, if not the whole of this sum, ought to have been paid to creditors, instead of being thrown away among horse-jockeys and gamblers. The same author mentions a circumstance which occurred in 1834 at Doncaster, which shows that, among noblemen and gentlemen, there are other modes of cheating than by the *sauter la coupe* trick. "A bet of a thousand guineas was made by two persons, renowned on the turf, whom we shall call A and B. A backed the field against certain horses named by B, of which horses, Touchstone, the winner, was *not* one. B, however, claimed the bet, and produced *his* list, in which Touchstone, the winner, *was named at the bottom of it*. A also produced his list, in which Touchstone, the winner, was not named by B, and was therefore a winner for him. The Jockey-Club was resorted to, and the following was the result of their investigation: 'The name of Touchstone,' said Mr Wilson, 'certainly appears in B's list, and *apparently* written with the same ink. Now, my old friend Roberts the banker told me, there is a species of ink that can be made to match any shade which that liquid may exhibit, if examined by day-light; but if put to the test of a candle, a difference of tint is plainly shown. Let the room be made dark, then, and candles produced.' Now, mark the result, which we are sorry thus to proclaim to the world, particularly as the offending party writes Honourable before his name. 'Let the *gentleman* be shown into the room,' said Mr Wilson, when he pronounced the following verdict: 'A wins from B one thousand guineas!' It was a forgery."

* Education Reform, by Thomas Wyse, Esq. M.P.

TEXAS.—FOURTH ARTICLE.

Whatever may have been the secret or petty causes of quarrel betwixt the Mexicans and Texians, the substantial grievance of the settlers, that which precipitated them into an open contest, was the unconstitutional act of the Mexicans in 1835, abolishing the federal system of state legislatures, and centralising the whole machinery of government in the city of Mexico. This was a dreadful error in policy, for, even although it may have been for certain reasons desirable, nay, granting it was effected by means strictly within the limits of the constitution, it was not what the Anglo-Americans from the United States had calculated upon, or bargained for, at the period of their settlement, and therefore afforded them a strong ground of truth in declaring themselves ill-used. The regularly constituted legislation of Coahuila and Texas protested against the decree, but, as we formerly stated, resistance was of no avail. The people of Texas, taking advantage of the unsettled state of affairs, perhaps wishing to bring things to a crisis, refused to pay taxes, expelled the custom-house officers, shut up the custom-house, and set the laws of Mexico at defiance. The chief of the central government was Santa Anna, who, having quelled all the resisting non-complying states except Texas, now took measures to bring it under his supreme authority. In September 1835, he dispatched General Coss, with 700 men, to bring the Texians to submission. Coss landed at Campano, and issued a proclamation, in which he stated his objects to be—to enforce the laws, collect the revenue, punish fraudulent speculators, and disarm the insurgents. From Campano he marched to Goliad, and thence to San Antonio de Bexar. The local legislature was now dissolved by force of arms, which was the signal for civil war. On the 7th of November, the Texians issued a declaration, in which they assumed the character of an independent people, and fairly defied the Mexicans to put them down. They at the same time established a provisional government, and endeavoured by loans, and assistance of men and arms from the United States, to maintain what they called their rights. Battles, sieges, skirmishes, and all the ordinary horrors of warfare, followed. At the city of San Antonio de Bexar, several severe encounters took place. The city was first taken by the Mexicans, but afterwards captured by the Texian forces. Santa Anna, with a large army, next advanced to recapture it, and on this occasion a dreadful slaughter ensued. One of the most intrepid defenders of the fort, or the Alamo, as it was called, was Colonel Crockett, whose droll adventures we have occasionally noticed. The following extract from his posthumous work, in which are his daily memoranda of the events of the siege, cannot fail to be perused with interest.

"Feb. 22, (1836.)—The Mexicans, about sixteen hundred strong, with their president, Santa Anna, at their head, aided by Generals Almonte, Coss, Sesma, and Castrillon, are within two leagues of Bexar. We are up and doing, and as lively as cheese in the dog-days. —23d. Early this morning the enemy came in sight, marching in regular order, and displaying their strength to the greatest advantage, in order to strike us with terror. But that was no go; they'll find that they have to do with men who will never lay down their arms as long as they can stand on their legs. We held a short council of war, and, finding that we should be completely surrounded, and overwhelmed by numbers, if we remained in the town, we concluded to withdraw to the fortress of Alamo, and defend it to the last extremity. We accordingly filed off, in good order, having some days before placed all the surplus provisions, arms, and ammunition, in the fortress. We have had a large national flag made; it is composed of thirteen stripes, red and white, alternately, on a blue ground, with a large white star, of five points in the centre, and between the points the letters Texas. As soon as all our little band, about one hundred and fifty in number, had entered and secured the fortress in the best possible manner, we set about raising our flag on the battlements; on which occasion there was no one more active than my young friend the Bee-hunter. The enemy marched into Bexar, and took possession of the town, a blood-red flag flying at their head, to indicate that we need not expect quarters if we should fall into their clutches.

24th. Very early this morning the enemy commenced a new battery on the banks of the river, about three hundred and fifty yards from the fort, and by afternoon they amused themselves by firing at us from that quarter.—25th. The firing commenced early this morning, but the Mexicans are poor engineers, for we haven't lost a single man, and our outworks have sustained no injury. Our sharpshooters have brought down a considerable number of stragglers at a long shot. The Bee-hunter keeps the whole garrison in good heart with his songs and his jests, and his daring and determined spirit. He is about the quickest on the trigger, and the best rifle shot we have in the fort. I have already seen him bring down eleven of the enemy, and at such a distance we all thought it would be waste of ammunition to attempt it. His gun is first-rate, quite equal to my Betsey, though she has not quite as many trinkets about her. This day a small party sallied out of the fort for wood and water, and had a slight skirmish with three times their number from the division under General Sesma. The Bee-hunter headed them, and beat the enemy off, after killing three. On opening his Bible at night, of which he always reads a portion before going to rest, he found a musket ball in the middle of it. 'See here, colonel,' said he, 'how they have treated the valued present of my dear little Kate of Nacogdoches.' 'It has saved your life,' said I. 'True,' replied he, more seriously than usual; 'and I am not the first sinner whose life has been saved by this book.' He prepared for bed, and before retiring he prayed, and returned thanks for his providential escape; and I heard the name of Catherine mingle in his prayer.—27th. Provisions are becoming scarce, and the enemy are endeavouring to cut off our water. If they attempt to stop our grog in that manner, let them look out, for we shall become too wrathy for our shirts to hold us. We are not prepared to submit to an excise of that nature, and they'll find it out. This discovery has created considerable excitment in the fort.—28th. Last night our hunters brought in some corn and hogs, and had a brush with a scout from the enemy beyond gun-shot of the fort. They put the scout to flight and got in without injury. They bring accounts that the settlers are flying in all quarters, in dismay, leaving their possessions to the mercy of the ruthless invader, who is literally engaged in a war of extermination, more brutal than the untutored savage of the desert could be guilty of. Slaughter is indiscriminate, sparing neither sex, age, nor condition. Buildings have been burnt down, farms laid waste, and Santa Anna appears determined to verify his threat, and convert the blooming paradise into a howling wilderness.—29th. Before day-break we saw General Sesma leave his camp with a large body of cavalry and infantry, and move off in the direction of Goliad. We think that he must have received news of Colonel Fanning's coming to our relief. We are all in high spirits at the prospect of being able to give the rascals a fair shake on the plain. This business of being shut up makes a man wolfish. I had a little sport this morning before breakfast. The enemy had planted a piece of ordinance within gun-shot of the fort during the night, and the first thing in the morning they commenced a brisk cannonade, point-blank, against the spot where I was snoring. I turned out pretty smart, and mounted the rampart. The gun was charged again, a fellow stepped forth to touch her off, but before he could apply the match, I let him have it, and he keeled over. A second stepped up, snatched the match from the hand of the dying man, but Thimblerig, who had followed me, handed me his rifle, and the next instant the Mexican was stretched on the earth beside the first. A third came up to the cannon, my companion handed me another gun, and I fixed him off in like manner. A fourth, then a fifth, seized the match, who both met with the same fate, and then the whole party gave it up as a bad job, and hurried off to the camp, leaving the cannon ready charged where they had planted it. I came down, took my bitters, and went to breakfast.

March 1. The enemy's forces have been increasing in numbers daily, notwithstanding they have already lost about three hundred men in the several assaults they have made upon us. I neglected to mention in the proper place, that, when the enemy came in sight, we had but three bushels of corn in the garrison, but have since found eighty bushels in a deserted house. Colonel Bowie's illness still continues, but he manages to crawl from his bed every day, that his comrades may see him. His presence alone is a tower of strength. The enemy becomes more daring as his numbers increase.—3d. We have given over all hopes of receiving assistance from Goliad or Refugio. Colonel Travis harangued the garrison, and concluded by exhorting them, in case the enemy should carry the fort, to fight to the last gasp, and render their victory even more serious to them than to us. This was followed by three cheers.—4th. Shells have been falling into the fort like hail during the day, but without effect. —5th. Pop, pop, pop! Bom, bom, bom! throughout the day. No time for memorandums now. Go ahead! Liberty and independence for ever!"

Here ends Colonel Crockett's manuscript, and his literary executor takes up the thread of the narrative.

"The hand is cold that wrote the foregoing pages, and it devolves upon another to record the subsequent events. Before daybreak, on the 6th of March, the Alamo was assaulted by the whole force of the Mexican army, commanded by Santa Anna in person. The battle was desperate until daylight, when only six men belonging to the Texian garrison were found alive. They were instantly surrounded, and ordered, by General Castrillon, to surrender, which they did, under a promise of his protection, finding that resistance any longer would be madness. Colonel Crockett was of the number. He stood alone in an angle of the fort, the barrel of his shattered rifle in his right hand, in his left his huge knife dripping blood. There was a

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frightful gash across his forehead, while around him there was a complete barrier of about twenty Mexicans, lying pell-mell, dead and dying. At his feet lay the dead body of that well-known character, designated in the Colonel's narrative by the assumed name of Thimblerig.

General Castrillon was brave and not cruel, and disposed to save the prisoners. He marched them up to that part of the fort where stood Santa Anna and his murderous crew. The steady fearless step and undaunted tread of Colonel Crockett on this occasion, together with the bold demeanour of the hardy veteran, had a powerful effect on all present. Nothing daunted, he marched up boldly in front of Santa Anna, and looked him sternly in the face, while Castrillon addressed 'his excellency'—'Sir, here are six prisoners I have taken alive; how shall I dispose of them?' Santa Anna looked at Castrillon fiercely, flew into a violent rage, and replied, 'Have I not told you before how to dispose of them? Why do you bring them to me?' At the same time his brave officers plunged their swords into the bosoms of their defenceless prisoners. Colonel Crockett, seeing the act of treachery, instantly sprang like a tiger at the ruffian chief, but before he could reach him a dozen swords were sheathed in his indomitable heart; and he fell, and died without a groan, a frown on his brow, and a smile of scorn and defiance on his lips. Castrillon rushed from the scene, apparently horror-struck, sought his quarters, and did not leave them for several days, and hardly spoke to Santa Anna after."

A few days after this disaster, the Texians under General Houston surprised Santa Anna's camp, overpowered his forces, and took himself prisoner. The advantage which they thus gained, they turned to a good account, by endeavouring to bring about a settlement of their affairs.

THE PICKWICK PAPERS.

About twelve months ago, we recommended a work, entitled "Sketches by Boz," to the notice of our readers, at the same time expressing a hope that the author would proceed in the course he had adopted of depicting life and character in and about the metropolis. We are extremely glad to find that the distinguished success of Boz's first production has encouraged him to launch forth as a regular contributor to the public amusement. At the present moment he is unrivalled in the peculiar line he has selected, and, to the wonder of every body, has risen from comparative obscurity to a high point of fame in the short space of a single year. Town readers are so well acquainted with Boz and his writings, that it may look like impertinence for us to say any thing regarding either the one or the other; but as in all likelihood there are some forty or fifty thousand of our Scotch and country friends who hardly ever heard of his existence, we take the liberty of adverting to his style of writing, and the subjects he has lately been engaged upon.

Boz is the fictitious signature of a young man named Dickens, who was for some years engaged as a writer in one of the London newspapers, which he enlivened with his humorous and graphic sketches. We are not aware that he is a native of London, but he has at least, by his residence there, made himself minutely familiar with the peculiarities of the people, chiefly of the middle and lower ranks, which he has the knack of hitting off in a singularly droll and happy manner. We have never visited London without noticing that it possessed a prodigious fund of character for description, and yet, since the time of Smollett, this inexhaustible fund has lain untouched. The most odd-looking and odd-speaking beings were suffered to vegetate unheeded, unchronicled, except when partially brought into notice by a foreigner—Washington Irving. Upon this mine of character and manners, Boz has successfully struck. He is now busy in the work of excavation. The chief talent of this clever writer consists in close perception, not only of character, but of every minute circumstance and local peculiarity. Nothing escapes his notice, or fails to be made the subject of humorous observation. In order to deal out the results of his experience to the best advantage, he lately began, and is now issuing, a series of monthly pamphlets, called the "Posthumous Papers of the Pickwick Club—containing a faithful record of the perambulations, perils, travels, adventures, and sporting transactions of the corresponding members." The principal figurants in this medley of character are Mr Pickwick, the founder of the club which goes by his name, and his servant, Sam Weller. It is scarcely necessary to say that this worthy pair get into all sorts of adventures in town and country, affording a fair field for the exercise of the writer's talent for description. One of the best hit-off scenes in the papers already published, is that in which Mr Pickwick first becomes acquainted with Sam. We give it as a sample of Boz's Pickwickian style:—

There are in London several old inns, once the headquarters of celebrated coaches in the days when coaches performed their journeys in a graver and more solemn manner than they do in these times; but which have now degenerated into little more than the abiding and booking places of country waggons. The reader would look in vain for any of these ancient hostelries among the Golden Crosses and Bull and Mouths, which rear their stately fronts in the improved streets of London. If he would light upon any of these old places, he must direct his steps to the obscurer quarters of the town; and there, in some secluded nooks, he will find several still standing, with a kind of gloomy sturdiness, amidst the modern innovations which surround them.

In the Borough especially, there still remain some half dozen old inns, which have preserved their external features unchanged, and which have escaped alike the rage for public improvement, and the encroachments of private speculation. Great, rambling, queer old places they are, with galleries, and passages, and staircases, wide enough and antiquated enough to furnish materials for a hundred ghost stories, supposing we should ever be reduced to the lamentable necessity of inventing any, and that the world should exist long enough to exhaust the innumerable veracious legends connected with old London Bridge, and its adjacent neighbourhood on the Surrey side.

It was in the yard of one of these inns—of no less celebrated a one than the White Hart—that a man was busily employed in brushing the dirt off a pair of boots, early on the morning succeeding the events narrated in the last chapter. He was habited in a coarse-striped waistcoat, with black calico sleeves, and blue glass buttons: drab breeches and leggings. A bright red handkerchief was wound in a very loose and unstudied style round his neck, and an old white hat was carelessly thrown on one side of his head. There were two rows of boots before him, one cleaned and the other dirty, and at every addition he made to the clean row, he paused from his work, and contemplated its results with evident satisfaction.

The yard presented none of that bustle and activity which are the usual characteristics of a large coach inn. Three or four lumbering waggons, each with a pile of goods beneath its ample canopy, about the height of the second-floor window of an ordinary house, were stowed away beneath a lofty roof which extended over one end of the yard; and another, which was probably to commence its journey that morning, was drawn out into the open space. A double tier of bedroom galleries, with old clumsy balustrades, ran round two sides of the straggling area, and a double row of bells to correspond, sheltered from the weather by a little sloping roof, hung over the door leading to the bar and coffee-room. Two or three gigs and chaise-carts were wheeled up under different little sheds and penthouses; and the occasional heavy tread of a cart-horse, or rattling of a chain at the further end of the yard, announced to any body who cared about the matter, that the stable lay in that direction. When we add that a few boys in smockfrocks were lying asleep on heavy packages, woolpacks, and other articles that were scattered about on heaps of straw, we have described as fully as need be, the general appearance of the yard of the White Hart Inn, High Street, Borough, on the particular morning in question.

A loud ringing of one of the bells was followed by the appearance of a smart chambermaid in the upper sleeping gallery, who, after tapping at one of the doors, and receiving a request from within, called over the balustrades, "Sam!" "Hallo," replied the man with the white hat. "No. 22 wants his boots." "Ask No. 22 vether he'll have 'em now, or vait till he gets 'em," was the reply. "Come, don't be a fool, Sam," said the girl, coaxingly; "the gentleman wants his boots directly."

"Well, you *are* a nice young 'ooman for a musical party, you are," said the boot-cleaner. "Look at these here boots—eleven pair o' boots; and one shoe as b'longs to No. 6, with the wooden leg. The eleven boots is to be called at half-past eight, and the shoe at nine. Who's No. 22, that's to put all the others out? No, no; reg'lar rotation, as Jack Ketch said, ven he tied the men up. Sorry to keep you a-watin', sir, but I'll attend to you directly." Saying which, the man in the white hat set to work upon a top-boot with increased assiduity.

There was another loud ring; and the bustling old landlady of the White Hart made her appearance in the opposite gallery. "Sam," cried the landlady, "where's that lazy, idle—why Sam—oh, there you are; why don't you answer?" "Vouldn't be gen-teel to answer, 'till you'd done talking," replied Sam, gruffly. "Here, clean them shoes for No. 17 directly, and take 'em to private sitting-room, No. 5, first floor." The landlady flung a pair of lady's shoes into the yard, and bustled away.

"No. 5," said Sam, as he picked up the shoes, and taking a piece of chalk from his pocket, made a memorandum of their destination on the soles—"Lady's shoes, and private sittin' room! I suppose *she* didn't come in the waggin." "She came in early this morning," cried the girl, who was still leaning over the railing of the gallery, "with a gentleman in a hackney-coach, and it's him as wants his boots, and you'd better do 'em, and that's all about it." "Vy didn't you say so before?" said Sam, with great indignation, singling out the boots in question from the heap before him. "For all I know'd he vas one o' the regular three-pennies. Private room! and a lady, too! If he's any thing of a gen'lm'n, he's vurth a shillin' a-day, let alone the arrands."

Stimulated by this inspiring reflection, Mr Samuel brushed away with such hearty good will, that in a few minutes the boots and shoes, with a polish which would have struck envy to the soul of the amiable Mr Warren (for they used Day and Martin at the White Hart), had arrived at the door of No. 5. "Come in," said a man's voice, in reply to Sam's rap at the door. Sam made his best bow, and stepped into the presence of a lady and gentleman seated at breakfast. Having officiously deposited the gentleman's boots right and left at his feet, and the lady's shoes right and left at hers, he backed towards the door.

"Boots," said the gentleman. "Sir," said Sam, closing the door, and keeping his hand on the knob of the lock. "Do you know—what's a-name—Doctors' Commons?" "Yes, sir." "Where is it?" "Paul's Churchyard, sir; low archway on the carriage-side, bookseller's at one corner, hot-el on the other, and two porters in the middle as touts for licences."

"Touts for licences!" said the gentleman. "Touts for licences," replied Sam. "Two coves in white aprons—touches their hats ven you walk in—'Licence, sir, licence?' Queer sort, them, and their mas'rs too, sir—Old Bailey proctors—and no mistake." Having said which, and having paused for an instant to see whether he was wanted for any thing more, Sam left the room.

"Half-past nine—just the time—off at once;" said the gentleman, whom we need hardly introduce as Mr Jingle. "Time—for what?" said the spinster aunt, coquettishly. "Licence, dearest of angels—give notice at the church—call you mine, to-morrow"—said Mr Jingle, and he squeezed the spinster aunt's hand. "The licence!" said Rachael, blushing. "The licence," repeated Mr Jingle. "Don't be long," said the spinster, affectionately, as Mr Jingle stuck the pinched-up hat on his head. "Long away from *you*?—Cruel charmer," and Mr Jingle skipped playfully up to the spinster aunt, imprinted a chaste kiss upon her lips, and danced out of the room. "Dear man!" said the spinster, as the door closed after him. "Rum old girl," said Mr Jingle, as he walked down the passage.

It is painful to reflect upon the perfidy of our species; and we will not therefore pursue the thread of Mr Jingle's meditations as he wended his way to Doctors' Commons. It will be sufficient for our purpose to relate, that, escaping the snares of the dragons in white aprons, who guard the entrance to that enchanted region, he reached the Vicar-General's office in safety; and having procured a highly flattering address on parchment, from the Archbishop of Canterbury, to his "trusty and well-beloved Alfred Jingle and Rachael Wardle, greeting," he carefully deposited the mystic document in his pocket, and retraced his steps in triumph to the Borough.

He was yet on his way to the White Hart, when two plump gentlemen and one thin one entered the yard, and looked round in search of some authorised person of whom they could make a few inquiries. Mr Samuel Weller happened to be at that moment engaged in burnishing a pair of painted tops, the personal property of a farmer, who was refreshing himself with a slight lunch of two or three pounds of cold beef and a pot or two of porter, after the fatigues of the Borough market; and to him the thin gentleman straightway advanced—

"My friend," said the thin gentleman. "You're one o' the advice gratis order," thought Sam, "or you wouldn't be so werry fond o' me all at once." But he only said—"Well, sir." "My friend," said the thin gentleman, with a conciliatory hem, "have you got many people stopping here now? Pretty busy, eh?"

Sam stole a look at the inquirer. He was a little high-dried man, with a dark squeezed-up face, and small restless black eyes, that kept winking and twinkling on each side of his little inquisitive nose, as if they were playing a perpetual game of peep-bo with that feature. He was dressed all in black, with boots as shiny as his eyes, a low white neckcloth, and a clean shirt with a frill to it. A gold watch-chain and seals depended from his fob. He carried his black kid gloves *in* his hands, not *on* them; and as he spoke, thrust his wrists beneath his coat-tails, with the air of a man who was in the habit of propounding some regular posers.

"Pretty busy, eh?" said the little man. "Oh, werry well, sir," replied Sam; "we shan't be bankrupts, and we shan't make our fort'ns. We eats our biled mutton without capers, and don't care for horse-radish ven we can get beef." "Ah," said the little man, "you're a wag, a'nt you?" "My eldest brother was troubled with that complaint," said Sam; "it may be catching—I used to sleep with him." "This is a curious old house of yours," said the little man, looking round him. "If you'd sent word you was a-coming, we'd ha' had it repaired," replied the imperturbable Sam.

The little man seemed rather baffled by these several repulses, and a short consultation took place between him and the two plump gentlemen. At its conclusion, the little man took a pinch of snuff from an oblong silver box, and was apparently on the point of renewing the conversation, when one of the plump gentlemen, who, in addition to a benevolent countenance, possessed a pair of spectacles and a pair of black gaiters, interfered—"The fact of the matter is," said the benevolent gentleman, "that my friend here (pointing to the other plump gentleman) will give you half a guinea, if you'll answer one or two—"

"Now, my dear sir—my dear sir," said the little man, "pray allow me—my dear sir, the very first principle to be observed in these cases, is this; if you place a matter in the hands of a professional man, you must in no way interfere in the progress of the business; you must repose implicit confidence in him. Really, Mr (he turned to the other plump gentleman, and said)—I forget your friend's name."

"Pickwick," said Mr Wardle, for it was no other than that jolly personage. "Ah, Pickwick—really, Mr Pickwick, my dear sir, excuse me—I shall be happy to receive any private suggestions of yours, but you must see the impropriety of your interfering with my conduct in this case, with such an argument as the offer of half a guinea. Really, my dear sir, really," and the little man took an argumentative pinch of snuff, and looked very profound.

"You want me to accept of half a guinea," interrupted Sam; "werry well, I'm agreeable; I can't say no fairer than that, can I, sir? (Mr Pickwick smiled.) Then the next question is, what do you want with me?" "We want to know"—said Mr Wardle.

"Now, my dear sir—my dear sir," interposed the busy little man.

Mr Wardle shrugged his shoulders, and was silent. "We want to know," said the little man, solemnly; "and we ask the question of you, in order that we may not awaken apprehensions inside—we want to know who you've got in this house at present."

"Who there is in the house!" said Sam, in whose mind the inmates were always represented by that particular article of their costume which came under his immediate superintendence. "There's a wooden leg in No. 6, there's a pair of Hessians in 13, there's two pair of halves in the commercial, there's these here painted tops in the snuggery inside the bar, and five more tops in the coffee-room."

"Nothing more?" said the little man.

"Stop a bit," replied Sam, suddenly recollecting himself. "Yes; there's a pair of Vellingtons a good deal vorn, and a pair o' lady's shoes, in No. 5." "What sort of shoes?" hastily inquired Wardle, who, together with Mr Pickwick, had been lost in bewilderment at the singular catalogue of visitors.

"Country make," replied Sam. "Any maker's name?" "Brown." "Where of?" "Muggleton." "It *is* them," exclaimed Wardle. "We've found them."

"Hush!" said Sam. "The Vellingtons has gone to Doctors' Commons." "No," said the little man. "Yes,

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for a licence." "We're in time," exclaimed Wardle. "Show us the room; not a moment is to be lost."

"Pray, my dear sir—pray," said the little man; "caution, caution." He drew from his pocket a red silk purse, and looked very hard at Sam as he drew out a sovereign. Sam grinned expressively. "Show us into the room at once, without announcing us," said the little man, "and it's yours."

Sam threw the painted tops into a corner, and led the way through a dark passage, and up a wide staircase. He paused at the end of a second passage, and held out his hand. "Here it is," whispered the attorney, as he deposited the money in the hand of their guide. The man stepped forward for a few paces, followed by the two friends and their legal adviser. He stopped at a door. "Is this the room?" murmured the little gentleman. Sam nodded assent.

Old Wardle opened the door; and the whole three walked into the room just as Mr Jingle, who had that moment returned, had produced the licence to the spinster aunt.

The spinster uttered a loud shriek, and, throwing herself in a chair, covered her face with her hands. Mr Jingle crumpled up the licence, and thrust it into his coat-pocket. The unwelcome visitors advanced into the middle of the room.

"You—you are a nice rascal, ar'n't you?" exclaimed Wardle, breathless with passion. "My dear sir, my dear sir," said the little man, laying his hat on the table. "Pray, consider—pray. Defamation of character, action for damages. Calm yourself, my dear sir, pray—"

"How dare you drag my sister from my house?" said the old man. "Ay—ay—very good," said the little gentleman, "you may ask that. How dare you, sir?—eh, sir?" "Who are you?" inquired Mr Jingle, in so fierce a tone, that the little gentleman involuntarily fell back a step or two.

"Who is he, you scoundrel!" interposed Wardle. "He's my lawyer, Mr Perker, of Gray's Inn. Perker, I'll have this fellow prosecuted—indicted—I'll—I'll—I'll ruin him. And you," continued Mr Wardle, turning abruptly round to his sister, "you Rachael, at a time of life when you ought to know better, what do *you* mean by running away with a vagabond, disgracing your family, and making yourself miserable. Get on your bonnet, and come back. Call a hackney-coach there, directly, and bring this lady's bill, d'ye hear—d'ye hear?"

"Cert'nly, sir," replied Sam, who had answered Wardle's violent ringing of the bell with a degree of celerity which must have appeared marvellous to any body who didn't know that his eye had been applied to the outside of the key-hole during the whole interview.

"Get on your bonnet," repeated Wardle. "Do nothing of the kind," said Jingle. "Leave the room, sir—no business here—lady's free to act as she pleases—more than one-and-twenty."

"More than one-and-twenty!" ejaculated Wardle, contemptuously. "More than one-and-forty!"

"I a'nt," said the spinster aunt, her indignation getting the better of her determination to faint. "You are," replied Wardle; "you're fifty if you're an hour." Here the spinster aunt uttered a loud shriek, and became senseless.

"Boots," said Jingle, "get me an officer." "Stay, stay," said little Mr Perker. "Consider, sir, consider." "I'll not consider," replied Jingle, "she's her own mistress—see who dares take her away, unless she wishes it." [This firmness on the part of Jingle immediately brings about a compromise. He is led into another room, accepts a checque for a hundred and twenty pounds, and forthwith leaves the lady in the hands of her friends. Mr Pickwick is so well pleased with Sam's conduct in the affair, that he takes him from his profession of "boots," and constitutes him his own personal attendant.]

LOSS OF BRITISH SHIPPING.

So deficient is the construction of our ships, that the average annual loss, taking the period from 1793 to 1829, is 557 vessels; but of late years the loss has been increasing in an alarming degree—no fewer than 1068 having, in the year 1829, been wrecked, foundered, upset, or driven ashore. It appears, in fact, that our merchant ships are the worst in the world, and that they have been rapidly declining of late years. The chief cause of this is the system of insurance, combined with classifying the ships at Lloyd's. After a certain length of time, a ship ceases to be in the first class A 1, whatever may be her strength. The merchant, finding the rate of insurance is lowest on new ships, of course prefers them. The ship-owner is thus compelled to have not good but *new* ships; he, like the merchant, protects himself against the risk of loss from their insufficiency, by insurance; and hence it is only cheap ships that are in demand. A merchant ship, of 1000 tons, is only three inches thick in the bottom; while a ship of the Royal Navy, of equal tonnage, is twenty-one inches thick. Many merchant ships are so weak, even when new, that they cannot bear the weight of their own cargoes, unless when afloat; and hence the enormous loss of that kind of shipping, compared with that of the Royal Navy, and the vessels of the East India Company, neither of which are insured. In 1833, 800 merchant ships were lost, and not one of the Royal Navy. Although ship-builders, ship-owners, merchants, and insurers, may all contrive to carry on a lucrative business, the loss of property, amounting to about three millions a-year, ultimately falls on the public, in the form of an increased price of the commodities carried by sea. The loss of life by this state of matters is so great, that Professor Faraday lately mentioned, at the Royal Society, that of all classes of men, sailors are the shortest lived.—*Tait's Magazine, April* 1837.

We have seen other reasons given for the use of bad vessels; one in particular is so curious that it deserves notice. When a crazy vessel is damaged, it goes at once to the bottom, or is knocked in pieces, and there is no trouble whatever in recovering the value insured; but when a good vessel is damaged, and not totally wrecked, it can be repaired; and there is then a vast deal of trouble, perhaps litigation, in recovering the actual amount of loss incurred. We have an instance in point within our own experience. Some time ago we sent a large quantity of goods to a distant colony, and the vessel carrying them being partially wrecked, our goods were partially damaged. When we shall receive their value as insured, or payment for the injury done them, we cannot tell. It is a troublesome business. Had the ship gone to the bottom of the sea, instead of hanging together till it got into port, we should long ere now have received the value for which we effected an insurance. There could have been no difficulty in the matter. "But why not compel the underwriter to pay the injury, and be done with it?" we hear some one say. In other words, "why not ruin yourselves with a law-plea in order to get justice?" We prefer putting up with the loss or the delay, as the case may be. And there closes the argument. There is only one way of putting an end to these absurdities—let a proper maritime code of law be established, which would settle all disputes about insurance off hand, without either trouble or expense.

POETRY OF MANY LANDS.

FRANCE.—BERANGER.

In the present age, a lyrical genius, gifted with powers extraordinary in extent, and of an order almost unique, has adorned the national literature of France. This lyrist is still alive, his name, as many of our readers will know, being Pierre Jean de Beranger. The songs of Beranger amount to several hundreds, and have long been deservedly and universally popular with the French people. It is scarcely possible to give a general character of these compositions, so varied are the subjects which the lyrist, with a skill almost unparalleled in this species of writing, has melted and mingled into poetry. Over this wide range, the career of Beranger was in some measure instrumental in giving him the mastery; his life having been a round of perpetual vicissitudes from his first humble occupation of an inn-boy, to the time when his well-earned celebrity brought him into contact with the rich and great. Having witnessed, besides, the revolution in his youth, he, like every active mind then existing in his country, had formed strong political opinions, and being manly and independent enough never to conceal them, but on the contrary to advocate them with all his powers, he suffered again and again from the resentment of the Bourbons and others to whom his liberal notions, and his cutting satire, were specially obnoxious; for, among other subjects of his verse, politics were a favourite theme.

The character of Beranger's lyrics may be better understood by negative than positive description. The French poet is not so close and sententious as Horace, has not the refined wit and exquisite polish of Moore, and is inferior to Burns in tenderness and pathos. But he combines all these distinguishing characteristics of the illustrious song-writers now named, in a degree such as none of them singly possessed, nor any other lyrical poet perhaps that ever lived. Endowed with powers so rare, and employing them upon subjects so varied as we have described, it is scarcely to be wondered at, that Beranger should be equally admired by peer and by peasant, by every one, indeed, excepting the mean and the tyrannical, and that he is now one of the most noted men in his native country.

Lucien Bonaparte had the merit of first discovering and patronising Beranger's talents. This occurred in the beginning of the present century, when the poet was about his twentieth year. His first effusions were of a joyous description, corresponding well with the frank and careless spring-time of the mind which emitted them. The following song, which, in its English dress, has little pretension to any merit besides that of being a close translation, will give some idea of the light, arch, and simple character of these earlier and less ambitious effusions. A blind mother sits in a cottage beside her pretty daughter, and cautions her against love, while all the time an amatory scene is going on between the girl and the very lover whom the old dame dreads:

Daughter, while you turn your wheel,
Listen to the words I say:
Colin has contrived to steal
Your unthinking heart away:
Of his fawning voice beware,
You are all the blind one's care,
And I mark your sighs whene'er
Our young neighbour's name is heard;
Colin's tongue is false, though winning—
Hist! the window is unbarred!
Ah, Lisette, you are not spinning!

The room is close and warm, you say,
But, my daughter, do not peep
Through the casement—night and day
Colin there his watch doth keep.
Think not mine a grumbling tongue,
Ah! ere at my breast you hung,
I, like you, was fair and young,
And I know how apt is love
To lead the youthful heart to sinning—
Hist! the door—I heard it move!
Ah, Lisette, you are not spinning!

It is a gust of wind, you say,
That hath made the hinges grate,
And my poor old growling Tray—
Must you break for that his pate?
Ah, my child, put faith in me,
Age permits me to foresee
Colin soon will faithless be,
And your love to an abyss
Of grief will be the sad beginning—
Bless me! sure I heard a kiss!
Ah, Lisette, you are not spinning!

'Twas your little bird, you say,
Gave that tender kiss just now;
Make him cease his trifling, pray,
He will rue it else, I vow.
Love, my girl, oft bringeth pain,
Shame and sorrow in his train,
While the false successful swain
Scorns the heart he hath beguiled
From true virtue's paths to sinning—
Hist! I hear you moving, child;
Ah, Lisette, you are not spinning!

You wish to take the air, you say:
Think you, daughter, I believe you?
Bid young Colin go his way,
Or at once as bride receive you!
Let him go to church, and there
Show his purpose to be fair,
But, till then, beside my chair
You must work, my girl, nor heed
All his vows so fond and winning:
Tangled is love's web indeed—
Lisette, my daughter, mind your spinning!

At the restoration of the Bourbons, Beranger began to make his songs the vehicle of political satire; an unwise step, for which he suffered severely. Louis XVIII. deprived him, in 1821, of a petty official place which he had held, besides imposing on him a fine of 300 francs, and throwing him into prison for three months. In the time of Charles X., the poet received a still heavier punishment for a similar offence, being imprisoned for nine months, and fined in ten thousand francs! On both occasions, the nation, who sympathised in his sufferings, rallied round the poet, paid his fines by subscription, and in a great measure took the charge of his future maintenance.

It is not our intention to lay before the reader at present any of Beranger's satirical effusions. The reader will be better pleased, we have no doubt, with a specimen illustrative of the tenderness and enthusiasm of his muse. A love of human freedom, however, breathes through *all* his writings, as the following translation, imperfect though it be, of his "Carrier Dove of Athens," will show:—

THE CARRIER DOVE OF ATHENS.

I sat by the side of my own dear May,
And drank of the sparkling wine,
And our talk was of Greece in her elder day,
When her arts and her arms were divine.
When, lo! at our feet there alighted a dove,
And a wing-hidden billet it bore:—
Wert thou sent, faithful bird, on a message of love?
Taste my cup, and repose from thy long flight above,
On the breast of my fair Isidore!

Though thy pinion now flags with its long weary flight,
Strength and freedom again shall be thine,
And thy task be fulfilled, whether true lover's plight,
Or trade be the theme of the line.
It may be, thou bear'st from the exiles that rove
Afar on a stranger shore
The last fond sigh to the land of their love—
Taste my cup, and repose from thy long flight above,
On the bosom of fair Isidore!

Ha! these letters are traced in the tongue of the Greek,
Which to France thou hast wafted with speed,
From Athens they come, and of glory should speak,
So a lover of glory may read.
Hurrah! *Greece is free!* Oh brave sounds of delight—
Does her laurel-tree flourish once more?
Will her children again be god-like and bright?
Taste my cup, faithful bird, and repose from thy flight,
On the breast of my own Isidore!

Old Athens is free! Let us drink, love, to Greece,
And her sons of the demigod race,
Who, while Europe stood by in inglorious peace,
Fought their way to their fathers' high place!
They have conquered, and pilgrims on Athens shall gaze
In pity and sadness no more,
For no more shall she be but a wreck of past days—
Taste my cup, thou bright rover in heavenly ways,
And rest with the fair Isidore!

Strike the lyre, Muse of Greece! wake the long-silent strings,
And resume the proud empire of song!
She is free, in despite of our cold-hearted kings—
Of barbarian violence and wrong!
Her valleys again shall be verdant and fair,
Her laurels be green as of yore;
And her name with earth's highest and best shall compare—
Taste my cup, and recline, faithful rover of air,
On the breast of my own Isidore!

Lovely pilgrim of Hellas, repose yet a while,
Then away to thy fond watching mate,
And again may'st thou bear to oppression and guile
A message of loathing and hate!
Again may'st thou waft to each tyrant-filled throne,
Till it totters and quakes to its core,
The cries of a people—in freedom's dread tone—
Taste my cup, faithful dove, for thou soon must be gone,
From the breast of the fair Isidore!

While still in the prime of his life and powers, Beranger, a few years ago, took a public and solemn farewell of poetry, announcing at the same time his intention of dedicating the autumn of his days to an historical composition, embodying his personal views and recollections of the stirring times in which he has flourished. He smiles at the thought, that he who has so long stood before his contemporaries in the character of a fanciful songster, may be known to future times chiefly as the "grave and judicious annalist, Beranger!" It is honourable to his countrymen that their generous patronage should have put that leisure in the poet's power, which such a change of views requires, though the result he anticipates is not likely to ensue. On his songs rests his chance of an immortal name, and the chance is as fair a one as that of any poet of the present age. Meanwhile, the beautiful valedictory ode which the occasion gave birth to, may tend to lessen our regret at Beranger's desertion of the muse. With an admirable translation of this piece, for which we are indebted to the pages of

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the Edinburgh Review, we shall conclude the present article.

"BERANGER'S ADIEU TO SONG.

Of late, to keep my fading garland green,
I tried to give some sportive measure birth;
When, lo! beside me was the fairy seen,
My nurse of yore beside the tailor's hearth.
'The wind,' she said, 'upon thy head blows bleak,
The nights grow dark and long, and chill the sky;
With twenty years the voice may well be weak,
That never sang but when the storm was high.'
Then, songs, adieu! Bare is my wrinkled brow;
'Tis time the bird were hush'd—the storm begins to blow.

'Those days are over when the heart would bound,
And like a harp to every tone reply;
When mirth its playful lightnings scattered round,
And made a sunshine in the darkest sky.
Now narrower grows the heaven, more deep the gloom:
No more the joyous laugh of friends will flow:
Where are they sleeping? In the silent tomb
Lisette herself is but a shadow now.'
Then, songs, adieu! Bare is my wrinkled brow;
'Tis time the bird were hush'd—the storm begins to blow.

'Bless thou thy lot. Thy simple strains have led
The highborn muse to be the poor man's guest,
And wafted on the wings of song, have sped
Their way to many a rude unletter'd breast.
The orator a learned throng must find,
Thou didst more boldly against kings conspire,
And to the ditties of the street hast join'd
The high and solemn accents of thy lyre!'
Then, songs, adieu! Bare is my wrinkled brow;
'Tis time the bird were hush'd—the storm begins to blow.

'Thy pointed shafts that never spared the throne,
Fast as they fell, were gathered from the plain;
From hand to hand conveyed, and boldly thrown
By laughing thousands to their goal again.
In vain that throne its thunders would recall,
Three days, and rusty muskets, tamed its pride.
For every shot which pierced its purple pall,
Who but the muse of song the charge supplied?'
Then, songs, adieu! Bare is my wrinkled brow;
'Tis time the bird were hush'd—the storm begins to blow.

'Proud was thy share in that immortal strife,
When men from plunder turn'd in scorn away;
The bright remembrance, crowning all thy life,
Shall gild with sunshine its declining day.
Go thou, to younger ears repeat the tale,
Guide thou their bark—point out the rocks below;
And when with pride France shall thy pupils hail,
Warm thy cold winter at their youthful glow.'
Then, songs, adieu! Bare is my wrinkled brow;
'Tis time the bird were hush'd—the storm begins to blow.

Yes, gentle fairy, at the poet's door
Thou tapp'st in time, and warn'st him to be gone.
Soon in his garret, shall he meet, once more,
Oblivion, of repose the sire and son.
Haply some friends, old comrades in the fight,
When I am gone, may wipe their eyes and say—
'We can remember when his star wax'd bright,
And Heaven, before it waned, withdrew its ray!'
Then, songs, adieu! Bare is my wrinkled brow;
'Tis time the bird were hush'd—the storm begins to blow."

MANAGEMENT AND MISMANAGEMENT.*

GREAT men have written their "confessions." Why should I not write mine? I have something to tell as well as my neighbours, and, perhaps, to as good purpose. Listen, then, kind reader, to my gossiping narrative. My name is Philip Artervelde, and I am a descendant of one of the most respectable families in Belgium. I am married, and have a wife of the most agreeable dispositions, who has brought me two sons and three daughters. At my father's death, a small estate was left to me, which yielded a decent though not a large income. These are things important for you to know; but to let my history be known thoroughly, I must begin with my marriage. When this event took place, I was twenty-six years of age. Before receiving my wife into my house, I expended a great deal of money in what I thought necessary preparations. I bought a fine new dwelling-house, and filled it, from the roof to the cellar, with furniture of the best kind. At the same time, I purchased a horse and curricle, and in every thing, in short, endeavoured to anticipate my wife's wishes.

What with driving about, and paying and receiving visits, things went on very pleasantly with us for some time. When our first child was born, however, my wife found less leisure for pleasures of this kind, and as we had often determined that our superfluous expenses should *decrease* as our family *increased*, the horse and curricle were sold. This was a wise enough step, but, to my surprise, I found at the end of the year that our expenditure was not curtailed by it one whit upon the whole. This annoyed me the more, because I knew that one of our neighbours, a M. Lenoir, was in the habit of laying by two hundred crowns yearly, though his income was rather less than mine, and his family the same in number.

"I cannot comprehend how he manages to do it," said my wife one day to me.

"If we discover his plan, would you have the firmness to follow his example?" asked I. "I would certainly do so," was my wife's reply, and on the following day we made a visit of observation to the Lenoirs. After partaking of their hospitality, we turned the discourse upon household economy. "We are very frugal now," said Madame Lenoir, "in our table expenses. The times are hard; every thing is dear. Our dishes do not tickle the palate, but they agree all the better with the stomach. Coffee, sugar, and such things, have been given up by us, because they are so costly at this time, and we live chiefly on our vegetables, and plain soup. We thus maintain our health and good humour, without having the annoyance of always seeing our last piece of money. The pleasure of feeding on luxuries cannot counterbalance the inquietude caused by an empty purse."

Several other particulars of her management were detailed to us by the lady. On returning home from our visit to the Lenoirs, my wife said, "These people starve on crumbs; they do not enjoy life, which is very foolish, as we only come into this world *once*. We will economise more rationally than they do; we will mix succory with our coffee, which will make it a cheaper diet than Madame Lenoir's soup, and it will still be coffee. As to our dinner, we must have one dish less." This retrenchment, as well as a number of minor ones, was accordingly put in force. Several years passed away, and still, at the end of every twelve months, I had not a shilling to spare. Our family had increased, a nurse had to be got to take care of the children, and they required clothes so incessantly, that a sempstress had to work daily in the house. It is inconceivable how many charges I had to support. M. Lenoir, in the meantime, had, like myself, five children born to him, *yet every year he had found means to lay by two hundred crowns for the improvement of his estate.*

"I cannot comprehend how he manages to do it," said my wife. To which repetition of her former remark, I again replied, "Will you follow his example?" She answered in the affirmative, and away we went again on a voyage of discovery to M. and Madame Lenoir's. The old subject being introduced, "Heaven be praised!" exclaimed Madame Lenoir, "with all our children, things go on better than could be expected, and our family is quiet and regular. At five o'clock, we rise; breakfast at seven, dine at noon, sup at seven in the evening, and go to bed at nine. Summer and winter, it is the same. It is incredible, my dear friend," continued the lady, addressing my wife, "how much may be done between waking and sleeping, when one loves occupation, and every hour has its appointed duty! All is order with us. Every thing has its place, and minutes are never lost in searching for keys, scissors, or other little implements. We could find a needle in the dark here. This gives me a good deal of leisure, and I employ it in the children's affairs, so that I need neither nurse nor sempstress." Much more of the same kind did we listen to from Madame Lenoir before returning home. When we did so, I only observed to my wife, "Remember what our neighbour has said about the *keys!*"

For some time after this, our household was the most orderly that can be conceived. By and bye, however, it became again necessary to search for the *keys*. Our children grew up, and became such boisterous roving creatures, that a man-servant had to be got to take charge of them. Three or four years had again passed away, and I was as far from saving money as ever, while every year, M. Lenoir continued to lay by his two hundred crowns. "It is incomprehensible," said my wife to me, a third time; "his income is not greater than ours, yet his children are as well clothed, and he has money to spare!" Another visit was made by us to the Lenoirs, and on this occasion we candidly told them our thoughts. "My plans are simple," said M. Lenoir to us; "when I had no children, I visited my friends, and freely entertained them in return. Now, I am contented with the company of my family; for where can a man be happier than at his own fireside, with his children at his knees? A part of my house is let, because I had no use for it when I gave up company. With the rent, my children are clothed." Many more advices did M. Lenoir give us, and the result was, that my wife and I followed his example, and gave no more entertainments. But the children's wants were now increasing daily; books and pocket-money were in continual request for the boys, and the girls wanted lessons in dancing, music, and other accomplishments. I found at the end of each year that I had not yet learned the art of saving money. Meanwhile M. Lenoir went on with his annual saving of *two hundred crowns*.

"I can see no way of accounting for it," said my wife, "but that he must be a sorcerer." "Let us try again to discover the secret," was my reply; and away we went once more to the Lenoirs. "No; I am no sorcerer," said our neighbour Madame Lenoir; "listen to the way in which our household is managed, since our boys and girls grew up beyond childhood. My girls assist me in managing the house, each taking for a month in turn the charge of the kitchen, the dairy, and the poultry. Our eldest son is the teacher of all the rest; and in order to qualify him for this, he has received the best instructions, not only in the common branches of education, but in such accomplishments as music, dancing, &c. We began this practice so early, that the routine is become habitual to them all, and habit, you know, is second nature."

Alas! we found the truth of this maxim when we tried to introduce at home this new imitation of our neighbours. Our children were habituated to other ways, and habit is second nature. My eldest son was as good a scholar at school and college as theirs, but he could not teach what he learnt.

After M. Lenoir's eldest son had studied at college, he was, to my great surprise, placed by his father as apprentice to a rich and noted artizan. On asking M. Lenoir why he had done this, he replied, "I wish my son to have two strings to his bow. His education never can be lost to him, and from the unsettled state of Europe just now, it is possible that he may have to depend some day on his hands for support." Pleased with this reasoning, I proposed the scheme to my wife for imitation. "No, no, husband!" cried she; "our son must be a surgeon or advocate, and so occupy a respectable station, which will enable him, probably, to make a grand marriage. How can an artizan expect to make a rich match?" Still stronger objections were started by the boy himself. "One cannot," said he, "walk two ways at once. Learn one thing, and learn it well. A jack of all trades is master generally of nothing." As a husband and father, I was always tractable, and said no more. My son remained at college, costing much money, and gaining none.

My daughters had received every accomplishment, and, being now grown to womanhood, were sent by their mother to balls, parties, and concerts, without number, which made it necessary to purchase for them expensive articles of dress more frequently than can be imagined. My wife and I deprived ourselves of many little comforts to give them these opportunities of forming advantageous connections. This was not the way with M. Lenoir's daughters. "Bah!" said their father, "my girls are not brilliantly accomplished, yet they can dance and sing. They do not go often to spectacles and assemblies, yet they meet their friends, and display their good qualities among those they know. Activity and industry are the best recommendations of young women, and an acquaintance with those duties which are required to manage a family, is the training they should receive before becoming their own mistresses."

When I repeated to my wife these sentiments of M. Lenoir—"Ah, he is right!" said she, "but we are right also. It may do very well for his daughters to remain at home; it is well known that he has money to give away with them, and accordingly admirers will seek them out and follow them. But our daughters must depend on their personal qualities, and not on their fortune, for we have none to give them. How then are they to attract lovers unless they show themselves at balls, concerts, and assemblies? The young Lenoirs may sit secure at their own firesides, but our poor dowerless girls must mix with the world to be seen and loved." I held my tongue, and assumed as much patience under the misfortune as I could, for I feared it to be incurable.

It would only tire the reader were I to linger any longer over the history of M. Lenoir's household and my own. His three daughters were married respectably and advantageously; mine showed themselves every where, smiled on all the world, and remained single. My wife and myself have lived poorly, and suffered great straits during their gaudy and superficial exhibitions. How my property now stands, or rather how much of it now remains, after all that my children have cost, it would be painful to me to dwell on. Rather let me tell, for I envy not what superior conduct has achieved, how M. Lenoir is now placed. After the marriage of his daughters, he changed his way of life. He has bought a little villa, a horse and a curricle, and tastes more freely of the ease and enjoyments of life. In making the same purchases at marriage, I *began* with what I should have *concluded*. "Why should we continue our strict frugality?" said M. Lenoir to me; "our property is so much increased, after thirty years of economy, as to yield a handsome income. My wife and I are advancing in years, and require many comforts which in our days of strength we would have scorned to indulge in; therefore we have our table better served, and we ride about instead of walking as formerly. We visit our children, and sport with our grandchildren. Oh, how much happiness have we to be thankful for! Our life is spent as it were in a paradise!"

Tears filled my good neighbour's eyes as he spoke, and drops also coursed down my own cheek. But mine were not, like his, tears of joy. I now see that good intentions, which it is some consolation to me to think that I have always preserved, are not all that is necessary to render life comfortable and happy. A certain degree of mental firmness and carefulness of disposition, leading to a provident management of the worldly possessions which providence has bestowed, is requisite to guide the father of a family in that course, which is ultimately most conducive to the welfare of himself and all connected with him.

* Translated from the "Almanach Belge, pour 1837."

THE BLOOD-HOUND.

THE Old English blood-hound (or talbot) was not originally indigenous to the British Isles, nor have we positive information as to the period of its introduction; though I entertain not the least doubt that this animal accompanied, or very soon followed, the baleful steps of that horde of Norman banditti, who, under William the Conqueror, established themselves in this country. The talbot, or Old English blood-hound, is about twenty-eight or twenty-nine inches in height; of substantial, strong, and muscular form; the face long and wide, and the head altogether very large; nostrils wide and expansive; ears large, very long, soft, and pendulous; eyes deeply seated; the countenance remarkably expressive, solemn, noble, and majestic; voice awfully deep, loud, and sonorous. The talbot was evidently the source whence have sprung all those ramifications which, under the name of southern hounds, northern hounds, fox-hounds, stag-hounds, and beagles, are to be met with in various parts of the United Kingdom.

The most distinguishing characteristic or peculiarity of the talbot was his extraordinary sagacity and perse-

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verance in tracing animals which had strayed away, or had been stolen, and also the thief himself. From the frequent employment of this animal in tracing stolen deer (shot by the deer-stealers, and the ground perhaps sprinkled with their blood), as well as in pursuing thieves, the term blood-hound, no doubt, originated; but if we consider the subject philosophically, we shall perceive that the word *blood* may be applied to the hunting of any other kind of hound precisely in the same manner. However, inasmuch as the talbot evinced decidedly superior powers in the pursuit, could challenge and carry a scent, when no other variety of the tribe could recognise it, he became distinguished accordingly. Let us see whence he derived this extraordinary faculty. Having already remarked that the talbot has a very large head, it may be further observed that his head is much more capacious than that of any other kind of dog; on this account, therefore, he is more abundantly supplied with those little white cords (which the dissecting knife will render as palpable as possible) which constitute the olfactory organ, or sense of smell, and is enabled consequently to evince that acuteness and sagacity in the pursuit which has so frequently excited the astonishment of the superficial observer.

A sportsman will remark, that such a hound has a better nose than another. Why?—because his head is wider and more capacious. In dogs with capacious heads, the sieva bone is larger and contains more openings than in narrow-headed dogs; so that the olfactory nerves, which pass through it, are more numerous and more minutely divided; and thus that exquisite acuteness of smell is produced, which must always be found in dogs with broad capacious heads: hence that extraordinary superiority displayed by the talbot becomes perceptible. The talbot was formerly much in use in certain districts on the Scottish and English border, which were infested by robbers and murderers; and these hounds were maintained at the public expense; and there was a law in Scotland, that whoever refused entrance to one of them in pursuit of stolen goods, should be deemed an accessary. They are faintly recollected in Scotland by the name of *sleuth-hound*.

These animals were used in the pursuit of the moss-trooper, called *hot-trod*; whence they acquired the name of *slough dogs*, from their perseverance in exploring mosses (morasses) and bogs in pursuit of thieves.

When the barbarous and petty chieftains of the north were frequently in open hostility against each other, the vanquished who fled from the savage and sanguinary conflict, were frequently hunted from cave to cave by a dog of this description, and slaughtered in cold blood. When, something more than a century ago, deer-stealing was so much practised in this country, the foresters and keepers pursued the marauders with these dogs; and when once one of them was laid well on the scent, they considered detection as certain; a criminal was regarded as half-convicted the moment the talbot recognised the scent.

The South American blood-hound, called also the *Cuba blood-hound*, possesses but little pretension to the character which he has assumed, as far at least as the sense of smell is concerned, or compared with the noble animal which has formed the subject of the preceding observations.

The indigenous dog of America is a small weak creature, and the natives were struck with horror on beholding the large ferocious dogs which originally accompanied the Spaniards. To be brief, the dog taken by the Spaniards to America was a sort of mastiff, found all over the European continent, remarkable for its savage disposition, its fierceness, and its activity. This dog, this South American blood-hound, as he is called, is nearly as high as the English mastiff, but his head is smaller, the lower part more taper, lips much closer, legs rather thin, but cleaner than those of the dog just mentioned; his countenance presents a most malignant savage appearance. With such animals the persecuted natives of America were pursued and half-worried to death; with them also, subsequently, have the runaway negroes been hunted down by the remorseless Spaniards. However, when these dogs were used, it was generally found necessary to employ a smaller canine assistant, called a *finder*, on account of the inferiority of the larger animal's sense of smell. When the Maroons in Jamaica appeared in arms, for the purpose of shaking off their intolerable oppressions (under the governorship of Lord Balcarras), a number of these dogs were procured, *with their Spanish attendants*, from Cuba; and so terrified were the unfortunate blacks at the idea of being hunted by these animals, that they immediately submitted.

The talbot possesses all the courage of the Cuba blood-hound, without the malignant fierceness which forms the most distinguishing characteristic of the latter; to a mild, majestic appearance, the talbot adds a most acute sense of smell; qualities in which the South American blood-hound is very deficient.—*Sunday Times, Nov.* 13, 1836.

MISPLACING WORDS.

The following sentence from a work of fiction of modern date, entitled "Peter Simple," shows how ridiculous a very ordinary expression may be rendered, by the misplacing of words—"He was in his library, a large room, surrounded with handsome book-cases, sitting in an easy chair." That is to say—the book-cases were sitting in an easy chair—a thing by the way rather remarkable. If it had been the man who was sitting in the easy chair, the sentence would have been written thus—"He was sitting in an easy chair in his library." Here there could have been no room for misapprehension. This kind of slovenliness in the construction of sentences is very common. In a late newspaper, we saw the following droll announcement. "The locomotive engine constructed for the St Petersburg railway, at Newcastle, had its trial on Saturday." We never knew before that the St Petersburg railway is situated at Newcastle! Perhaps we may be told that the commas in these sentences save the credit of the writers. This is a lame excuse. Nonsense cannot be construed into sense by the aid of commas, and for the very good reason that, in reading aloud, we do not name the points as we go along. Authors should always write in such a manner that, when their compositions are read aloud, the audience will find no difficulty in comprehending at once what is meant.

THE FIRST DAY OF TERM.

This day the courts at Westminster will display, as usual, all the pomp and pageantry of glorious law—glorious and lucrative to a few, but destructive to at least one-half of the suitors, who must unquestionably be miserable. What is this boasted law? It is like turtle-soup at a tavern, sold at an extravagant rate. Whether the plaintiff in a suit be right or wrong, his cause cannot go on without the payment of enormous fees. Such is the great principle upon which the civil law of this country is now administered, and a knowledge of the fact has prevented thousands from obtaining justice. A short time since, a man filed a bill in Chancery to recover out of the hands of a swindler a small freehold, long the property of his ancestors. The justice of his claim was proved and admitted, but the costs of the proceedings were to be paid, and the house was sold for that purpose The wretched suitor, reduced to poverty, established his legal claim at the expense of his inheritance. This was law:—was it justice? Another seeks by action of ejectment to recover possession of an estate left by his father. He is poor, and unable to pay into the hands of his attorney the expense of stamps, and the fees necessary to bring the cause to trial. The fraudulent holder of the estate is rich. The poor man's attorney is told by indirect means that he may obtain more by losing the cause than he can get by bringing it to trial. A bribe finds its way into his hands, a wilful blunder is made in the proceedings, and the poor plaintiff is defeated in his right of action. These atrocious proceedings spring out of the law as it is now constituted. Many others might be quoted, but such abuses are too well known to require details. It is a general complaint that the practice of the law is at variance with justice. The judges are pure, and raised above temptation, but the fees and expenses in their courts amount, where a poor man is concerned, to a denial of justice. What have the great reformers done to correct this evil? Nothing. Justice is uncertain, costs are certain, and fall like an *avalanche* to crush the poor man and his family. The knowledge of this compels the poor and honest creditor to abandon his claim, and lose a debt rather than sue for it. We have great reformers, who profess the strongest desire to support the rights and comforts of the people. Such men should rescue the law from the odium under which it stands, and make justice preserve a fair balance. Many will go to see the legal array on the first day of term, but reflection must convince them it is a display which cannot excite pleasure. The dense cloud of black gowns is portentous of sorrow, pain, and misfortunes, in preparation for a large portion of his majesty's subjects. The system is bad—reform it altogether.—*From an old number of the Morning Advertiser newspaper.* [We beg leave to add, what the writer of the above paragraph has omitted, that the impossibility of getting justice either speedily or cheaply is fast demolishing the trade of lawyers. Few men in their senses, now-a-days, will go to law. They know they will be losers, even should they win, for nothing can compensate the distress of mind endured in litigation. We know a case in court at present which any two rational men could satisfactorily settle in an hour, and in all likelihood it will take two years for decision. What a protraction of misery is this!

PARODY ON "TO BE OR NOT TO BE."

To have it out or not? that is the question—
Whether 'tis better for the jaws to suffer
The pangs and torments of an aching tooth,
Or to take steel against a host of troubles:
And, by extracting, end them? To pull—to tug!—
No more: And by a tug to say we end
The tooth-ache, and a thousand natural ills
The jaw is heir to: 'Tis a consummation
Devoutly to be wished! To pull—to tug!—
To tug—perchance to break! Ay, there's the rub.
For in that wrench what agonies may come,
When we have half-dislodged the stubborn foe,
Must give us pause. There's the respect,
That makes an aching tooth of so long life.
For who would bear the whips and stings of pain,
The old wife's nostrum, dentist's contumely;
The pangs of hope deferred, kind sleep's delay:
The insolence of pity, and the spurns,
That patient sickness of the healthy takes:—
When he himself might his quietus make
For two-and-sixpence? Who would fardels bear,
To groan and sweat beneath a load of pain?—
But that the dread of something lodg'd within
The linen twisted forceps, from whose pangs
No jaw at ease returns!—puzzles the will:
And makes it rather bear the ills it has,
Than fly to others that it knows not of.
Thus dentists do make cowards of us all—
And thus the native hue of resolution
Is sicklied o'er with the pale cast of fear;
And many a one, whose courage seeks the door,
With this regard his footsteps turns away,
Scared at the name of dentist.

—*From the Rev. C. A. W——'s Album.*

COW-DEALING EXTRAORDINARY.

Once upon a time a farmer, residing at Epping Forest, having rather an elderly cow which began to be very slack of milk, he determined to get rid of her, and to purchase another. He accordingly took her to Romford fair, and sold her to a cow-dealer for about L.4, 10s., but he did not see any cow in the market promising enough in appearance, and returned home without a cow, but satisfied with the price he had got for the "old one." The cow-dealer calculated upon Smithfield market as a better *emporium* for disposing of his bargain, and accordingly drove her there, in order to sell her to the polony-pudding merchants; but there was a glut in that description of dainty in consequence of the late floods, which have proved fatal to many poor beasts. The cow would not sell even for the money which had been just given for her, and the owner was about to dispose of her for less—when a doctor, who had been regarding the beast for some time, offered, for a fee of 5s. to make her as young as she had been ten years before. The fee was immediately paid, the doctor took his patient to a stable, carded her all over—prescribed some strange diet for her—sawed down her horns from the rough and irregular condition to which years had swelled them, into the tapering and smoothness of youth, and delivered her to the owner, more like a calf, than the venerable ancestress of calves. The cow-dealer was struck with the extraordinary transformation, and it immediately occurred to him (a proof that a cow-dealer can be dishonest as well as a horse-dealer) to sell her for the highest price he could get for her, without saying a word about her defects and infirmities. Having learned that the Epping farmer was in want of a cow, he thought he could not send his bargain to better quarters than those she was accustomed to, and he forthwith dispatched her to Romford market, where her old master was on the look-out for a beast. She immediately caught his eye. He asked her age. The driver did not know, but she was a "fine young un." "I've seen a cow very like her somewhere," said the farmer. "Ay," said the driver, "then you must have seen her a long way off, for I believe she is an Alderney." "An Alderney! What do you ask for her?" The price was soon fixed. The driver got the sum of L.15, 7s. for the cow, and the farmer sent her home. The ingenuity exercised might be guessed at from the fact, that the person who drove the beast home had been at her tail for the last seven years at least twice a-day, and yet he did not make the discovery, although she played some of her old tricks on the journey, and turned into the old cow-house, and lay down in her old bed, with all the familiarity of an old acquaintance. At length the discovery was to be made. The cow was milked, and milked, but the most that could be got from her for breakfast was a pint, and that was little better than sky-blue. The farmer, in grief and astonishment, sent her to a cow-doctor, who had been in the habit of advising in her case, and complained that she gave him no milk. "Milk!" said he, "how should she, poor old creature? Sure it isn't by cutting her horns, and giving her linseed oil-cakes, and scrubbing her old limbs, that you can expect to make her give milk." The farmer was soon convinced of the imposture, and would have forgiven it if the laugh against him could have been endured. This not being the case, he applied to the Lord Mayor of London, for redress; but was told that his lordship could do nothing in the matter.—*Old Scrap Book.*

THE POWER OF WOMEN.

An editor in one of the country towns in the western states of America makes a most strange apology for the non-appearance of his paper on the regular day of publication, which we give in his own words:—"I feel ashamed to own the fact, but 'murder will out.' The plain reason was, my readers, that my dear wife said, *I must stay at home and take care of the children, while she went to a camp meeting*, and as I am a peace-making sort of a man, I did as I was bid, which is the only apology I have to make."

NOT COMFORTABLE YET.

A highly respectable and wealthy farmer in Connecticut gives the following as his own experience:—"When I first came here to settle about forty years ago, I told my wife I wanted to be rich. She said she did not want to be rich—all she wanted was enough to make her comfortable. I went to work and cleared up my land, I've worked hard ever since, and got rich—as rich as I want to be. Most of my children have settled about me, and they have all got farms—and my wife ain't comfortable yet."

UNION OF AN EAR.

In June 1833, a miller received a sabre cut at a public house, which completely amputated his right ear. Before he left the house, he picked up the ear from the ground, and put it into his pocket: this was in the evening. Early the following morning, he went to a surgeon, and showed him the ear, now cold and somewhat crushed. The surgeon washed the ear in spirits and water, and made a new edge to the wound of the part which the man still possessed, and to that of the ear which he had lost. After accurately fitting the parts, he kept them together by four stitches, and dressed them with adhesive plasters, compresses, and an appropriate bandage. The day after, some of the dressings were removed, in order to make sure that the parts were in contact: the point of union was then observed to be red; the patient was feverish, and had thirst and headache. In eight days these symptoms disappeared, and the helix began to assume its vital warmth; the lobular extremity united the first; the other parts suppurated; and granulations appeared on the cartilages. In little more than a month the cure was complete: the patient's right ear was almost in the same condition as the left, and all that was remarked was an elliptic linear cicatrix at the point of union.—*London Medical and Surgical Journal.*

A HOAX EXTRAORDINARY.

About the time of Bonaparte's departure for St Helena, a respectably dressed man caused a number of handbills to be distributed through Chester, in which he informed the public that a great number of genteel families had embarked at Plymouth, and would certainly proceed with the British regiment appointed to accompany the ex-emperor to St Helena: he added farther, that the island being dreadfully infested with rats, his majesty's ministers had determined that it should be forthwith effectually cleared of those noxious animals. To facilitate this important purpose, he had been deputed to purchase as many cats and thriving kittens as could possibly be procured for money in a short space of time; and therefore he publicly offered in his handbills 16s. for every athletic full-grown tom-cat, 10s. for every adult female puss, and half-a-crown for every thriving vigorous kitten that could swill milk, pursue a ball of thread, or fasten its young fangs on a dying mouse. On the evening of the third day after this advertisement had been distributed, the people of Chester were astonished by the irruption of a multitude of old women, boys, and girls, into their streets, all of whom carried on their shoulders either a bag or a basket, which appeared to contain some restless animal. Every road, every lane, was thronged with this comical procession; and the wondering spectators of the scene were involuntarily compelled to remember the old riddle about St Ives:

As I was going to St Ives,
I met a man with seven wives;
Every wife had seven sacks,
Every sack had seven cats,
Every cat had seven kitts;
Kitts, cats, sacks, and wives,
How many were going to St Ives?

Before night a congregation of nearly three thousand cats was collected in Chester. The happy bearers of these sweet-voiced creatures proceeded all (as directed by the advertisement) towards one street with their delectable burdens. Here they became closely wedged together. A vocal concert soon ensued. The women screamed; the cats squalled; the boys and girls shrieked treble, and the dogs of the streets howled bass. Some of the cat-bearing ladies, whose dispositions were not of the most placid nature, finding themselves annoyed by their neighbours, soon cast down their burdens, and began to fight. Meanwhile the boys of the town, who seemed mightily to relish the sport, were employed in opening the mouths of the sacks, and liberating the cats from their situation. The enraged animals bounded immediately on the shoulders and heads of the combatants, and ran squalling towards the walls of the houses of the good people of Chester. The citizens, attracted by the noise, had opened the windows to gaze at the uproar. The cats, rushing with the rapidity of lightning up the pillars, and then across the balustrades and galleries, for which the town is so famous, leaped slap-dash through the open windows into the apartments. Now were heard the crashes of broken china—the howling of affrighted dogs—the cries of distressed damsels, and the groans of well-fed citizens. All Chester was soon in arms; and dire were the deeds of vengeance executed on the feline race. Next morning above five hundred dead bodies were seen floating on the river Dee, where they had been ignominiously thrown by the two-legged victors. The rest of the invading host, the victims of this cruel joke, having evacuated the town, dispersed in the utmost confusion to their respective homes.—*Flowers of Anecdote.*

EBENEZER ADAMS.

This celebrated Quaker, on visiting a lady of rank, whom he found, six months after the death of her husband, sitting on a sofa covered with black cloth, and in all the dignity of woe, approached her with great solemnity, and gently taking her by the hand, thus accosted her—"So, friend, I see thou hast not yet *forgiven* God Almighty." This seasonable reproof had such an effect upon the person to whom it was addressed, that she immediately laid aside her trappings of grief, and went about her necessary business and avocations.—*The same.*

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